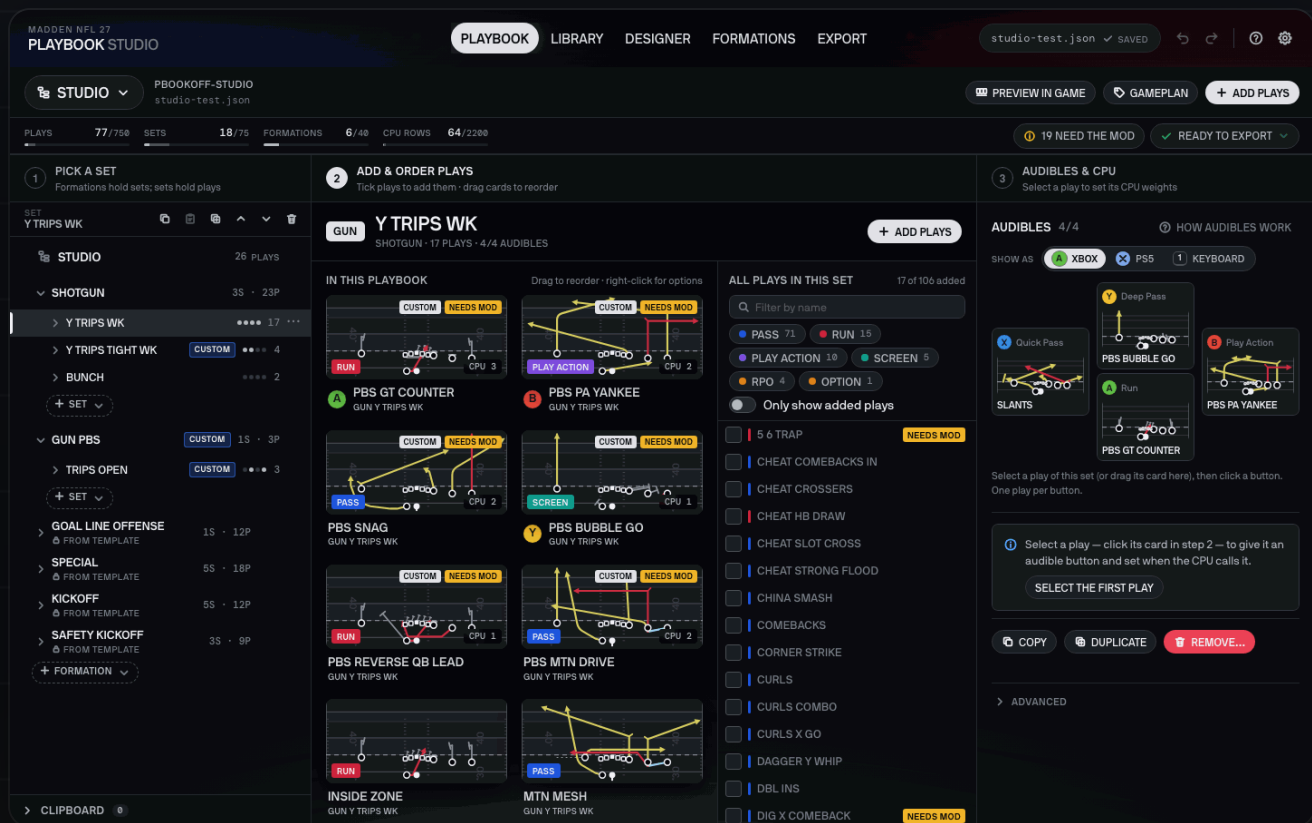


PLAYBOOK STUDIO

USER GUIDE · MADDEN NFL 27

Build custom playbooks, design your own plays, routes and formations, and send them to the game: a step-by-step guide to every screen.



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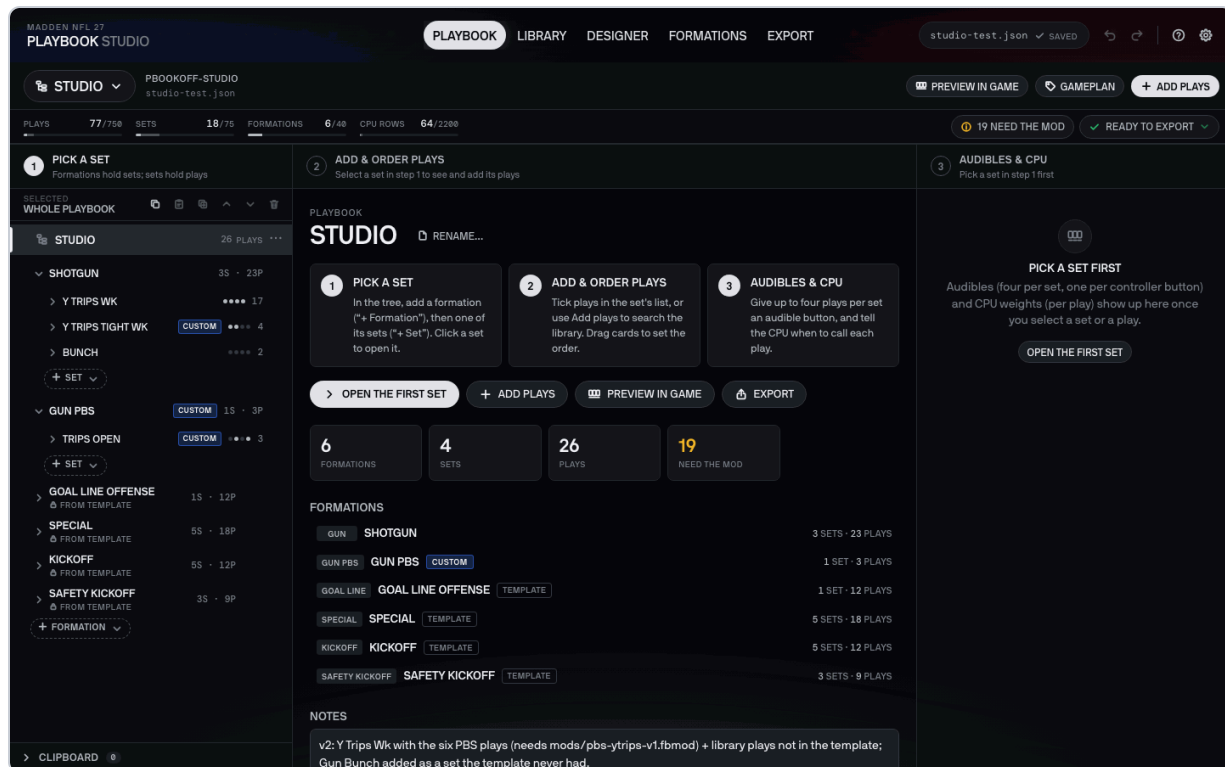
GETTING STARTED

What the app does, the round trip to the game, saving

HOW IT ALL FITS TOGETHER · THE FIVE TABS · YOUR FIRST PLAYBOOK IN TEN MINUTES · SAVING AND UNDO · WHERE YOUR FILES LIVE · MOUSE FIRST, A FEW KEYS · GETTING HELP · TWO WAYS TO OPEN THE APP

Playbook Studio is where you build your Madden NFL 27 playbooks. Pick plays from the game's library, put them in the order you like, set your audibles, design your own plays and routes, and even make your own formations. When you're done, one command on the Madden PC turns everything into a custom playbook you can pick in the game.

You don't need to know anything about Frosty, mods or file formats. The app writes a few small files into your 2026 Playbook folder, and the export tools on the Madden PC do the rest.



The Playbook tab with the STUDIO playbook open: pick a set on the left, its plays in the middle, audibles and CPU calls on the right.

HOW IT ALL FITS TOGETHER

Every change you make goes around the same loop:

1. Edit in Playbook Studio. Build playbooks, design plays, make sets. Save with `⌘S` (Mac) or `Ctrl+S` (PC).
2. Your work is saved as files in the `2026 Playbook` folder: playbooks in `playbooks/`, your own plays in `playbooks/plays/`, your own sets in `playbooks/sets/`.
3. Run the export on the Madden PC. Close Madden, open PowerShell in the `2026 Playbook` folder and run `tools\export.ps1 -Install`. It builds one mod and one playbook save per playbook.

4. Apply the mod in MMC Mod Manager. Add (or refresh) `mods\pbstudio.fbmod`, click **Apply**, then **Launch**.
5. Pick your playbook in the game. In an offline mode, choose your custom playbook (for example STUDIO).

The [Export](#) section walks through steps 3 to 5 with screenshots.

✦ THE SHORT VERSION

Work through the tabs at the top from left to right: **PLAYBOOK** → **LIBRARY** → **DESIGNER** → **FORMATIONS** → **EXPORT**. Most people only ever need the first two and the last one.

THE FIVE TABS

TAB	WHAT YOU DO THERE
PLAYBOOK	Open a playbook (STUDIO opens by default), arrange formations, sets and plays, set the four audibles of each set and tell the CPU when to call each play.
LIBRARY	Browse and search every play in the game (about 11,000) plus your own plays, then add them to a playbook.
DESIGNER	Make your own play from a play in the game: change routes, cuts, blocks, motion and the primary receiver (the red route).
FORMATIONS	Make your own set: move players, adjust the pre-snap motions, copy plays into it.
EXPORT	Check everything, see what the game PC will build, and get the command to run.

At the top right you'll also find:

- the **file chip**: the file you're working on, with **SAVED**, or a **SAVE** button and a yellow dot when there are unsaved changes;
- **Undo** and **Redo** (the curved arrows);
- **?** opens this guide at the section for the screen you're on;
- the **gear** opens Settings (audible buttons, field options, where your files are).

YOUR FIRST PLAYBOOK IN TEN MINUTES

1. Click **PLAYBOOK**. The STUDIO playbook (`playbooks/studio-test.json`) opens. To practise on a fresh one instead, open the playbook menu at the top left (it shows **STUDIO**) and choose **New playbook....**
2. In step 1 on the left, click a set, for example **Y TRIPS WK** under **SHOTGUN**. In a new playbook, first click **+ FORMATION** (type "shotgun", press Enter), then **+ SET** under it (type "y trips wk", press Enter).
3. In step 2 in the middle, tick a few plays in **ALL PLAYS IN THIS SET**. They appear as cards in **IN THIS PLAYBOOK**. Drag the cards to put them in order.
4. In step 3 on the right, click a play card, then click one of the four buttons in the audible diamond to make it an audible.
5. Press **⌘S / Ctrl+S** to save (or click **SAVE** at the top right).
6. Click the **EXPORT** tab. If it says **READY TO EXPORT**, click the **EXPORT** button, then run the command it shows on the Madden PC.

Want a play that isn't in this set? Click + **ADD PLAYS** and search the whole library, or find it in the [Library](#) and use Add to playbook.

SAVING AND UNDO

- **⌘S / Ctrl+S** saves the file you're working on. **⇧⌘S / Ctrl+Shift+S** saves every changed file.
- A yellow dot and a **SAVE** button in the file chip mean there are unsaved changes. **SAVED** means the file on disk is up to date.
- **⌘Z / Ctrl+Z** undoes, **⇧⌘Z / Ctrl+Y** redoes. Every file keeps its own history (up to 200 steps), so undo works even after you've switched tabs.
- If you try to close the page with unsaved changes, the browser asks first.
- **EXPORT** saves everything for you before it checks.

CHANGED ON DISK

If a file changes outside the app while it's open (git, a sync app, another browser tab), the app never overwrites it silently. You choose: reload the disk version, overwrite it, or save your version as a copy. See the [FAQ](#).

WHERE YOUR FILES LIVE

Everything is in your `2026 Playbook` folder. Nothing is uploaded anywhere.

WHAT	FILE
Playbooks	<code>playbooks/<name>.json</code> , one per playbook (becomes the save <code>PBOOKOFF-<NAME></code>)
Your own plays	<code>playbooks/plays/<name>.json</code> (built into the mod)
Your own formations and sets	<code>playbooks/sets/<name>.json</code> (built into the same mod)
My Routes, concepts and tags	<code>app-data/routes.json</code> , <code>app-data/concepts.json</code> (only the app uses these)
Deleted files	<code>app-data/.trash/</code> (move a file back to restore it)
The game's play library	<code>data/library/</code> (read only)

MOUSE FIRST, A FEW KEYS

Everything is a button, a menu or a right-click menu. The keyboard only has the usual shortcuts:

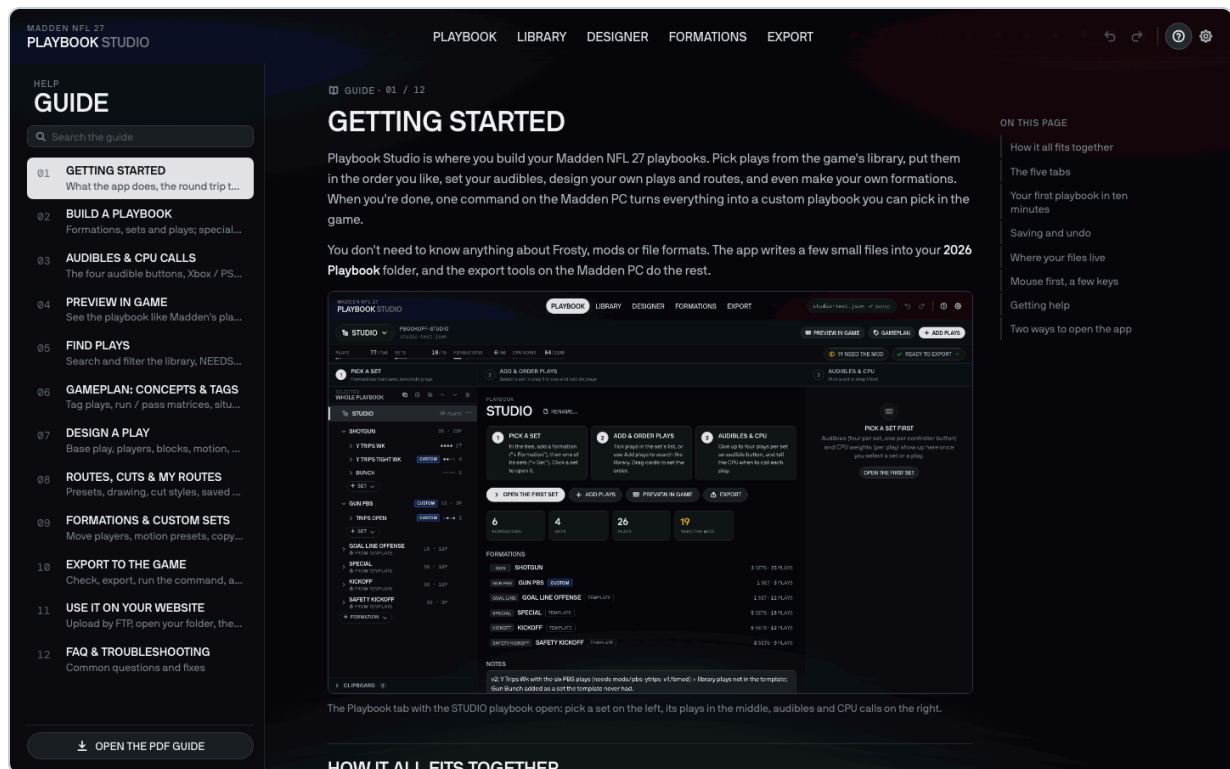
KEYS	DOES
⌘S / Ctrl+S	Save this file
⇧ ⌘S / Ctrl+Shift+S	Save all files
⌘Z / Ctrl+Z, ⇧ ⌘Z / Ctrl+Y	Undo, redo
⌘C, ⌘V, ⌘D (Ctrl on a PC)	Copy, paste, duplicate in the playbook tree and card grid
Delete / Backspace	Remove the selected play, or the selected route point in the designer
Esc	Close a dialog or menu, clear a selection
Enter	Confirm a dialog

CONTROLLER BUTTONS

You use the app with a mouse and keyboard. Controller buttons only show up for audibles, drawn as Xbox, PS5 or keyboard buttons. See [Audibles & CPU calls](#).

GETTING HELP

The ? at the top right opens this guide at the section for the screen you're on. Use the search box above the section list to find a word anywhere in the guide, and [Open the PDF guide](#) at the bottom for the printable version.



The guide inside the app: sections on the left, the page in the middle, its topics on the right.

TWO WAYS TO OPEN THE APP

- On your own computer: run `npm run dev` in the `app` folder and open `http://localhost:5178`.

- **From your website:** upload the app once and open it in Chrome or Edge from any computer, including the Madden PC. It asks you to open your `2026 Playbook` folder. See [Use it on your website](#).

Both work on the same files in the same way.

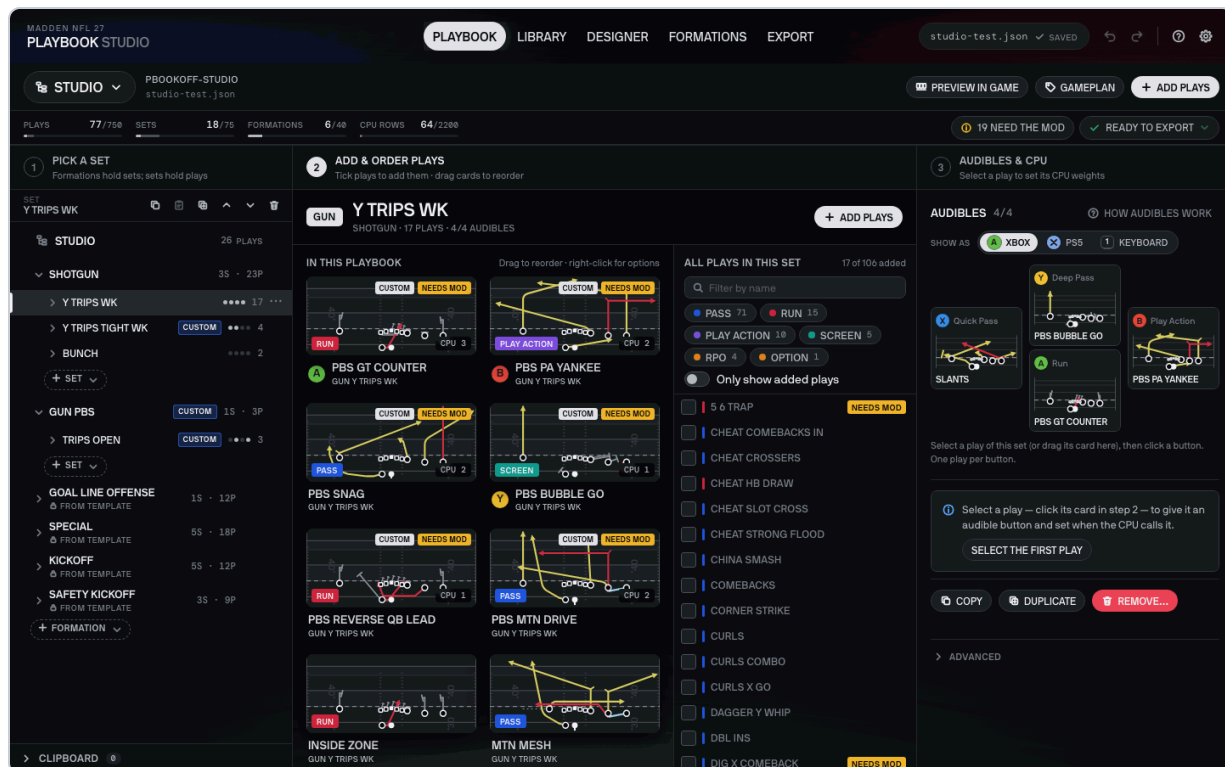
BUILD A PLAYBOOK

Formations, sets and plays; special teams; limits

OPEN, CREATE AND RENAME PLAYBOOKS · STEP 1: PICK A SET · STEP 2: ADD AND ORDER PLAYS · SPECIAL TEAMS AND GOAL LINE (TEMPLATE SECTIONS) · LIMITS AND CHECKS · PREVIEW IT LIKE THE GAME, AND PLAN YOUR GAMEPLAN · NOTES AND SIDE

A playbook is a list of **formations**, each formation holds **sets**, and each set holds **plays**, just like the FORMATION screen in Madden. One playbook file becomes one custom playbook in the game: `studio-test.json` with the name STUDIO becomes the save `PBOOKOFF-STUDIO`, and you pick it in the game as STUDIO.

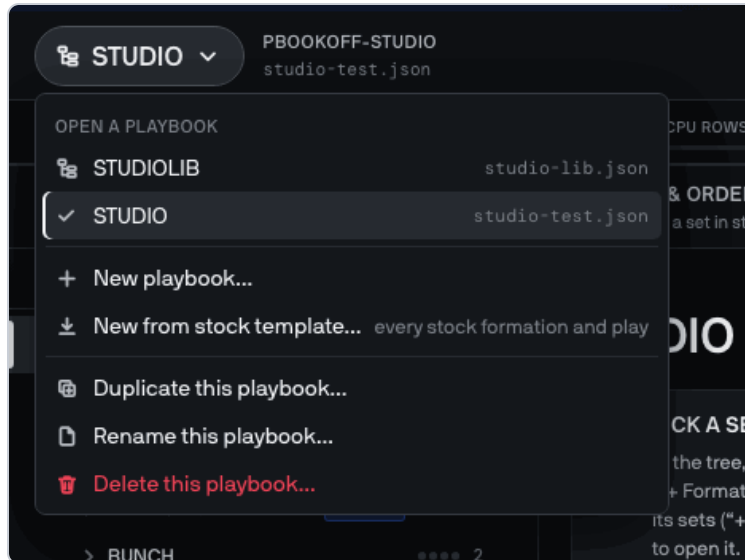
The PLAYBOOK tab works in three steps, left to right: 1 Pick a set, 2 Add & order plays, 3 Audibles & CPU.



STUDIO with the Y Trips Wk set open: the tree (1), the set's plays (2), and its audibles (3).

OPEN, CREATE AND RENAME PLAYBOOKS

The playbook menu at the top left (it shows the playbook's name, for example STUDIO) lists every playbook in your folder.



The playbook menu: open a playbook, start a new one, duplicate, rename or delete.

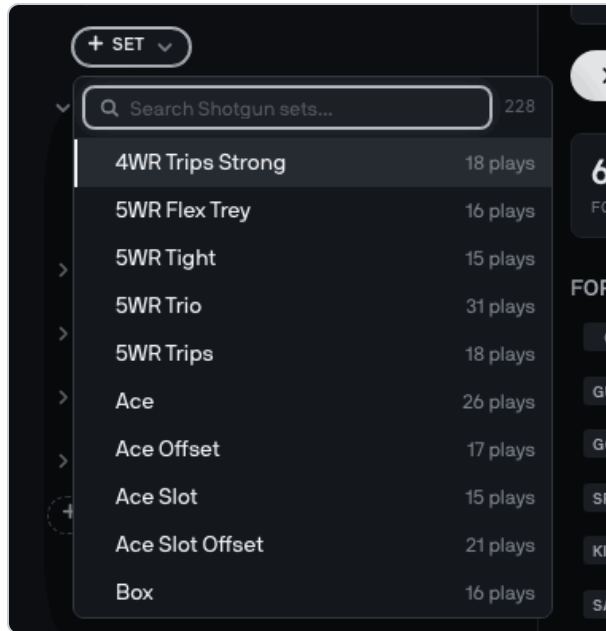
- Click a playbook to open it. STUDIO (`playbooks/studio-test.json`) opens the first time; after that the app reopens the one you used last.
- **New playbook...** starts an empty offense playbook with goal line and special teams already in it. Give it a name (letters A–Z and digits only; it becomes the in-game name).
- **New from stock template...** starts with every formation, set, play, audible and CPU weight of the game's stock playbook, ready to trim down.
- **Duplicate this playbook...** makes a copy to experiment with.
- **Rename this playbook...** changes the in-game name and the file name together.
- **Delete this playbook...** moves the file to `app-data/.trash/` ; nothing is lost for good.

Next to the menu you see the save name the game will use (`PBOOKOFF-STUDIO`) and the file (`studio-test.json`).

STEP 1: PICK A SET

The tree on the left shows the playbook: formations (SHOTGUN, GUN PBS...), and under each one its sets. The dots next to a set show how many audibles it has; the number is its play count.

1. Click a formation's arrow to open it, then **click a set** to work on it.
2. To add a formation, click **+ FORMATION** at the bottom of the tree and pick one from the list.
3. To add a set, click **+ SET** under the formation and pick a set. Type to search the list.



+ SET lists the formation's sets with their play counts; type to filter.

Drag formations and sets up and down the tree to reorder them. Your own sets (made in [Formations](#)) show a CUSTOM tag and appear in the + SET list like any other set.

STEP 2: ADD AND ORDER PLAYS

With a set selected, the middle column shows two lists:

- **IN THIS PLAYBOOK:** the set's plays as cards, in your order.
- **ALL PLAYS IN THIS SET:** every play the game (and you) have for this set, with a tick box each.

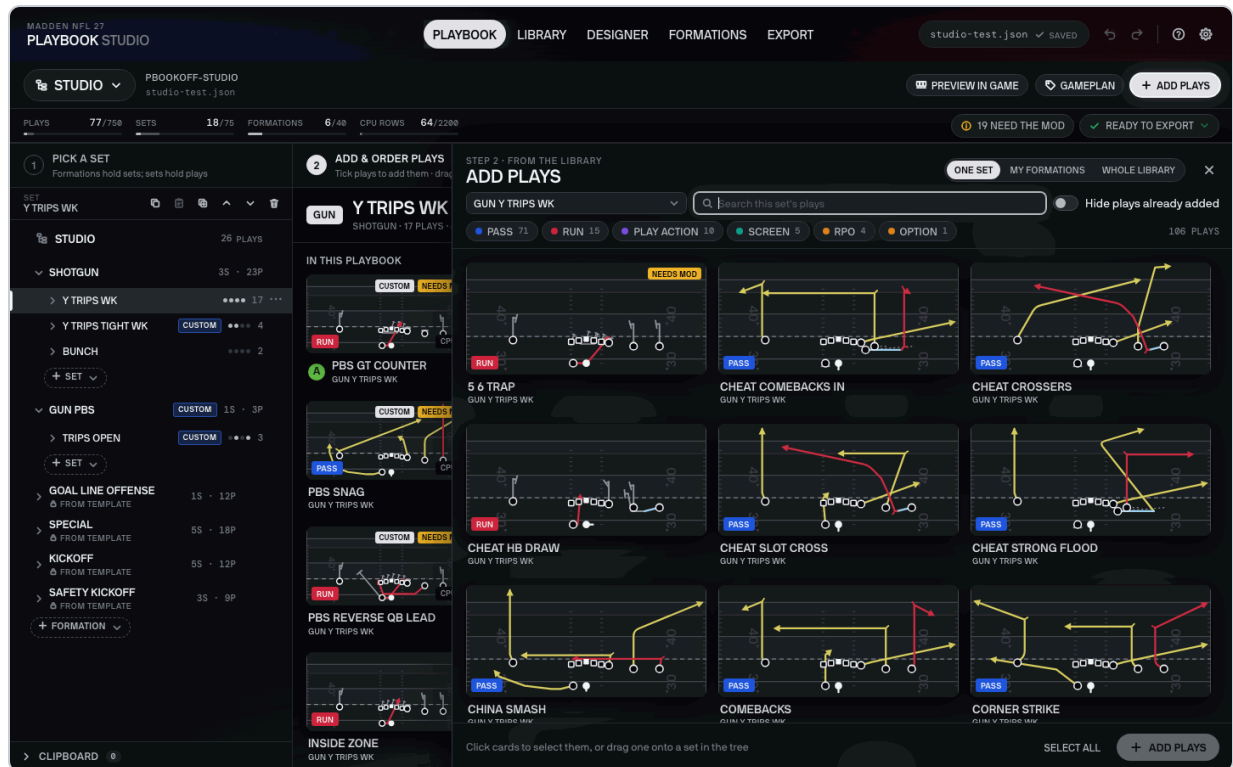
To add plays:

1. **Tick a play** in ALL PLAYS IN THIS SET. It's added at the end. Untick it to take it out again. Use the colored chips (PASS, RUN, PLAY ACTION, SCREEN...) and the filter box to narrow the list, or **Only show added plays**.
2. Or click **+ ADD PLAYS** to search beyond this set (next section).
3. Or, in the [Library](#), click **Add to playbook...** on any play.

To change the order, **drag the cards**. To remove a play, right-click its card and choose **Remove from playbook**, or select it and press **Delete**.

ADD PLAYS FROM ANYWHERE

+ ADD PLAYS opens a search drawer over the set.



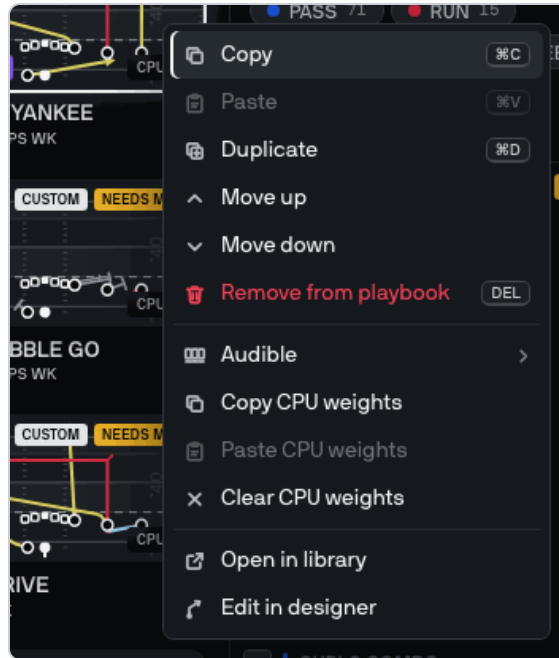
Add plays: search one set, every set of your formations, or the whole library.

1. Choose where to search: **One set**, **My formations** (every set of the formations in this playbook) or **Whole library**.
2. Type part of a play name, for example "mesh".
3. Click cards to select them, then click **Add N plays** at the bottom. Or drag one card straight onto a set in the tree.

Plays from a formation or set that isn't in the playbook yet bring their formation and set with them. **Hide plays already added** keeps the list short.

RIGHT-CLICK MENU

Right-click any card or tree row (or click its ... button) for everything you can do with it:



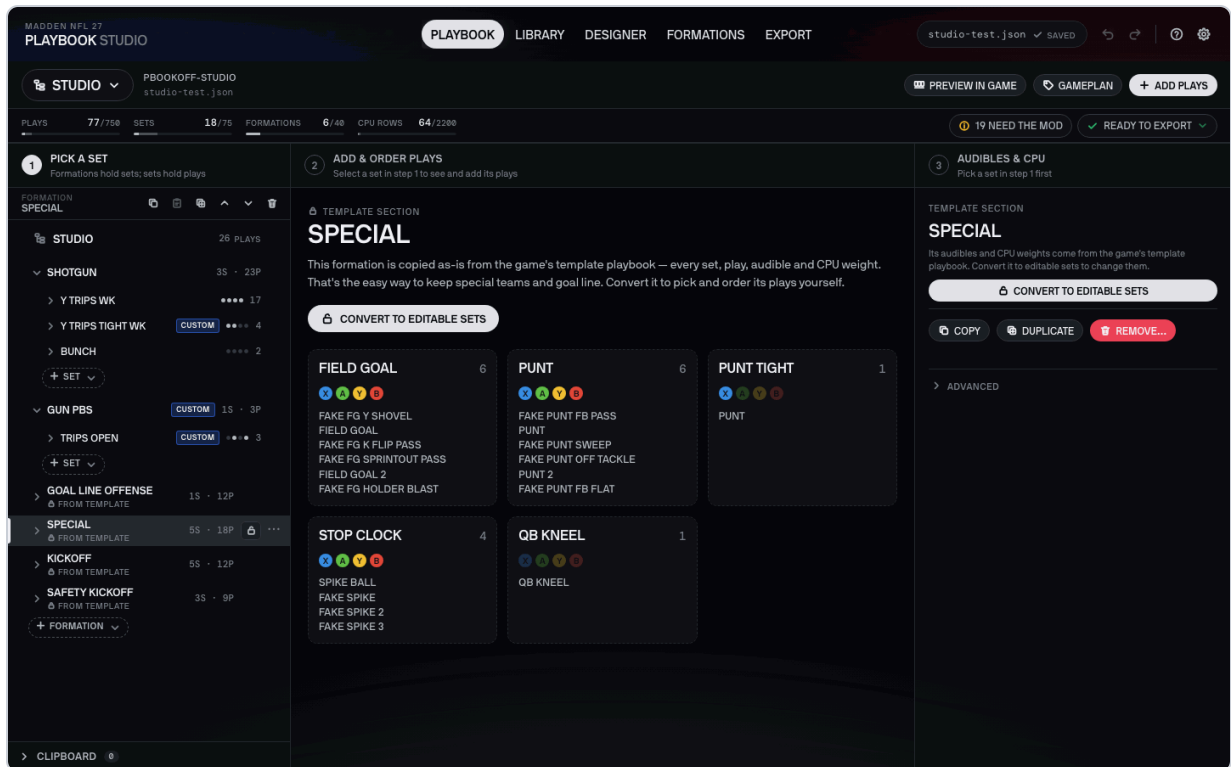
The play menu: copy, paste, duplicate, move, remove, audible, CPU weights, open in the library or the designer.

- **Copy, Paste, Duplicate** (also ⌘C, ⌘V, ⌘D). Copied plays, sets and formations wait in the **CLIPBOARD** panel at the bottom of the tree, so you can paste them into another set or another playbook.
- **Move up, Move down, Remove from playbook**.
- **Audible**: give the play an audible button (see [Audibles & CPU calls](#)).
- **Copy CPU weights, Paste CPU weights, Clear CPU weights**.
- **Open in library** shows the play's details; **Edit in designer** opens one of your own plays (it's only in the menu of plays you made; a play copied into one of your own sets offers **Edit its custom set** instead).

Select several plays with ⌘-click (Ctrl-click on a PC) or a range with Shift-click, then use the menu or the toolbar above the tree on all of them at once.

SPECIAL TEAMS AND GOAL LINE (TEMPLATE SECTIONS)

The last rows of the tree (GOAL LINE OFFENSE, SPECIAL, KICKOFF, SAFETY KICKOFF) have a **TEMPLATE** tag and a lock. They are copied exactly as they are from the game's stock playbook when you export, so your playbook always has kickoffs, punts, field goals and goal-line plays.



A template section (SPECIAL): its sets and plays come from the stock playbook.

- Click a template row to see what's in it.
- To change what's in it, click **Convert to editable sets** (the unlock button on the row). It becomes a normal formation you can edit.

⚠ KEEP SPECIAL TEAMS

Keep **Special**, **Kickoff** and **Safety Kickoff** in every offense playbook (as template sections or converted). Without them the game has no kicking plays to call.

LIMITS AND CHECKS

The bar under the playbook name counts what the game allows in one playbook:

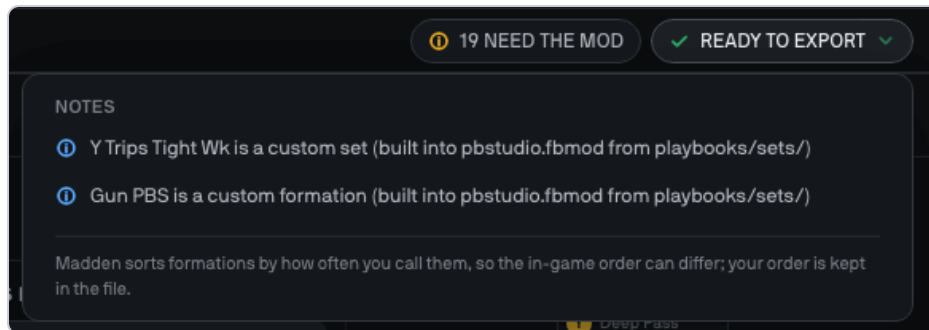


The playbook header: play, set, formation and CPU-row counts against the game's limits, plus the checks.

METER	LIMIT
PLAYS	750
SETS	75
FORMATIONS	40
CPU ROWS (CPU weights)	2,200

The counts include the template sections. On the right:

- **NEED THE MOD** counts your own plays and the stock plays the game hides from custom playbooks. Both work once the Playbook Studio mod is applied; see [NEEDS MOD](#).
- **READY TO EXPORT** (or the number of problems) opens the list of checks. Click a problem to jump to it.



The checks list for STUDIO: two notes, nothing blocking.

THE ORDER IN THE GAME

Madden sorts formations by how often you call them, and in testing the order of plays inside a set didn't always follow the file. Your order is still saved; it's what the preview and the file show.

PREVIEW IT LIKE THE GAME, AND PLAN YOUR GAMEPLAN

- **PREVIEW IN GAME** shows the playbook the way Madden's play-call screen does. See [Preview in game](#).
- **GAMEPLAN** opens your concepts and tags: what you have for each situation, run and pass concepts by formation. See [Gameplan](#). The **LIBRARY** has the same **GAMEPLAN** button.

NOTES AND SIDE

Click the playbook's name at the top of the tree (**STUDIO**) to see its overview: formations, sets and play counts, a **NOTES** box for yourself, and under **ADVANCED** whether it's an offense or defense playbook.

AUDIBLES & CPU CALLS

The four audible buttons, Xbox / PS5 glyphs, CPU weights

THE FOUR SLOTS · GIVE A PLAY AN AUDIBLE BUTTON · XBOX, PS5 OR KEYBOARD BUTTONS · IF YOUR GAME PUTS THEM ON OTHER BUTTONS · WHEN THE CPU CALLS A PLAY (CPU WEIGHTS) · SEE IT LIKE THE GAME

Every set in a playbook has **four audible slots**: the plays you can switch to at the line of scrimmage without going back to the play-call screen. This page also covers the **CPU weights**, which tell the computer when to call each play.

THE FOUR SLOTS

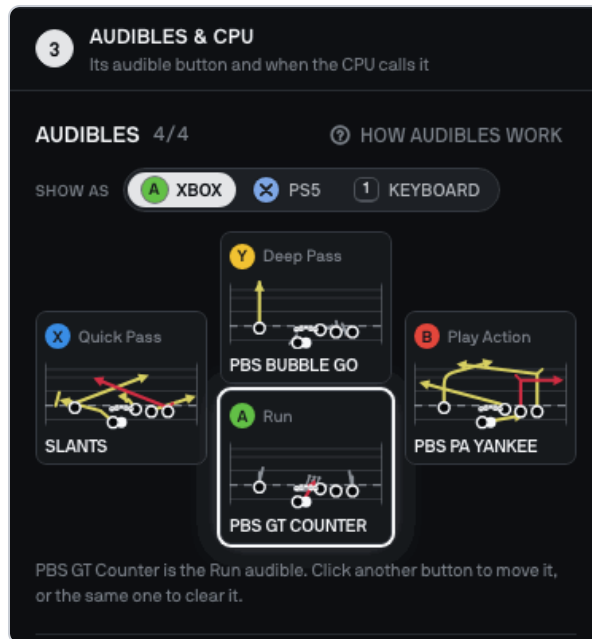
Madden's audible menu groups audibles by type. The usual layout, and how the app draws each slot:

SLOT	USUAL TYPE	XBOX	PS5	KEYBOARD
1	Quick pass	X	□	1
2	Run	A	×	2
3	Deep pass	Y	△	3
4	Play action	B	○	4

The slot type is a label, not a rule: you can put any play of the set on any slot. Stock playbooks follow it (quick passes such as Slants or Stick on slot 1, Inside Zone on slot 2, Four Verticals on slot 3, a PA pass on slot 4), so it's a good habit.

GIVE A PLAY AN AUDIBLE BUTTON

1. In **PLAYBOOK**, click a set in step 1 (for example **Y TRIPS WK**).
2. In step 2, click the **play's card**.
3. In step 3, click one of the four buttons in the audible diamond. The play's mini diagram and name appear on the button.



The audible diamond for Y Trips Wk: Slants on X, PBS GT Counter on A, PBS Bubble Go on Y, PBS PA Yankee on B.

Other ways to do the same:

- Drag a card from step 2 onto a button.
- Right-click a card → Audible → pick a slot (for example 1 • Quick Pass).

To **move** a play to another button, select it and click the other button. To **clear** a button, click the small x on it, or select the play and click its own button again. Each button holds one play; giving a button to a new play takes it away from the old one. The dots next to each set in the tree show how many of its four slots are used.

✦ PICK AUDIBLES YOU'LL ACTUALLY CHECK TO

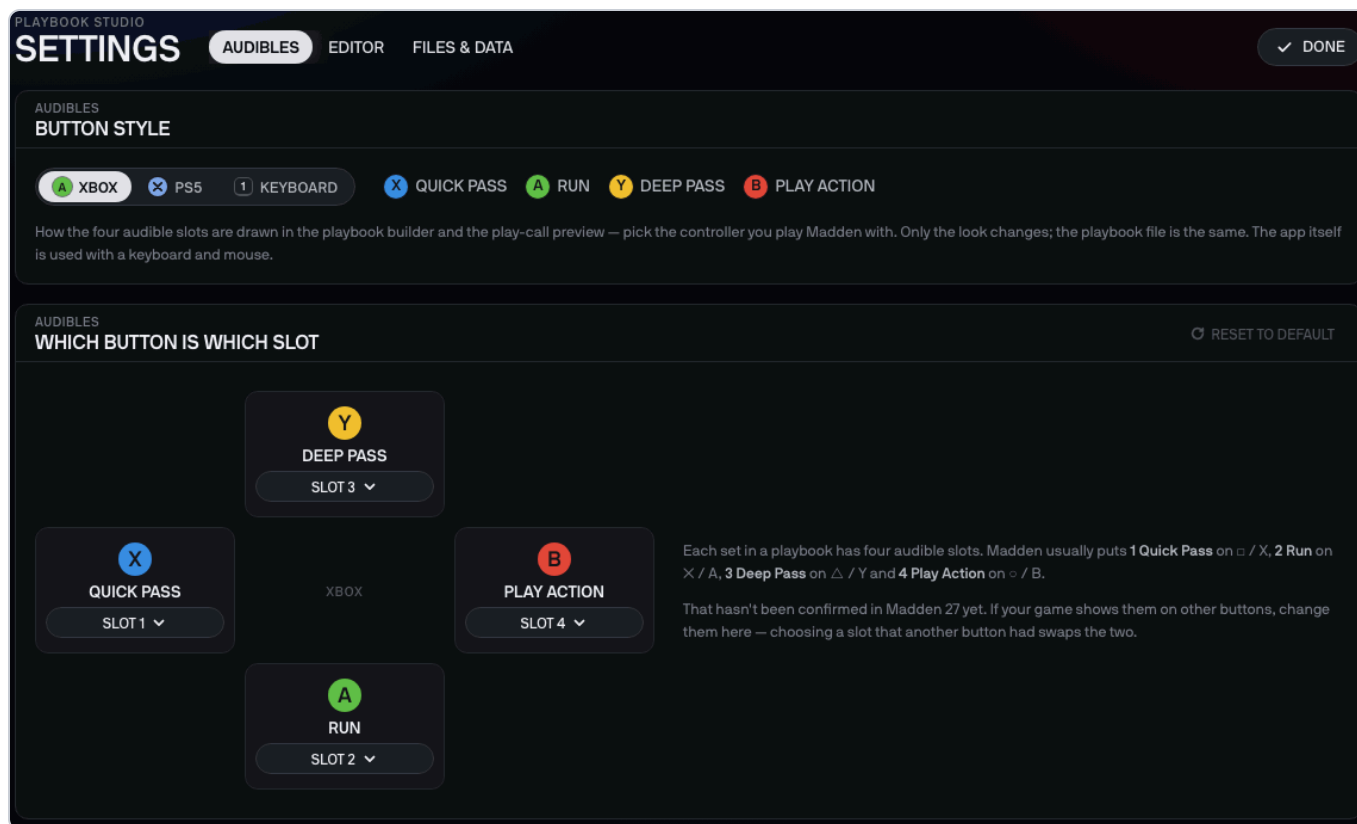
A good set of audibles answers what the defense shows you: a quick pass against press or blitz, a run against a light box, a shot play against single-high, and a play action that looks like your run.

XBOX, PS5 OR KEYBOARD BUTTONS

You play Madden on a controller, so the app draws the audible buttons the way your controller shows them. Use the **SHOW AS** switch above the diamond (XBOX, PS5, KEYBOARD), or **Settings** → **Audibles** → **Button style**. Xbox is the default.

This only changes how the buttons are drawn in the app. The playbook file stores the slot number (1 to 4), so the same playbook works with any controller.

IF YOUR GAME PUTS THEM ON OTHER BUTTONS



Settings → Audibles: the button style, and which button shows which slot.

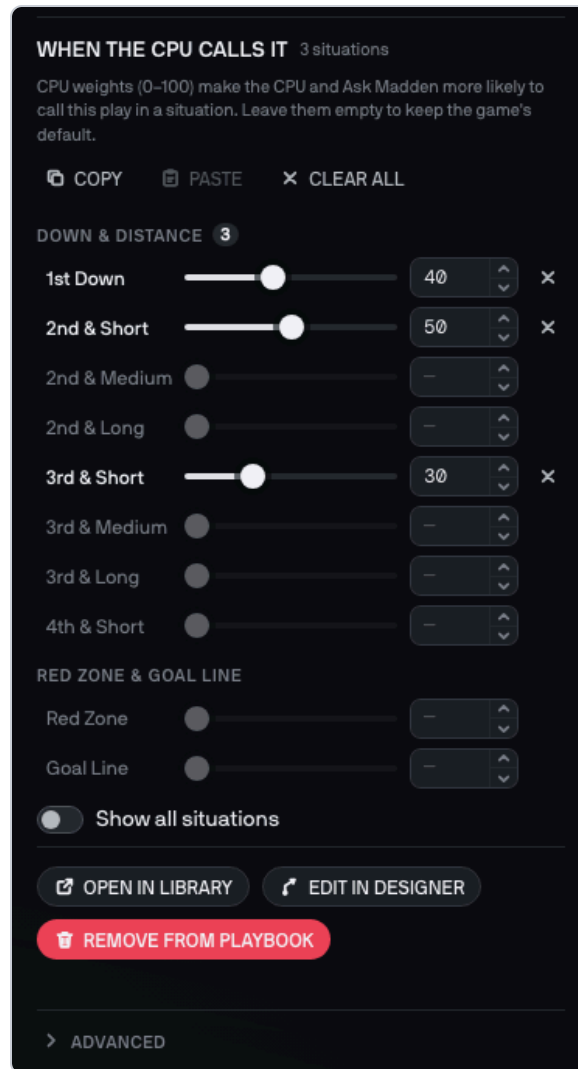
Open **Settings** (the gear at the top right) → **Audibles** → **Which button is which slot**. Each button has a slot menu; choosing a slot another button had swaps the two. **Reset to default** puts back X = 1, A = 2, Y = 3, B = 4.

⚠ CHECK THIS ONCE IN MADDEN 27

The default layout above was worked out from the game's stock playbooks; it hasn't been confirmed in Madden 27 yet. After your first export, open your playbook in the game, call a play from a set with audibles, and press the audible button at the line. If Madden shows a slot on a different button than the app, change it here so the app matches your game. Your playbooks don't change.

WHEN THE CPU CALLS A PLAY (CPU WEIGHTS)

Below the audibles, a selected play shows **When the CPU calls it**: a slider from 0 to 100 for each game situation. Higher means the computer (and Ask Madden suggestions) is more likely to call this play in that situation. Leave a situation empty to keep the game's default.



CPU weights for PBS GT Counter: 1st Down 40, 2nd & Short 50, 3rd & Short 30.

1. Select a play in step 2.
2. Drag a slider, or type a number. The x next to a row clears it.
3. The common situations (down and distance, red zone, goal line) are shown first. **Show all situations** lists the rest (two-minute, kneel, fake punt, go for 2...).

To give several plays the same weights:

1. Select the play that has them and click **Copy** (or right-click → **Copy CPU weights**).
2. Select one or more other plays (⌘-click or Shift-click to select several) and click **Paste** (or right-click → **Paste CPU weights**).

Clear all removes a play's weights. Every weight is one "CPU row"; a playbook can hold 2,200 of them (the CPU ROWS meter at the top).

SEE IT LIKE THE GAME

The AUDIBLES tab of [Preview in game](#) shows each set's audibles the way Madden's play-call screen does.

PREVIEW IN GAME

See the playbook like Madden's play-call screen

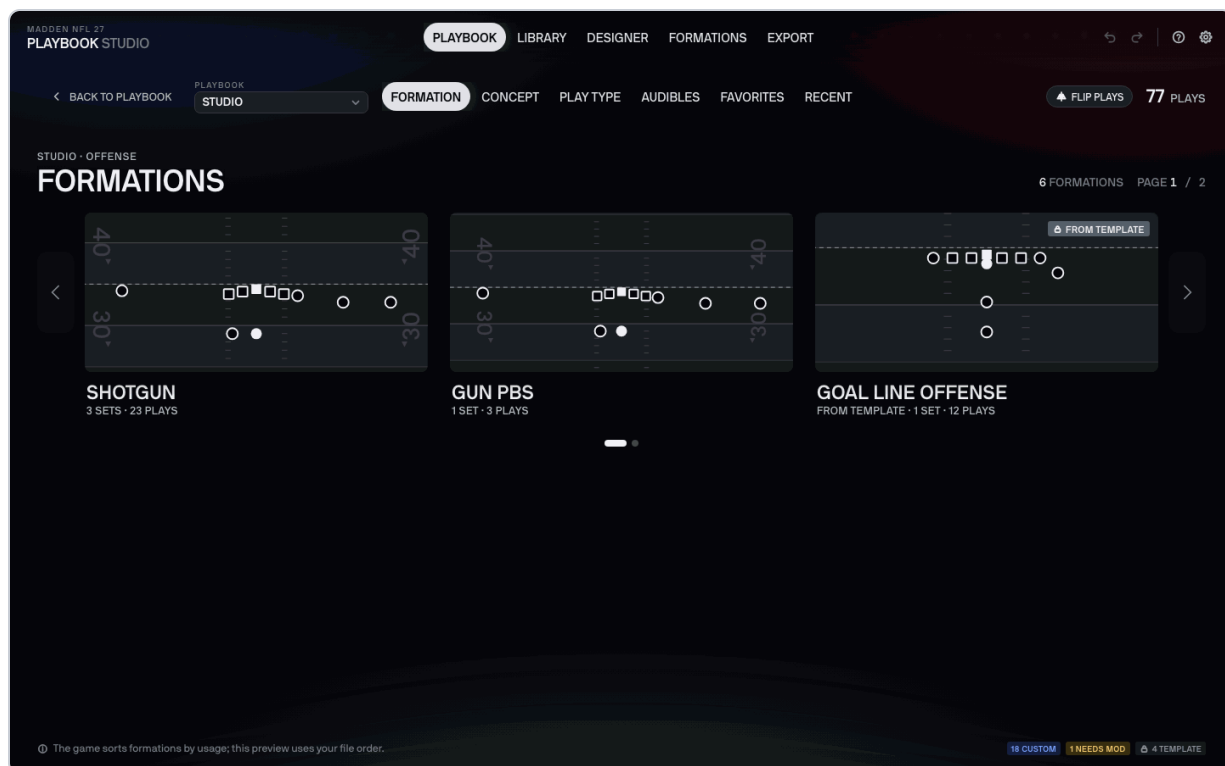
OPEN THE PREVIEW · MOVE AROUND · THE TABS · WHAT THE TAGS MEAN

PREVIEW IN GAME shows a playbook the way Madden's play-call screen does: big cards, three at a time, with the same **FORMATION**, **CONCEPT** and **PLAY TYPE** tabs. Use it to see how your playbook will feel to call from, before you export.

OPEN THE PREVIEW

1. In **PLAYBOOK**, open the playbook you want to see.
2. Click **PREVIEW IN GAME** at the top right.

The **PLAYBOOK** menu at the top left of the preview switches to another playbook. **BACK TO PLAYBOOK** returns to the editor. The preview always shows your file order; Madden sorts formations by how often you call them, so the game's order can differ.

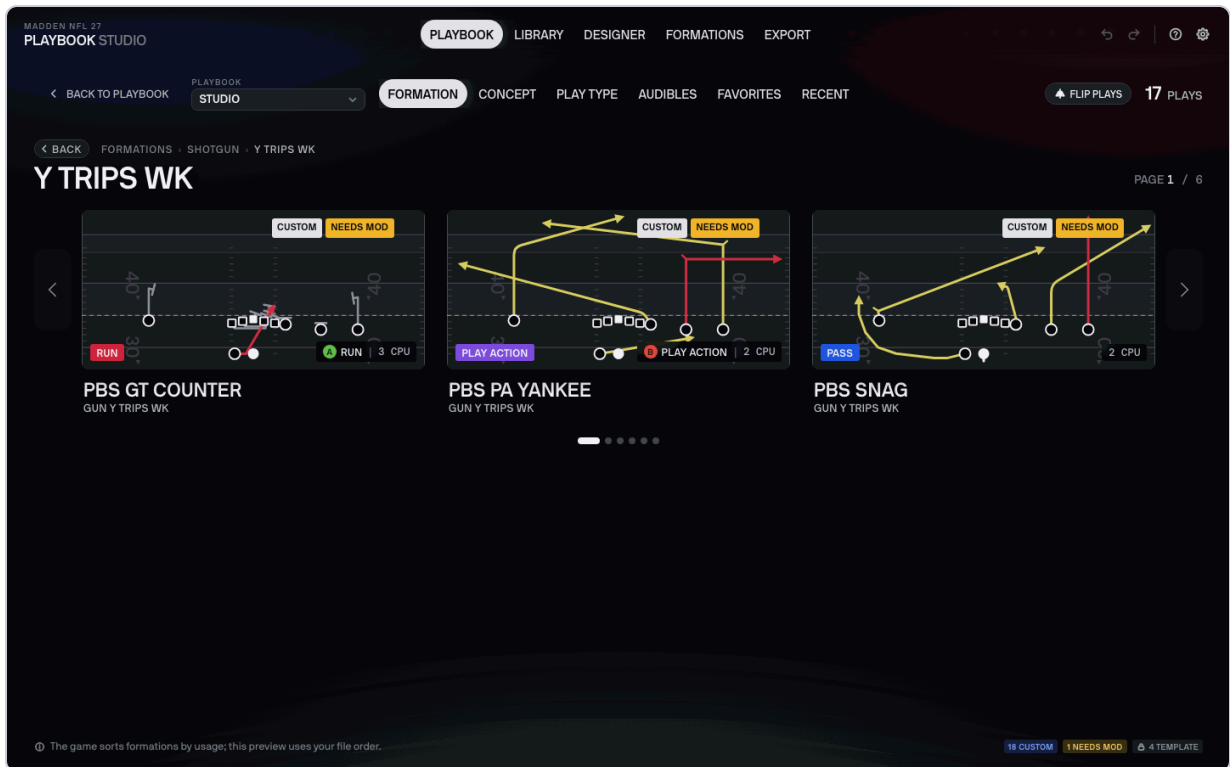


*The **FORMATION** tab: one card per formation, three per page.*

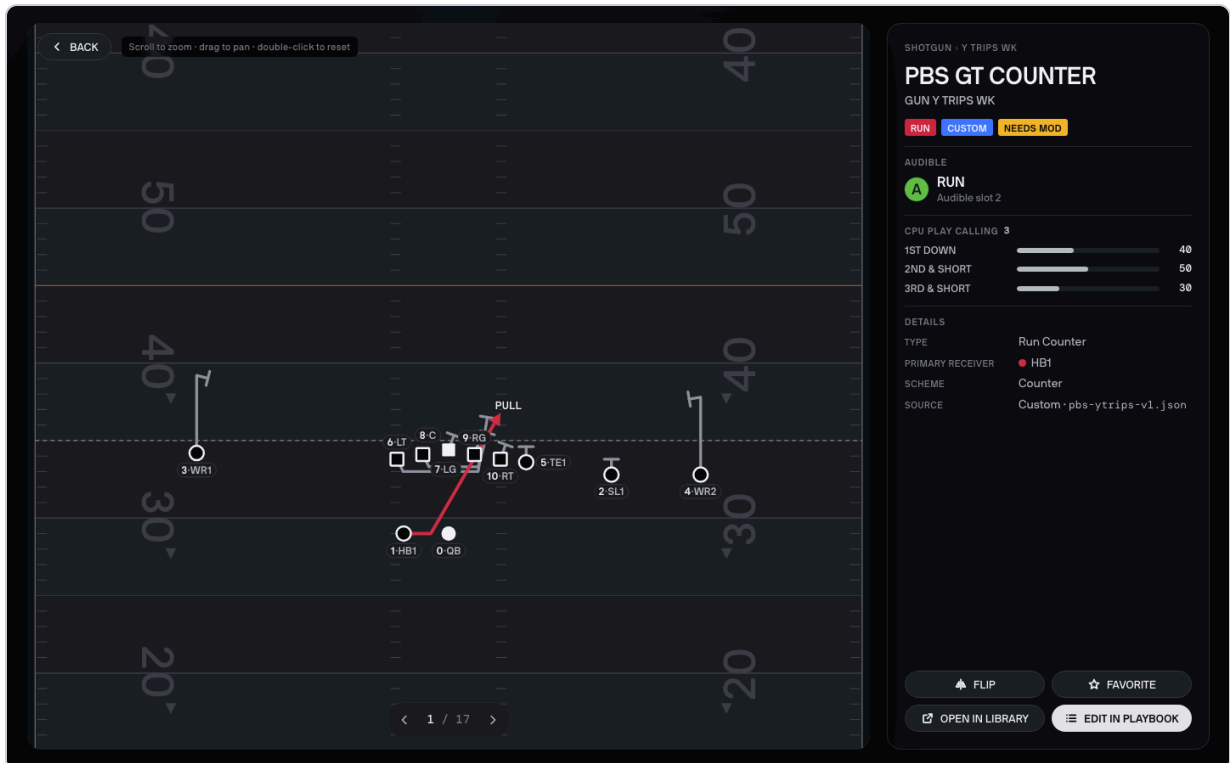
MOVE AROUND

- Click a card to open it: a formation shows its sets, a set shows its plays.
- < and > (or the mouse wheel, or the dots under the cards) turn the page.

- **BACK** and the path above the title (FORMATIONS › SHOTGUN › Y TRIPS WK) go back up.
- Click a play to see it full screen before the snap, as you would after calling it.



The plays of Y Trips Wk. Each card shows its audible button and how many CPU weights it has.

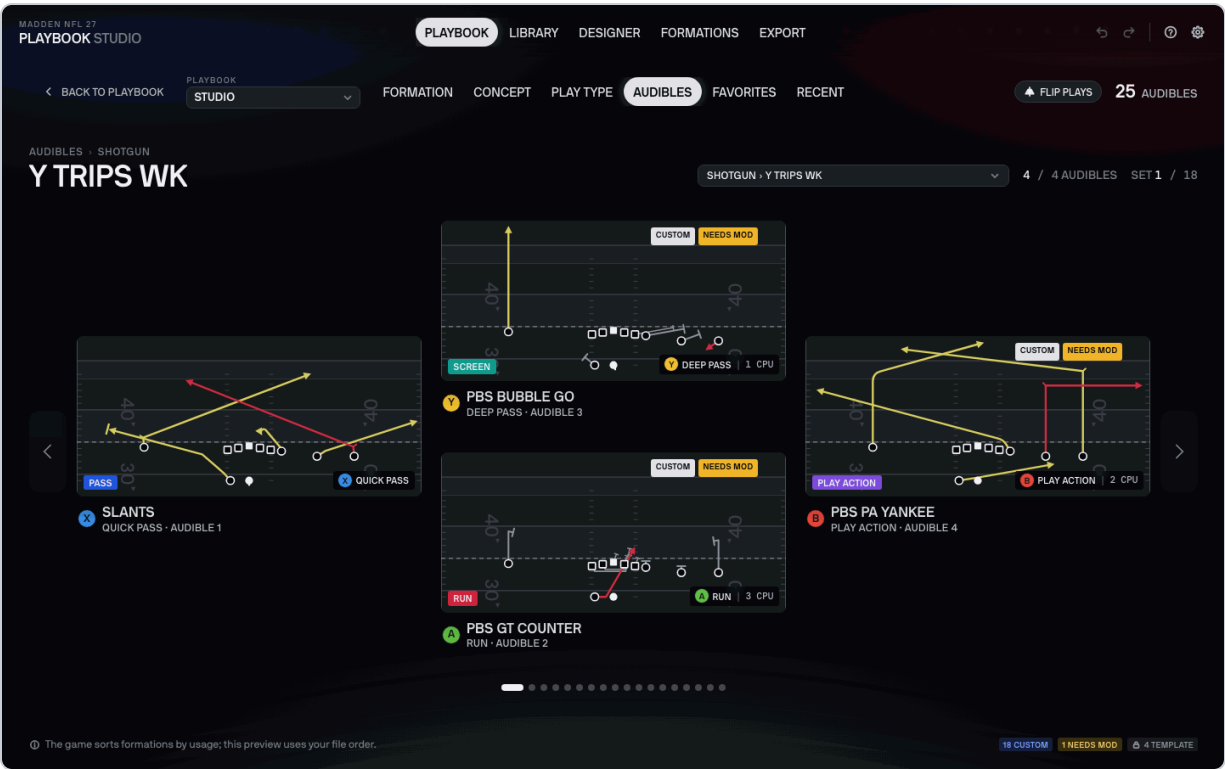


A play opened from the preview: the pre-snap view with its details on the right.

THE TABS

TAB	SHOWS
FORMATION	Formations → sets → plays, in your file order
CONCEPT	Plays grouped by concept: your Gameplan categories and the game's own read concepts (Mesh, Smash...)
PLAY TYPE	Plays grouped by type: pass, run, play action, screen, RPO, option
AUDIBLES	Each set's four audibles on the controller diamond
FAVORITES	Plays you starred (the ☆ on a card)
RECENT	Plays you opened recently

FLIP PLAYS shows every play mirrored, like flipping a play in the game. The counter at the top right shows how many plays the playbook has.



The AUDIBLES tab: one set's audibles, drawn on your controller's buttons.

WHAT THE TAGS MEAN

- **CUSTOM:** your own play, or a play in one of your own sets. It needs the mod.
- **NEEDS MOD:** a stock play the game normally hides from custom playbooks. The mod adds it back.
- **TEMPLATE:** a section copied from the stock playbook (special teams, goal line).

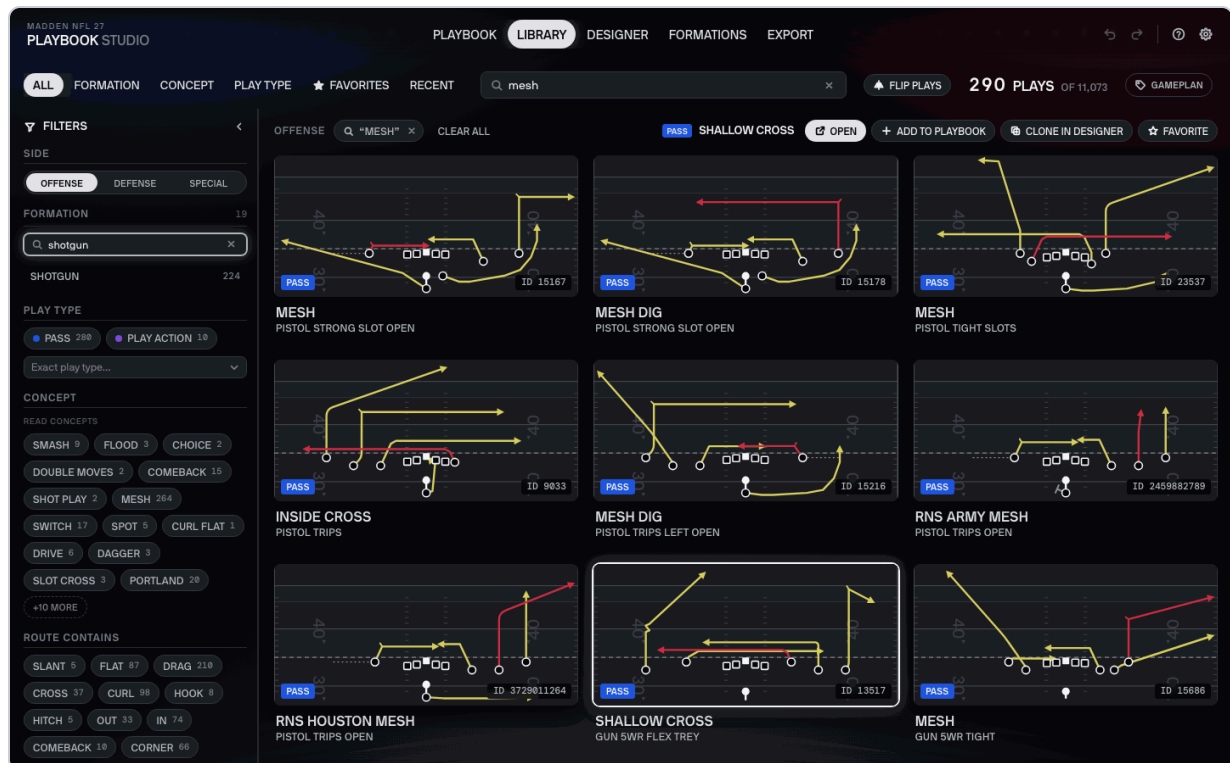
The counts at the bottom right add these up for the whole playbook.

FIND PLAYS

Search and filter the library, NEEDS MOD, add to a playbook

SEARCH AND FILTER · READING A PLAY CARD · LOOK AT A PLAY · ADD A PLAY TO A PLAYBOOK · USE A PLAY AS THE START OF YOUR OWN

The **LIBRARY** holds every play in Madden NFL 27 (about 11,000, offense, defense and special teams) plus the plays you made yourself. Find a play here, look at what every player does, then add it to a playbook or use it as the start of your own play.



Searching for "mesh" in Shotgun: the filters on the left, the results as play cards.

SEARCH AND FILTER

1. Type in the **search box** at the top: a play name ("mesh", "four verticals"), a concept or a formation.
2. Narrow it down with the **FILTERS** on the left:
 - **SIDE:** offense, defense or special teams.
 - **FORMATION:** type to find a formation (Shotgun, Pistol, Singleback...), then pick a set under it.
 - **PLAY TYPE:** pass, run, play action, screen, RPO, option.
 - **CONCEPT:** your own [Gameplan](#) categories and the game's read concepts (Smash, Flood, Mesh...).
 - **ROUTE CONTAINS:** plays with a slant, a wheel, a double move...
 - **AVAILABILITY:** plays that work without the mod, or plays that need it.

- **SOURCE:** stock plays or your own (custom) plays.

3. The active filters show as chips above the results. Click a chip's x to drop it, or **CLEAR ALL**.

The tabs at the top left browse the library a different way: **ALL**, by **FORMATION**, **CONCEPT** or **PLAY TYPE**, your **FAVORITES** (star a play to add it) and **RECENT** plays. **FLIP PLAYS** mirrors every diagram, and **GAMEPLAN** at the top right opens your [concepts and tags](#).

✦ **HIDE THE DRILLS**

Madden's minigame and drill formations are hidden by default. To see them, turn off **Hide minigame formations** in **Settings** → **Editor**.

READING A PLAY CARD

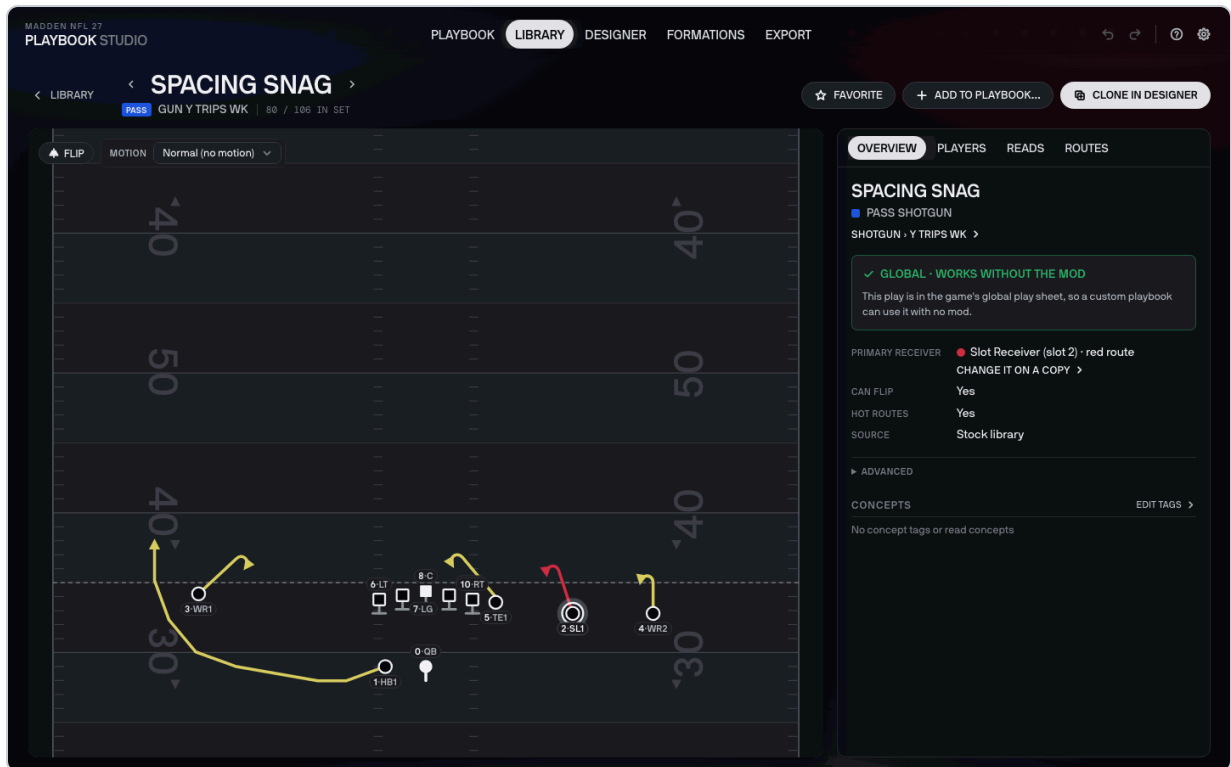
ON THE CARD	MEANS
Yellow line	A route
Red line	The primary receiver (the red route), or the ball carrier on a run
Gray line ending in a T	A block
Light blue line	Pre-snap motion
White line from the QB	The QB's drop, rollout or handoff
Corner shapes	How the receiver cuts; see cuts
PASS, RUN, PLAY ACTION, SCREEN, RPO, OPTION	The play type
CUSTOM	A play you made
NEEDS MOD	See below

NEEDS MOD

A custom playbook can normally only use the plays in the game's "global" play list; Madden quietly drops the others. Plays with a **NEEDS MOD** tag aren't on that list. You can still use them: the export adds them to the Playbook Studio mod automatically, so they work once the mod is applied. Your own plays and sets always need the mod too.

LOOK AT A PLAY

Click a card to select it (it gets a white outline). The bar above the cards then names the play and offers **OPEN**, **ADD TO PLAYBOOK**, **CLONE IN DESIGNER** and **FAVORITE**. **Double-click** a card (or click **OPEN**) to open the play.

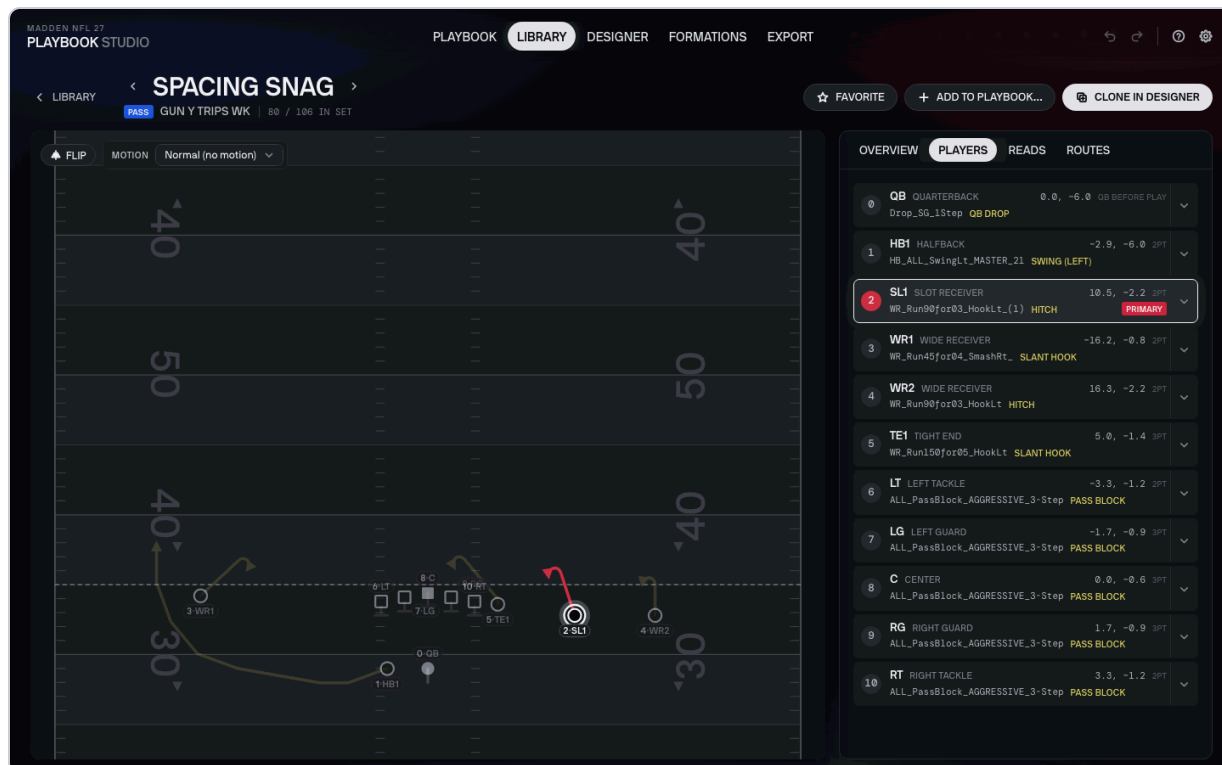


A play opened from the library: the field on the left, four tabs on the right.

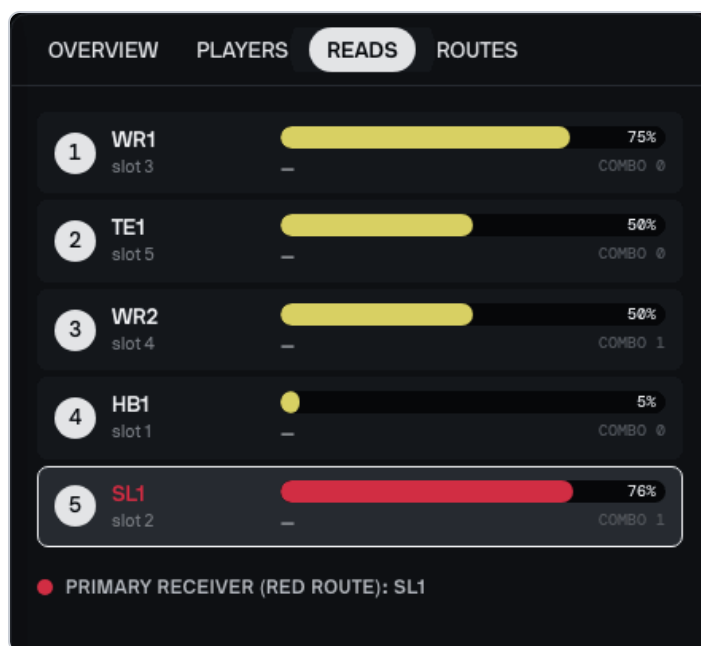
- < and > next to the name step through the other plays in your results.
- FLIP mirrors the play; the MOTION menu shows it with one of the set's pre-snap motions.
- Click a player on the field to highlight what he does.

The four tabs on the right:

TAB	SHOWS
OVERVIEW	Play type, formation and set, whether it needs the mod, the primary receiver, whether it can be flipped, and its concept tags
PLAYERS	Every player with his assignment (route, block, run path)
READS	The QB's read order with the percentage for each receiver; the primary receiver is the red one
ROUTES	Every route the game has, drawn from the selected player's spot (see below)



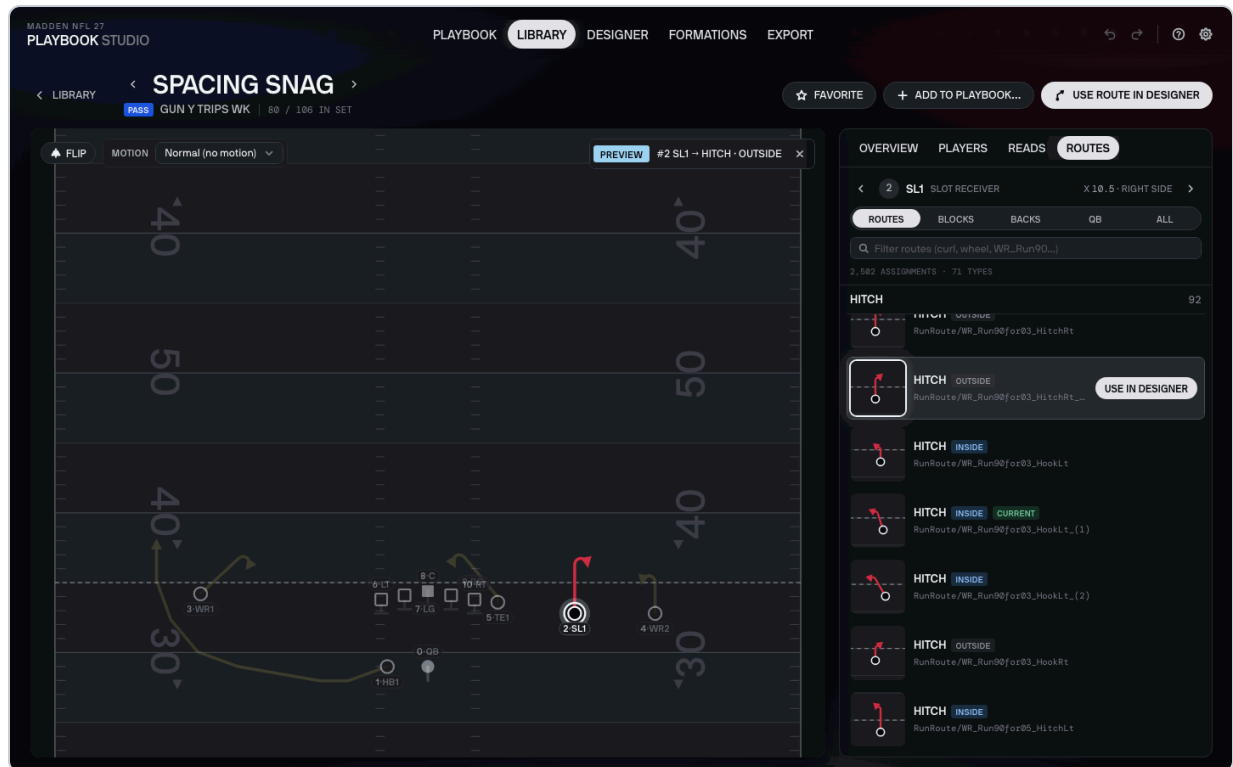
The PLAYERS tab: each player and his assignment.



The READS tab: the progression, with the primary receiver in red.

TRY OTHER ROUTES FOR A PLAYER (ROUTES TAB)

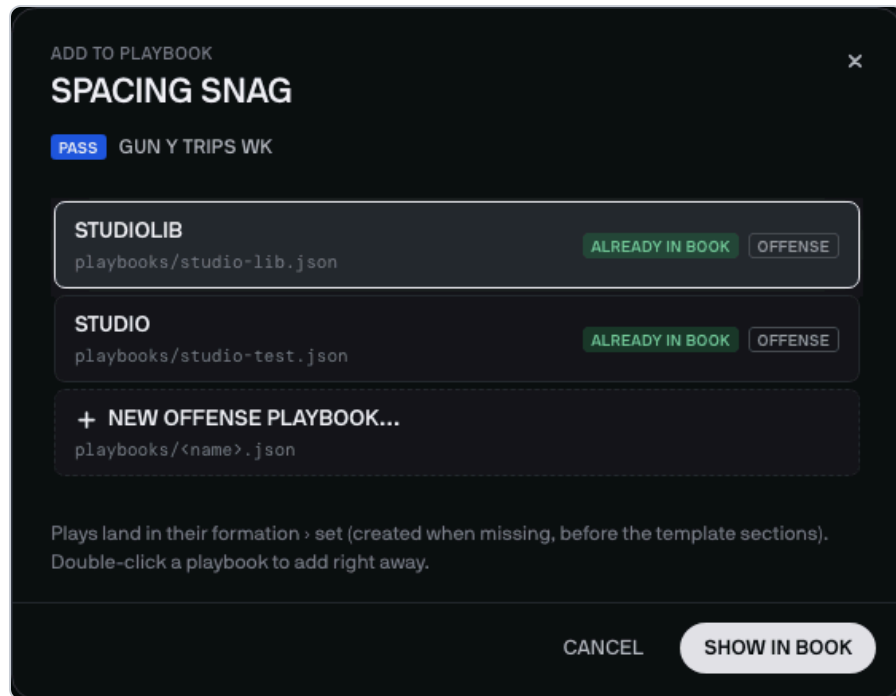
1. Click a player on the field (for example the slot, 2 SL1).
2. Open ROUTES. You see every route in the game for that spot, grouped by type (Hitch, Curl, Post...). ROUTES, BLOCKS, BACKS, QB and ALL switch the kind of assignment; the filter box finds one by name.
3. Click a route to preview it on the field (a PREVIEW chip appears above the field).
4. Click USE IN DESIGNER to start a new play from this one with that route on that player.



Previewing a hitch for the slot receiver in the ROUTES tab.

ADD A PLAY TO A PLAYBOOK

1. Click **ADD TO PLAYBOOK...** (on the play, or in the bar after selecting a card).
2. Pick the playbook. Plays already in a playbook say **ALREADY IN BOOK** (the button then reads **SHOW IN BOOK** and takes you to it).
3. Click **ADD** (or double-click the playbook). **NEW OFFENSE PLAYBOOK...** creates a new one on the spot.



Add to playbook: pick which playbook gets the play.

The play goes into its own formation and set in that playbook; if the playbook doesn't have them yet, they're added (before the special-teams sections). A message with an **Open** link takes you there. Remember to save the playbook (⌘S).

USE A PLAY AS THE START OF YOUR OWN

CLONE IN DESIGNER opens the [Designer](#) with this play as the base: same formation, same set, same handoffs and protection. Change the routes, blocks, motion and the red route there.

You can't edit a game play in place. Your changes always become a new play with its own name, so the original stays in the game untouched.

GAMEPLAN: CONCEPTS & TAGS

Tag plays, run / pass matrices, situations

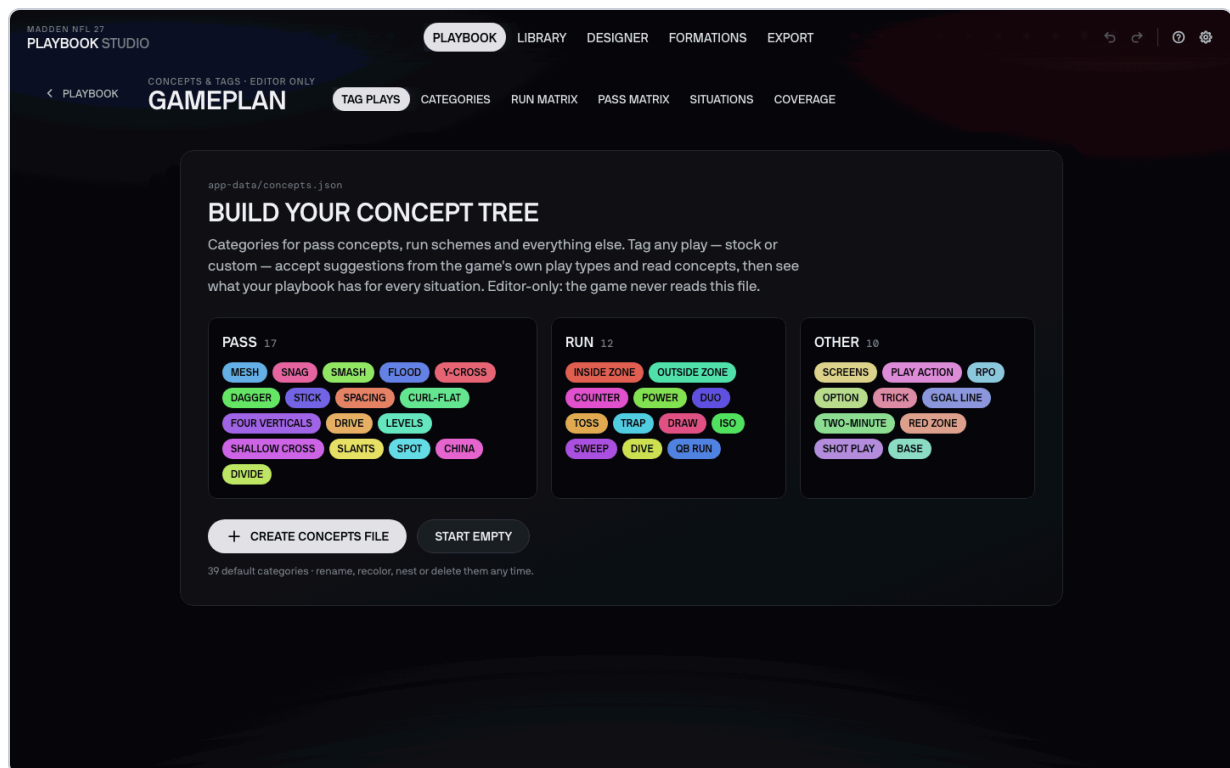
START YOUR CONCEPT LIST · TAG YOUR PLAYS (TAG PLAYS) · MANAGE CATEGORIES (CATEGORIES) · CHECK YOUR GAMEPLAN

The **Gameplan** screen helps you plan a playbook like a coach: sort plays into your own concepts (Mesh, Snag, Inside Zone, Two-minute...), then check what you have for each formation and each situation. Tags live only in the app (`app-data/concepts.json`); the game never sees them.

Open it with the **GAMEPLAN** button at the top right of the **PLAYBOOK** tab or of the **LIBRARY**. The back link at the top left takes you back to where you came from.

START YOUR CONCEPT LIST

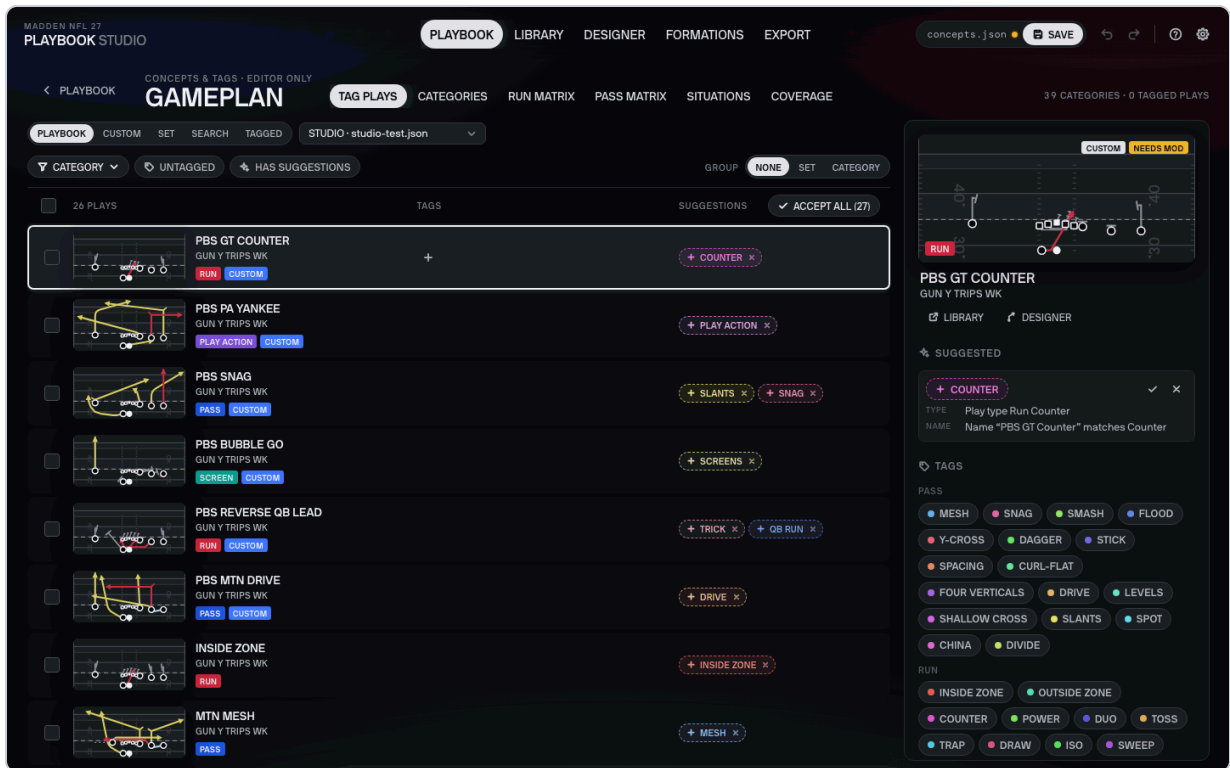
The first time, the app offers a ready-made list.



The first visit: create the concepts file with 39 ready-made categories, or start empty.

1. Click **CREATE CONCEPTS FILE** for 39 common categories in three groups: **PASS** (Mesh, Snag, Smash, Flood, Y-Cross, Dagger, Stick...), **RUN** (Inside Zone, Outside Zone, Counter, Power...) and **OTHER** (Screens, Play Action, RPO, Two-minute, Red Zone, Shot Play...). Or click **START EMPTY**.
2. Press **⌘S** / **Ctrl+S** (or **SAVE** at the top right). The file isn't written until you save.

TAG YOUR PLAYS (TAG PLAYS)



TAG PLAYS: your playbook's plays as rows, with suggested tags on the right of each row and the tag list for the selected play.

1. Choose which plays to list: **PLAYBOOK** (pick one in the menu next to it; it starts on the playbook you used last), **CUSTOM** (your plays), **SET**, **SEARCH** or **TAGGED**.
2. Click a row. The panel on the right shows the play and every category as a chip: click a chip to tag the play, click it again to remove the tag.
3. The **SUGGESTIONS** column proposes tags from the play's type, its read concept, its routes and its name. Click a suggestion to accept it, its x to dismiss it, or **ACCEPT ALL** for every suggestion in the list. Nothing is tagged until you accept it.
4. To tag many plays at once, tick their boxes, then click a category in the right-hand panel.
5. Save with **⌘S** / **Ctrl+S** (or **SAVE** at the top right) when you're done.

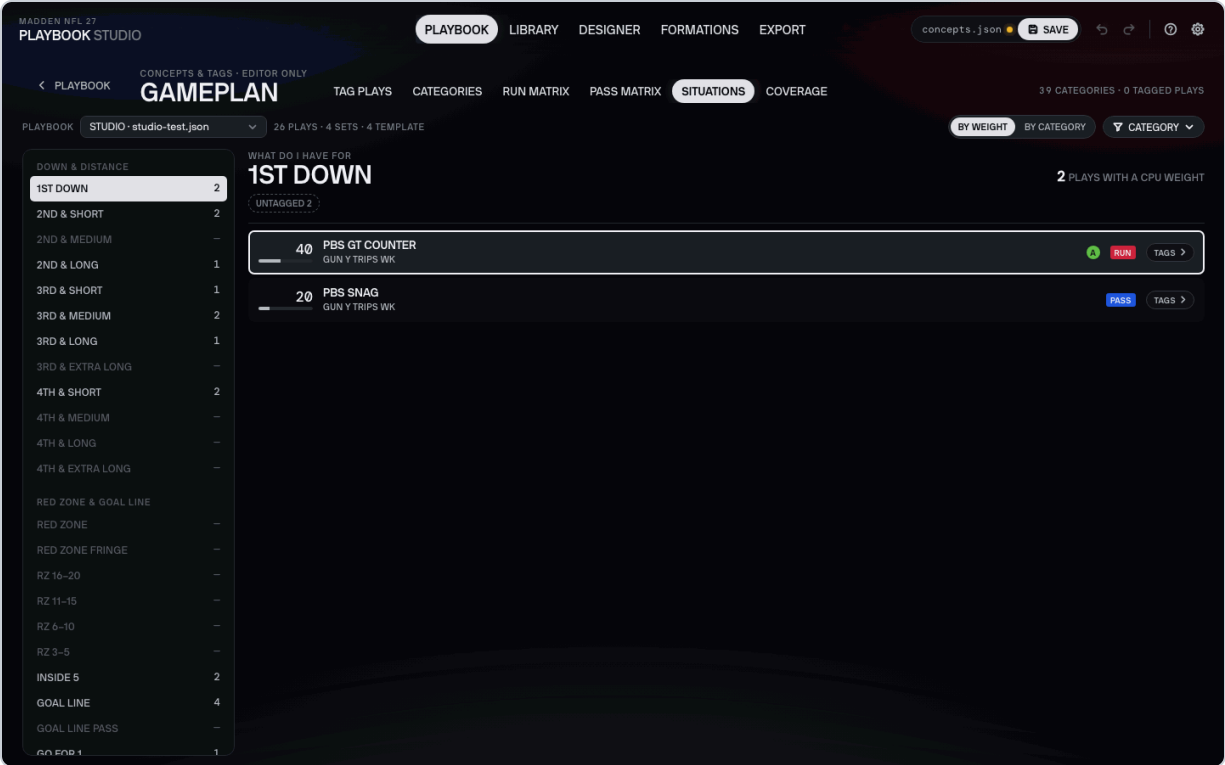
UNTAGGED and **HAS SUGGESTIONS** filter the list; **GROUP** sorts rows by set or category. Each play can also have a note.

MANAGE CATEGORIES (CATEGORIES)

Add a category, rename it, give it a color, drag it onto another to nest it (for example "Mesh Rail" under "Mesh"), move it between **PASS**, **RUN** and **OTHER**, or delete it (its tags are removed from every play).

CHECK YOUR GAMEPLAN

TAB	ANSWERS
RUN MATRIX	Which run concepts you have in which formation, with the gaps highlighted
PASS MATRIX	The same for pass concepts
SITUATIONS	What you have for each situation (1st down, 3rd & short, red zone, two-minute...), using the plays' CPU weights. Template sections count too
COVERAGE	How many plays each category has in the playbook



SITUATIONS: the plays STUDIO would call on 1st down, by CPU weight.

Your categories also show up as filters in the [Library](#) (FILTERS → CONCEPT) and as the CONCEPT tab of [Preview in game](#).

DESIGN A PLAY

Base play, players, blocks, motion, the red route

START A NEW PLAY · THE EDITOR · EDIT A PLAYER · BLOCKING · MOTION · THE PRIMARY RECEIVER (RED ROUTE) · WHERE PLAYERS LINE UP (FIXED STARTING SPOTS) · CHANGE THE BASE PLAY LATER · SAVE, ADD TO A PLAYBOOK, RENAME · ADVANCED (RARELY NEEDED)

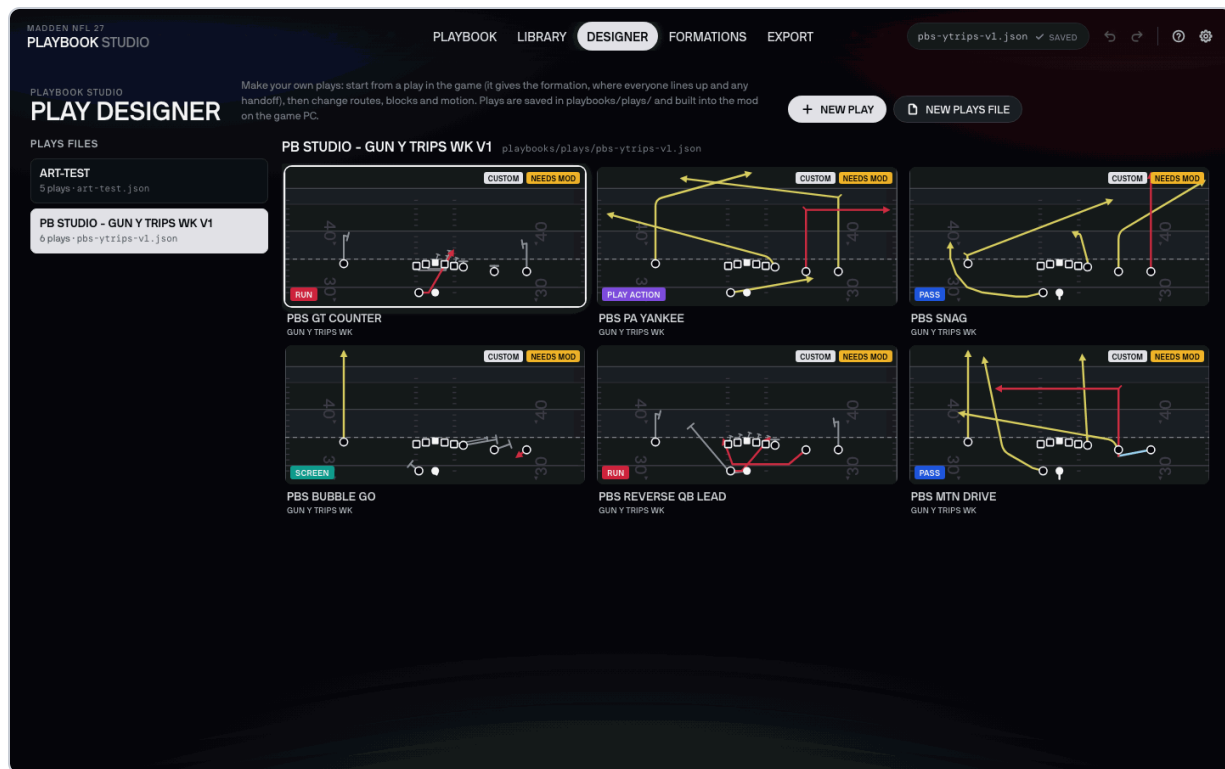
The **DESIGNER** makes your own plays. Every custom play starts from a **base play**: a play the game already has in the same set. You keep what you like and change the rest: routes, cuts, blocks, motion and who gets the red route.

WHY A BASE PLAY?

The base play supplies the things that have to match the game exactly: where everyone lines up, the handoff, play-action fake or option between the QB and the ball carrier, the pass protection and the QB's reads. Starting from a play that already works in the game keeps your play working too. Pick the base that's closest to what you want: for a run, the blocking scheme you want (Inside Zone, Power, Counter...); for a play-action pass, a PA play.

START A NEW PLAY

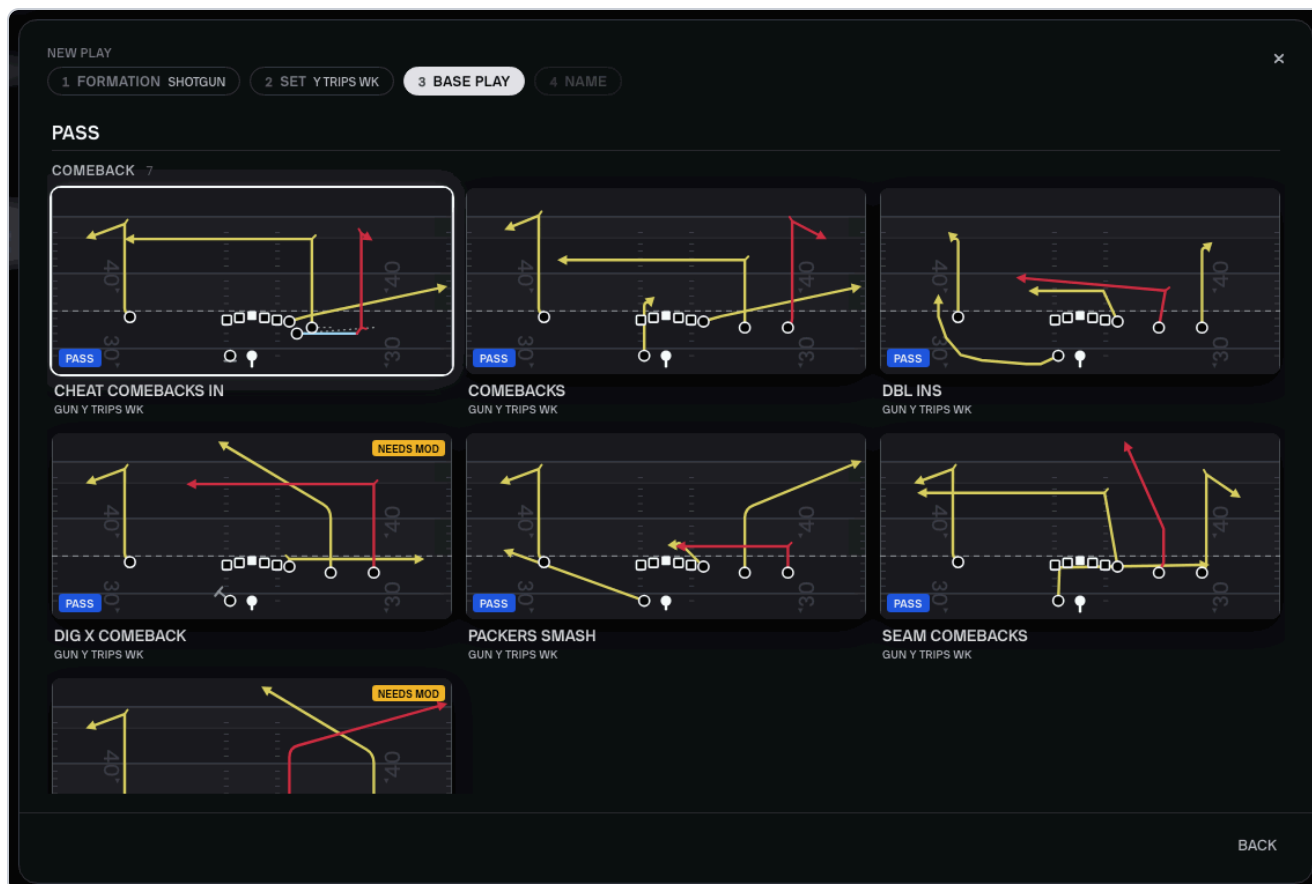
From the **DESIGNER** tab:



The Designer's start screen: your plays files on the left, their plays as cards.

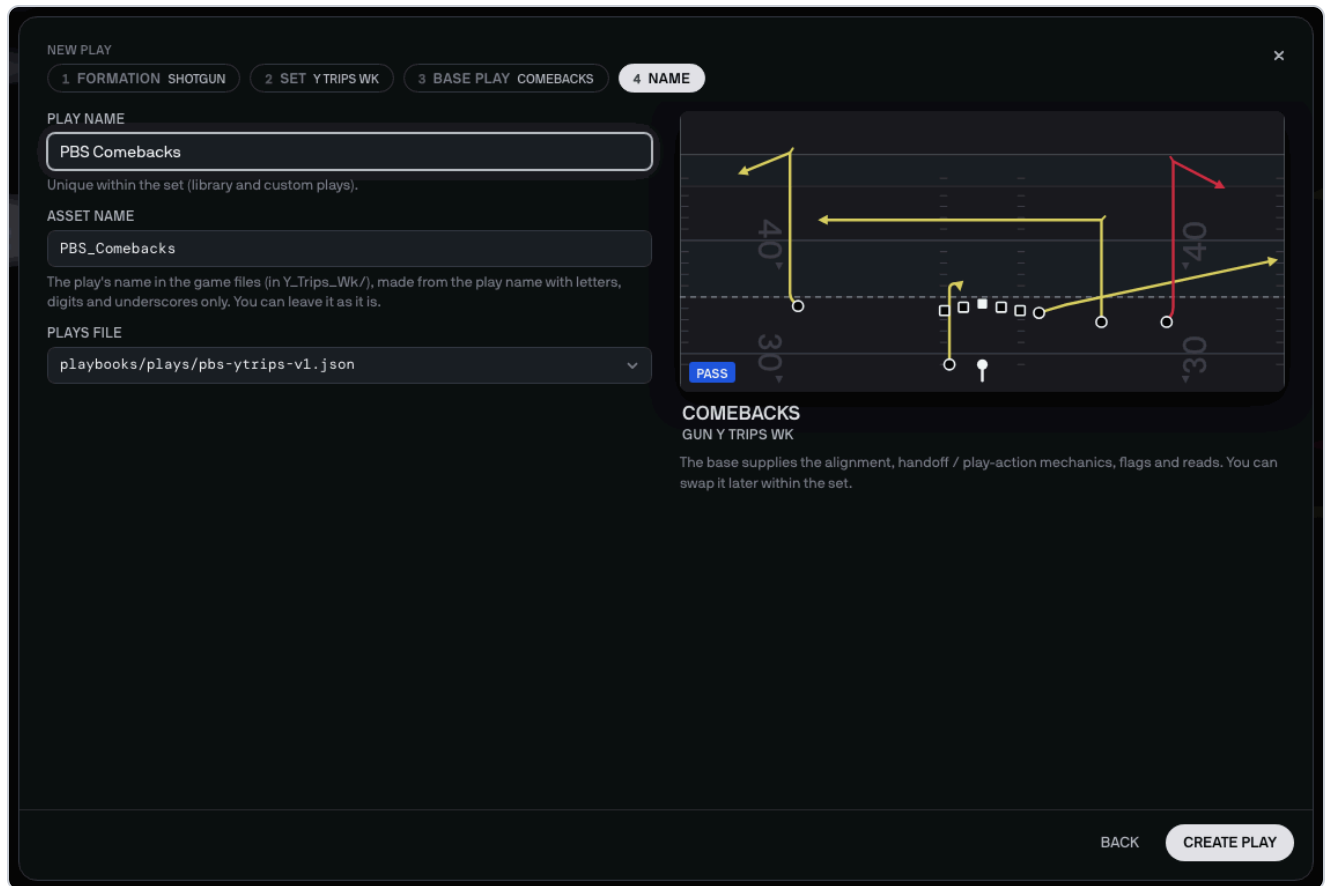
1. Click + **NEW PLAY**.

2. **Formation:** type to filter (for example "shotgun") and press **Enter**, or click one. Your own formations are marked **CUSTOM**.
3. **Set:** type to filter (for example "y trips wk") and press **Enter**, or click it. The field on the right shows the set's alignment.
4. **Base play:** click the play to start from. They're grouped by type and concept.



Step 3 of the wizard: choose the base play.

5. **Name:** type the in-game name (it must be unique in the set). The **ASSET NAME** below it is filled in from the name; leave it. Choose the **PLAYS FILE** to keep it in (**New plays file...** at the bottom of the list starts a new one), then click **CREATE PLAY**.

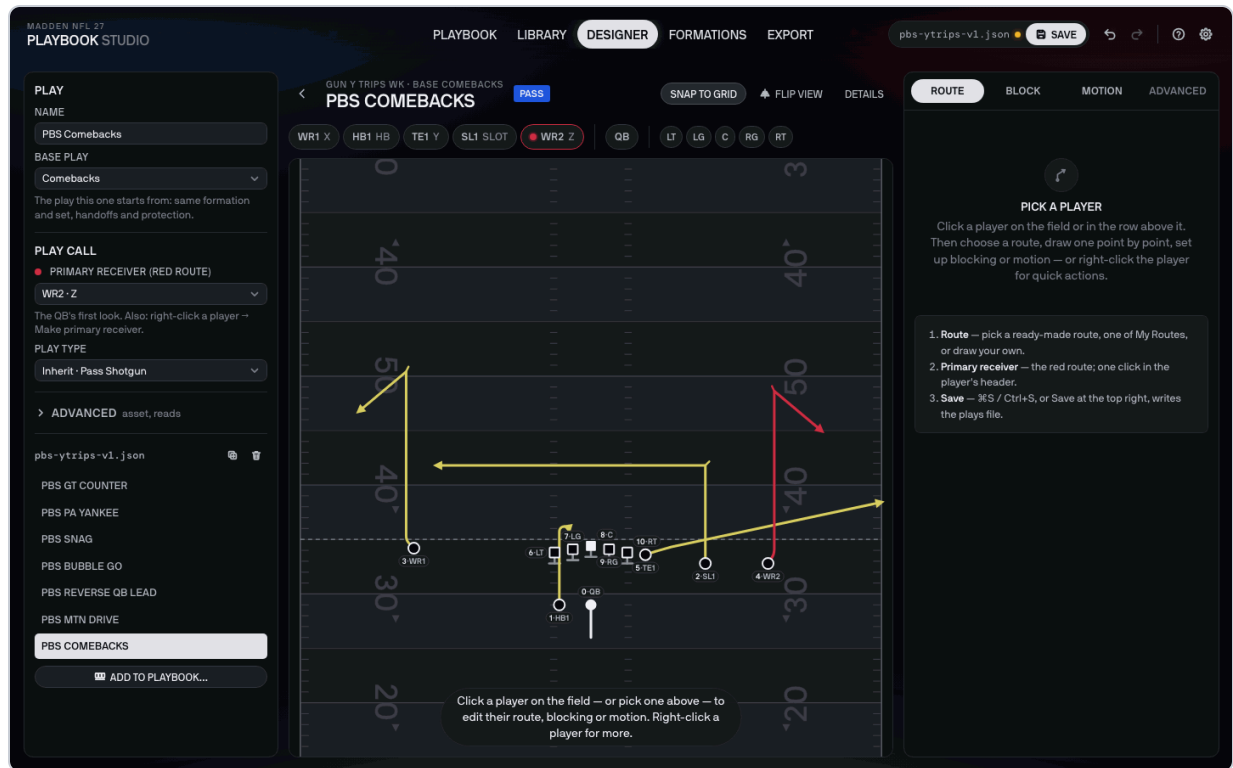


Step 4: the name and the file.

Other ways to start one:

- **LIBRARY** → **CLONE IN DESIGNER** on any play uses it as the base.
- **LIBRARY** → **ROUTES** tab → **USE IN DESIGNER** starts a play with that route already on the player.
- **FORMATIONS** → **Plays in this set** → **CUSTOMIZE THIS PLAY...** starts from a play copied into your own set.

THE EDITOR



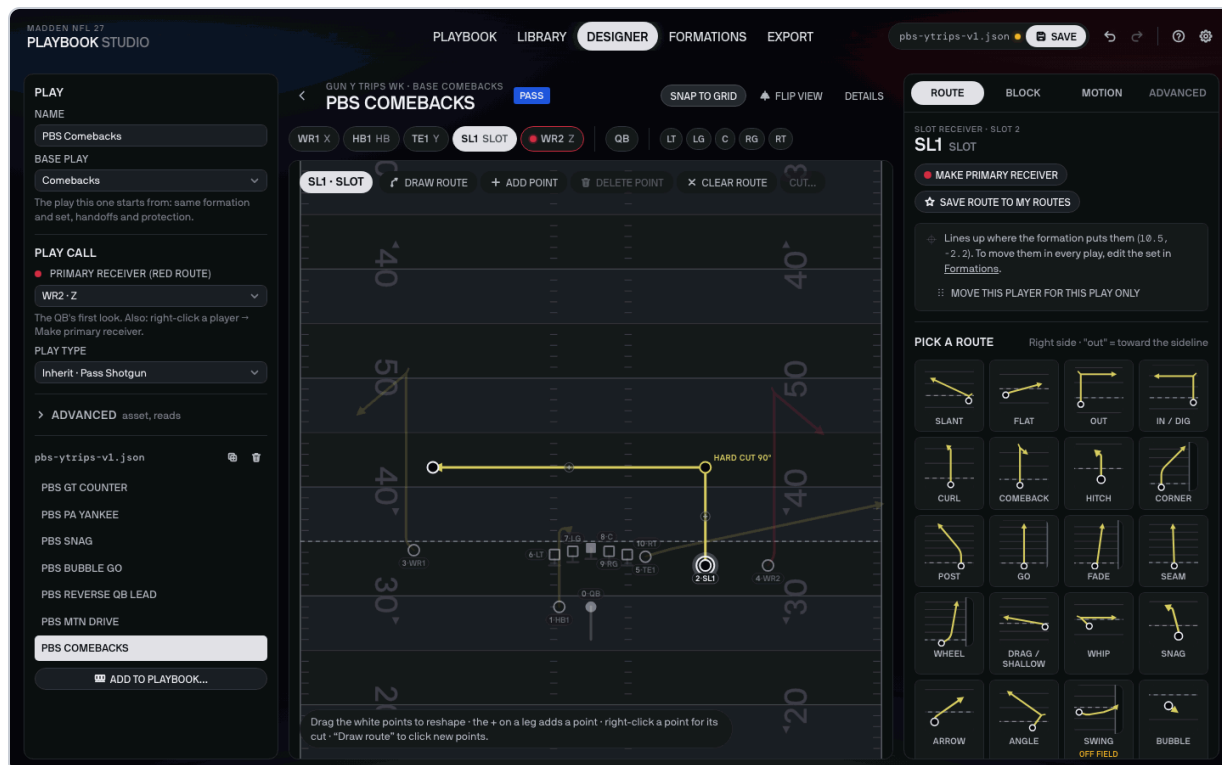
A new play, PBS Comebacks, based on Comebacks in Gun Y Trips Wk.

- **Left, PLAY:** the name and the **BASE PLAY**; under **PLAY CALL** the **PRIMARY RECEIVER (RED ROUTE)** and the **PLAY TYPE**; under **ADVANCED** the asset name, blocking scheme, run hole and reads (a run shows its run hole and blocking scheme under **PLAY CALL** instead). Below that, the other plays in the same file and **ADD TO PLAYBOOK....**
- **Middle, the field:** the play drawn to scale. The row of player buttons above it (WR1 X, HB1 HB, TE1 Y, SL1 SLOT, WR2 Z, QB, LT...RT) selects a player. A **red dot** marks the primary receiver, a **blue dot** a player you changed, a **lock** a handoff player.
- **Right, the player:** tabs **ROUTE**, **BLOCK**, **MOTION** and **ADVANCED** for the selected player.

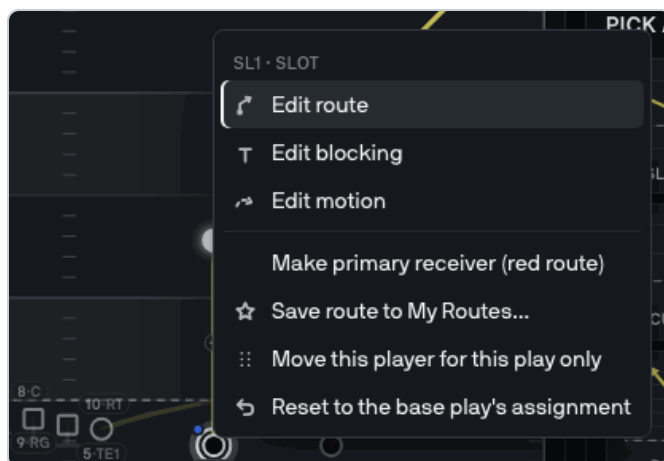
At the top of the field: **SNAP TO GRID** (points snap to half yards and 5° steps; click it for free placement, or hold Alt while dragging), **FLIP VIEW** (look at the play mirrored; the play itself doesn't change) and **DETAILS** (open the play in the library).

EDIT A PLAYER

1. Click a **player** on the field, or his button above the field.
2. Choose a tab on the right:
 - **ROUTE:** pick a ready-made route, one of My Routes, a double move, or draw your own. Everything about routes and cuts is in [Routes, cuts & My Routes](#).
 - **BLOCK:** make him block (next section).
 - **MOTION:** send him in motion before the snap (below).
3. **Right-click a player** for a shortcut menu.



The selected slot receiver (SL1): his current route on the field, the route presets on the right.

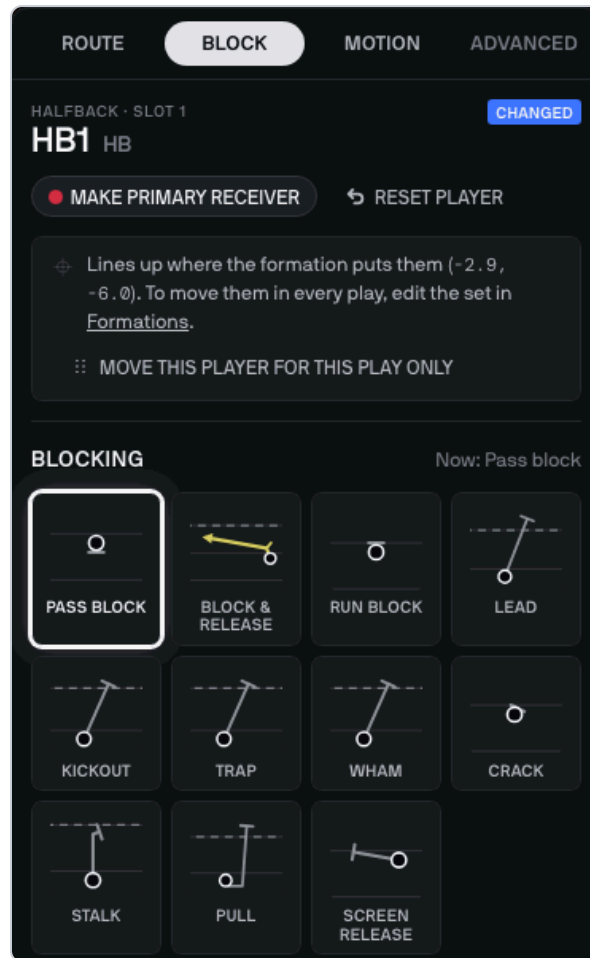


Right-click a player: edit his route, blocking or motion, make him the primary receiver, save his route, move him for this play, or reset him.

RESET PLAYER (or right-click → **Reset to the base play's assignment**) puts the player back exactly as the base play has him.

BLOCKING

On the **BLOCK** tab, pick what the player does:



The BLOCK tab for the halfback: pass block is selected.

BLOCK	USE IT FOR
PASS BLOCK	Stay in and protect the QB
BLOCK & RELEASE	Chip or check the rusher, then release into a route
RUN BLOCK	Block on a run (the play's blocking scheme picks the target)
LEAD, KICKOUT, TRAP, WHAM	Lead through a hole, kick out the end, trap or wham a defender
CRACK, STALK	Receiver blocks on the perimeter
PULL	A lineman pulls along the line
SCREEN RELEASE	Linemen releasing to set up a screen

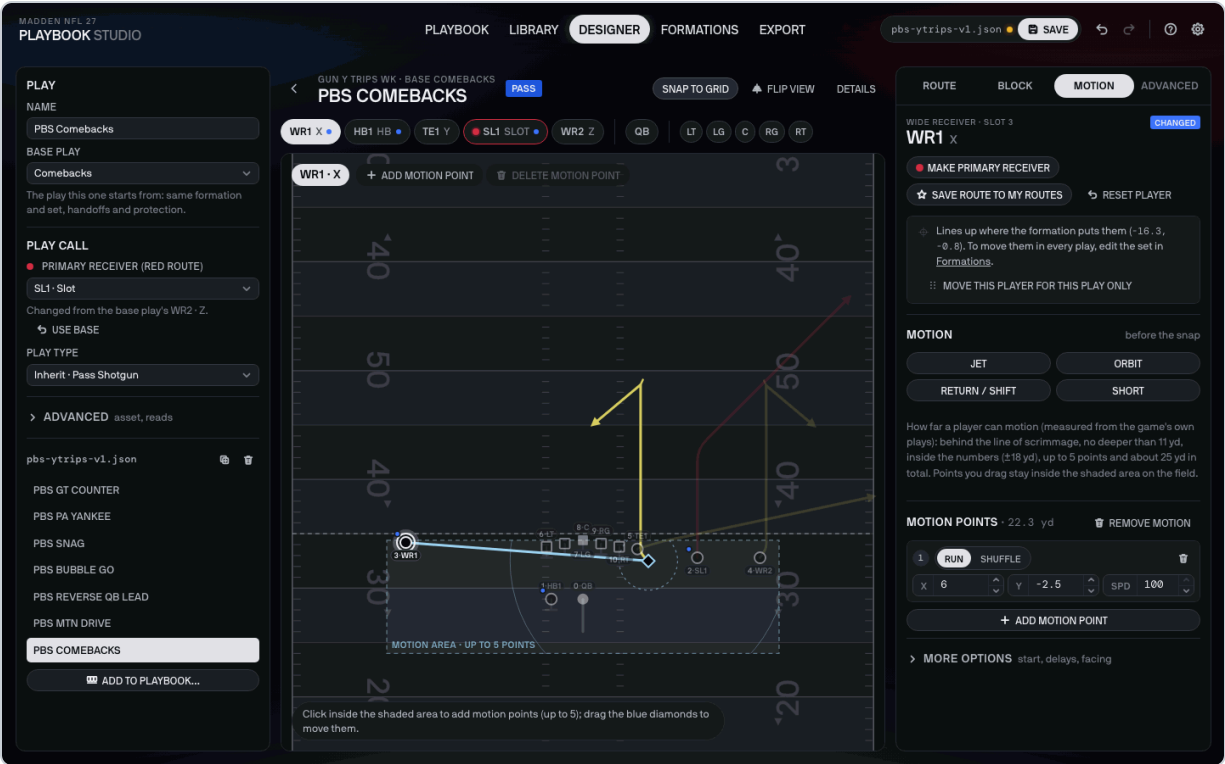
Gray lines ending in a T show the blocks on the field.

MOTION

On the MOTION tab, pick a preset to start with, then adjust it.

1. Click JET, ORBIT, RETURN / SHIFT or SHORT.

- The field shades the **motion area** and draws the path in light blue. Drag the **blue diamonds** to move the points, or click inside the shaded area to add a point (**ADD MOTION POINT** does the same).
- Each point has **RUN** or **SHUFFLE**, its **X** and **Y** and a speed. **MORE OPTIONS** sets when the motion starts, delays and facing.
- REMOVE MOTION** takes it out.



A jet motion for WR1: the shaded motion area, the light-blue path and its points on the right.

HOW FAR A PLAYER CAN MOTION

The limits come from the game itself: they were measured from all 2,099 motions in Madden's own plays, so a motion inside them is one the game knows how to run. The designer keeps your points inside them for you.

LIMIT	VALUE
Where	Behind the line of scrimmage, never past it
How deep	No deeper than 11 yards behind the line
How wide	Inside the numbers (18 yards either side of the ball)
Points	1 to 5 points per motion
Length	About 25 yards in total is a long motion; 35 yards is the most
Who	One motion man per play; offensive linemen never motion

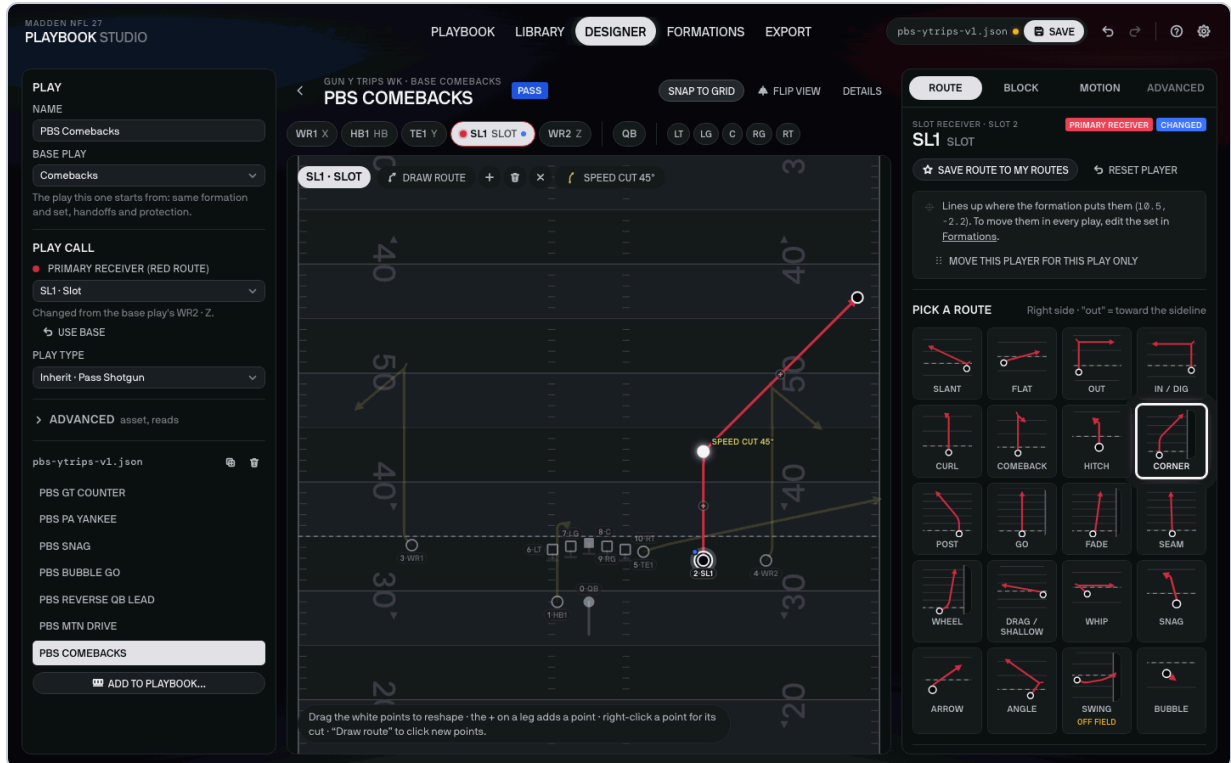
Dragging can't take a point out of the shaded area. The length and the motion man are up to you: the rings on the field show how far the player can still go from his last point, the tab's header shows the motion's length (for example **MOTION POINTS • 22.3 YD**), and the Motion tab warns when a motion is longer than 25 yards, longer than 35 yards (no motion in the game is) or when a second player motions. **EXPORT** lists a motion over 35 yards as a warning too.

THE PRIMARY RECEIVER (RED ROUTE)

The **primary receiver** is the QB's first look. His route is drawn **red** on the play art in the game and in the app. You can change who it is:

- In the play panel on the left, pick a player under **PRIMARY RECEIVER (RED ROUTE)**; or
- select a player and click **MAKE PRIMARY RECEIVER** in his header; or
- right-click a player → **Make primary receiver (red route)**.

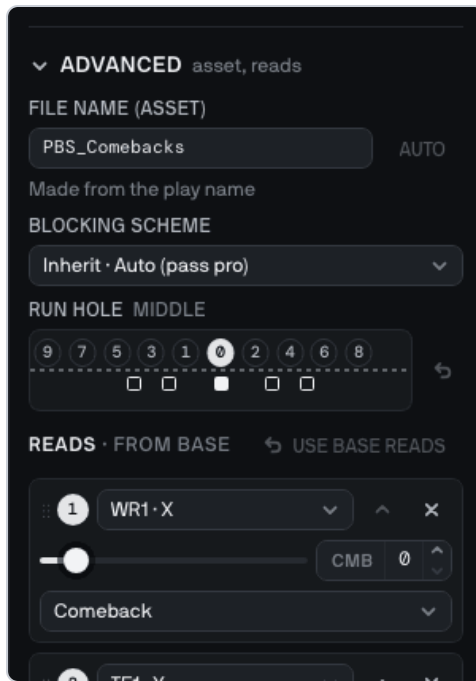
The route turns red right away, and the panel says which player the base play used (*Changed from the base play's WR2 · Z*). **USE BASE** under it goes back to the base play's primary receiver.



The slot receiver (SL1) is now the primary receiver: his corner route is red.

⚠ RED ROUTES AND READS

Stock plays have exactly one red route. In testing, plays whose **reads** were rewritten (every read with combo 0 and no concept) showed several red routes in the game. So: change the primary receiver here, but leave the reads alone unless you really need to (they're under **ADVANCED** → **READS**; **USE BASE READS** puts them back). The player's **ADVANCED** → **Red routes in the game** note says the same.

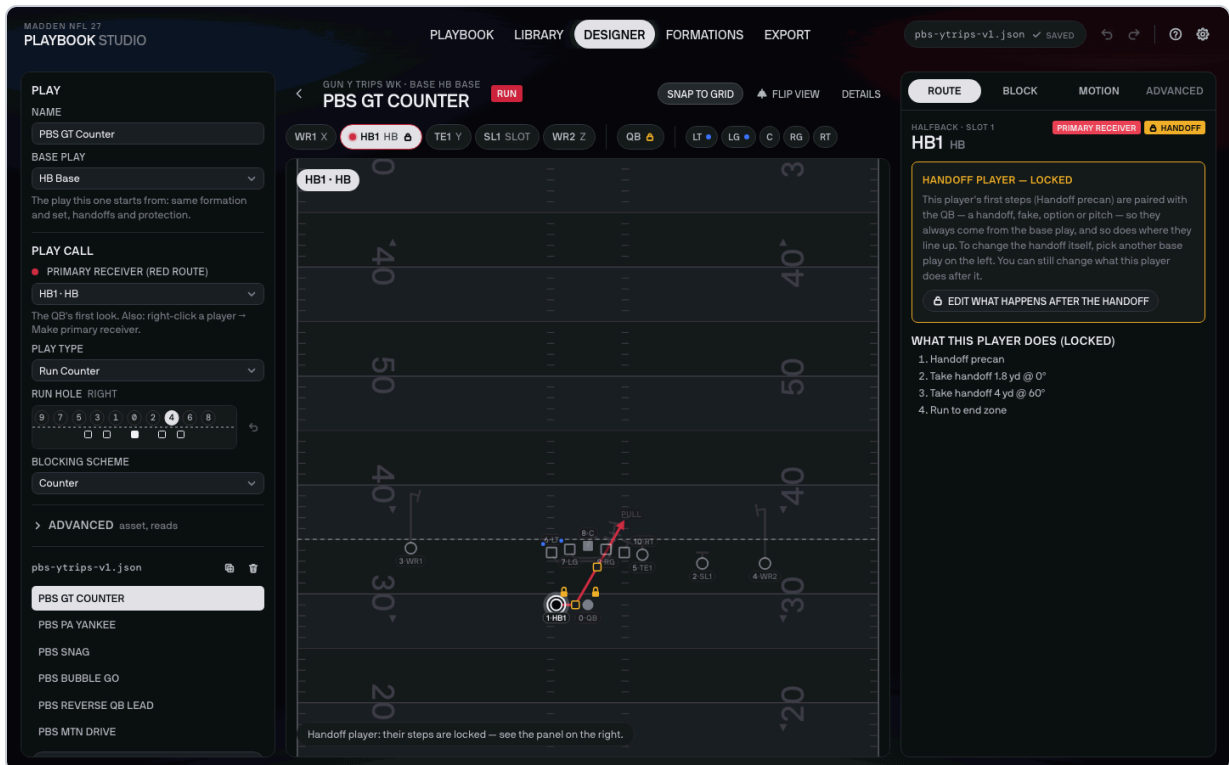


ADVANCED in the play panel: asset name, blocking scheme, run hole, and the reads (here still the base play's).

WHERE PLAYERS LINE UP (FIXED STARTING SPOTS)

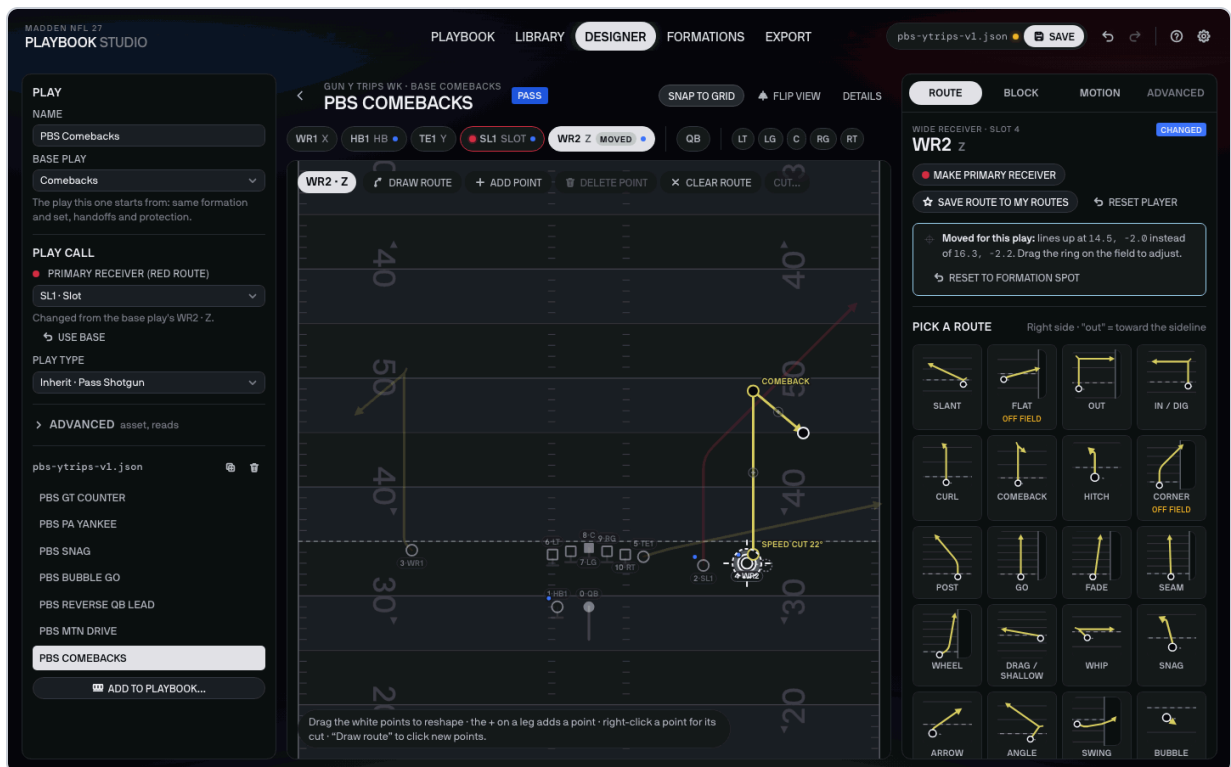
A play doesn't decide where players line up; **the set does**. Every play in Y Trips Wk starts from the same alignment. In the designer:

- The player's header says where he lines up, for example *Lines up where the formation puts them (10.5, -2.2)*.
- **Handoff players are locked** (lock icon, HANDOFF tag): the QB and the ball carrier on a handoff, fake, option or pitch keep the base play's first steps and spot, because the handoff only works from there. To change the handoff itself, pick another base play. **Edit what happens after the handoff** unlocks the rest of the path.



PBS GT Counter: the halfback is a handoff player, so his first steps and his spot are locked.

- Move this player for this play only lets you line one player up somewhere else in just this play (for example a tighter split). Click it, then drag the ring on the field to his new spot. His header then says *Moved for this play* and his button above the field shows **MOVED**. **RESET TO FORMATION SPOT** undoes it.



Moving WR2 for this play only: drag the ring to his new spot.

To move a player in **every** play of a set, make your own set in [Formations](#) and build the play on it.

CHANGE THE BASE PLAY LATER

The **BASE PLAY** menu on the left swaps the base for another play of the same set. The app asks first and tells you which players reset (players with a handoff in either base). Your other changes carry over.

SAVE, ADD TO A PLAYBOOK, RENAME

1. Press **⌘S** / **Ctrl+S** (or **SAVE** at the top right). The play is saved in its plays file.
2. Click **ADD TO PLAYBOOK...** at the bottom of the play panel and pick a playbook. The play goes into its set.
3. Save the playbook too (**⇧⌘S** / **Ctrl+Shift+S** saves everything).

If you rename a play that's already in a playbook, a note offers **Update everywhere**: it renames the play in your playbooks, tags and favorites too.

The icons next to the file name in the play panel **duplicate** or **delete** the current play. On the start screen, right-click a play card for **Edit**, **Add to playbook...** and **Delete....** Undo brings a deleted play back.

ADVANCED (RARELY NEEDED)

- **PLAY TYPE** changes how the game files the play (Pass, Run, Play action...). It inherits the base's by default.
- Play **ADVANCED**: the asset name (made from the play name), the blocking scheme and run hole (a run has them under **PLAY CALL**), and the reads.
- Player **ADVANCED** tab: the **release** (the first step off the line: straight, inside or outside) and start animation, the assignment's name and type, his exact alignment, and the raw step list.

ROUTES, CUTS & MY ROUTES

Presets, drawing, cut styles, saved routes

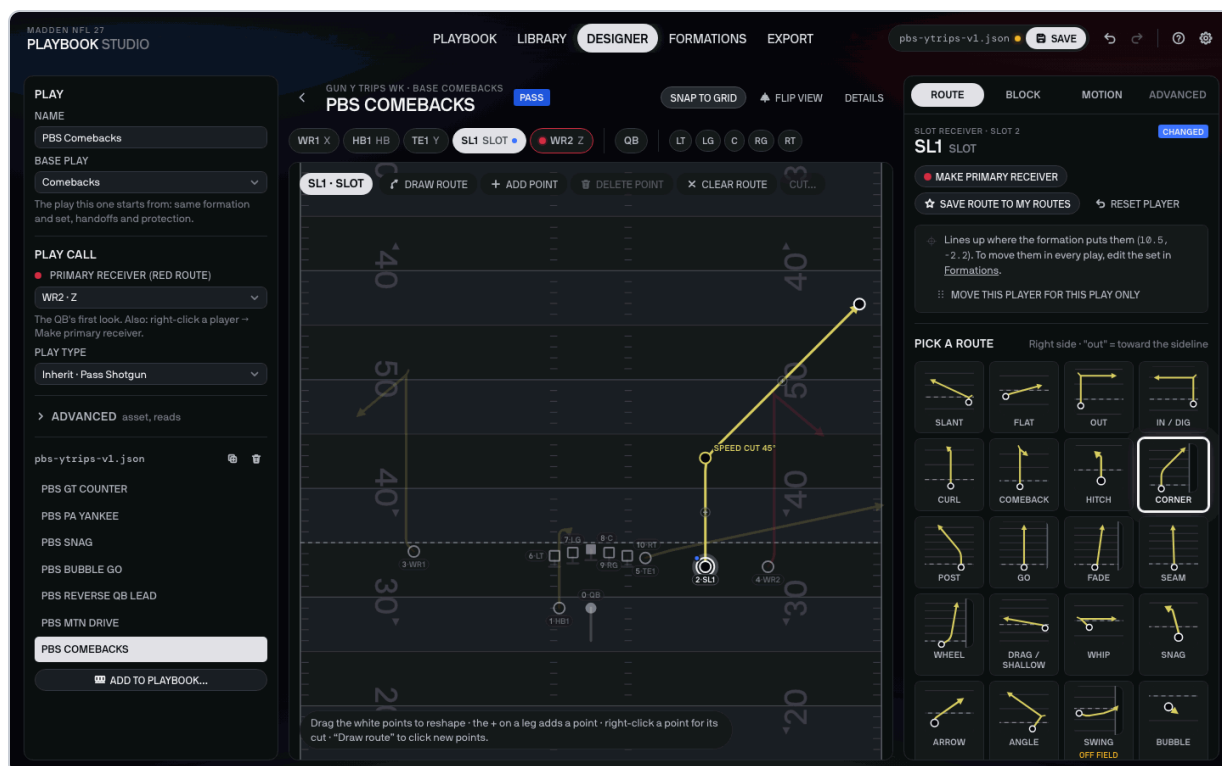
PICK A READY-MADE ROUTE · DRAW OR RESHAPE A ROUTE · CUTS: HOW THE RECEIVER TURNS · DOUBLE MOVES · RELEASES · A ROUTE THAT RUNS OUT OF BOUNDS · MY ROUTES

Everything about a receiver's route happens on the **ROUTE** tab of the [Designer](#): pick a ready-made route, draw your own point by point, choose how he cuts at each corner, and save routes you like to reuse them on any play.

PICK A READY-MADE ROUTE

1. Select a receiver (click him on the field).
2. Under **PICK A ROUTE**, click a route: Slant, Flat, Out, In / Dig, Curl, Comeback, Hitch, Corner, Post, Go, Fade, Seam, Wheel, Drag / Shallow, Whip, Snag, Arrow, Angle, Swing or Bubble.

The tiles are drawn from that player's spot, and they already know his side of the field: the note above them says, for example, *Right side · "out" = toward the sideline*. A tile marked **OFF FIELD** would carry him past the sideline from where he lines up.



The Corner preset on the slot receiver: a stem, a 45° speed cut, then the break to the corner.

Want more choice? **BROWSE GAME ROUTES...** at the bottom of the tab lists the 5,400 routes from the game's own plays, drawn from this player's spot.

DRAW OR RESHAPE A ROUTE

The route on the field has **white points**: one at each corner and one at the end.

- Drag a **white point** to move that corner or the end of the route.
- Click the **+** in the middle of a leg to add a point there (or use **ADD POINT** above the field).
- Click a point to select it, then **DELETE POINT** (or press Delete) to remove it.
- **DRAW ROUTE** extends the route: while it's on (the button reads **DRAWING ON**), every click on the field adds a point at the end of the route. Double-click, press Esc or click the button again to stop.
- **CLEAR ROUTE** removes the whole route and turns **DRAW ROUTE** on, so your next clicks draw a new route from the player's spot. His spot, motion and release stay. ⌘Z brings the old route back.
- Points snap to half yards and 5° angles. Click **SNAP TO GRID** for free placement, or hold **Alt** while dragging.

✦ START CLOSE, THEN SHAPE IT

The quickest way to a new route is the preset that's closest to it: pick it, then drag, add or delete points. To draw one from scratch, click **CLEAR ROUTE** and click the corners on the field, then press Esc. **RESET PLAYER** goes back to the base play's route.

Every segment between two points is one **leg** of the route. The **ROUTE POINTS** list on the right shows each leg's length (**YD**), direction (**DIR**: 90° is straight upfield, 0° toward the right sideline, 180° toward the left) and speed (**SPD**, 0–100; a stem at 80 and the break at 100 sells the cut). Type in these boxes for exact numbers.

The screenshot shows a dark-themed panel titled "ROUTE POINTS". At the top right are three buttons: "FIND SPACE" (highlighted), "SIT", and "NONE". Below are three sections for "Leg 1", "Leg 2", and "Leg 3". Each section contains four input fields: "YD", "DIR", "SPD", and a "cut" button. For Leg 1, YD is 2, DIR is 70, SPD is 80, and the cut button says "NO CUT". For Leg 2, YD is 30, DIR is 90, SPD is 100, and the cut button says "NO CUT". For Leg 3, YD is 20, DIR is 90, SPD is 100, and the cut button says "NO CUT". At the bottom, there is a text area that says "After: Get open" and a legend: "Direction: 90° = straight upfield, 0° = toward the right sideline, 180° = left."

Leg	YD	DIR	SPD	Cut
1 Leg 1	2	70	80	NO CUT
2 Leg 2	30	90	100	NO CUT
3 Leg 3	20	90	100	NO CUT

After: Get open
Direction: 90° = straight upfield, 0° = toward the right sideline, 180° = left.

ROUTE POINTS: each leg's yards, direction and speed, its cut, and what he does at the end.

What the receiver does when the route ends: **FIND SPACE** (keep working to get open), **SIT** (stop and wait) or **NONE**.

CUTS: HOW THE RECEIVER TURNS

At every corner the receiver makes a **cut**. The cut changes how sharp the break is, and the app draws it the way it looks on the field, so you can see the difference on the play art:

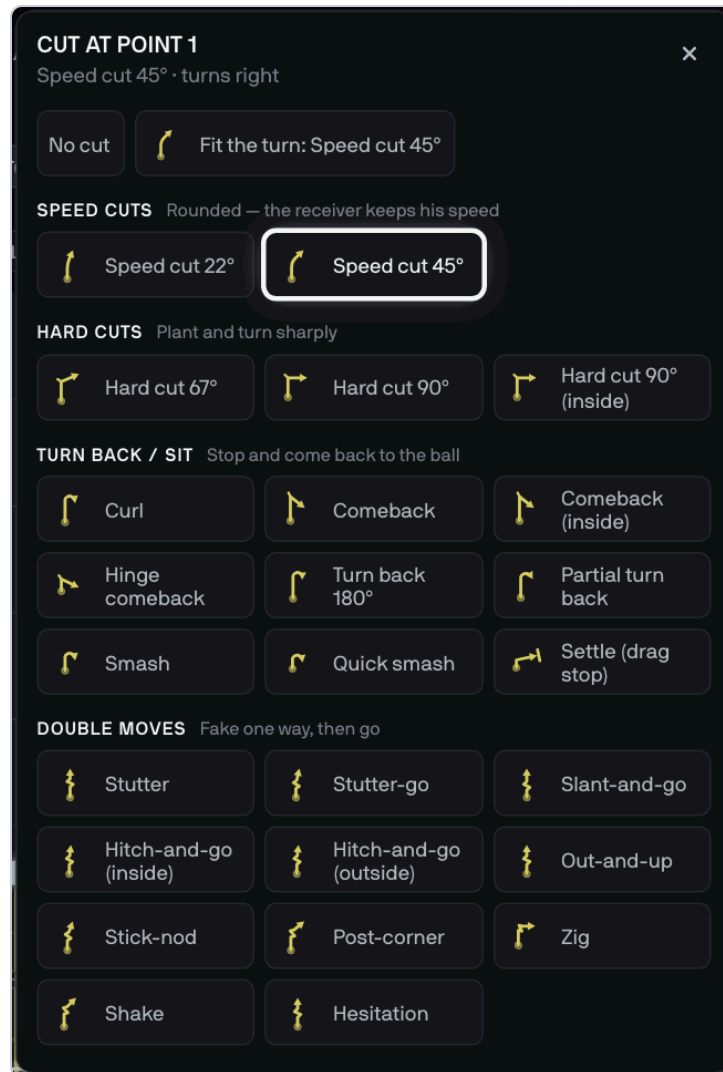


The five cut styles and how the app draws them.

LOOKS LIKE	CUT STYLE	CUTS IN THE MENU
Rounded corner	Speed cut: bends the route without slowing down	Speed cut 22°, Speed cut 45°
Sharp corner	Hard cut: plants and breaks	Hard cut 67°, Hard cut 90°, Hard cut 90° (inside)
Small zig at the corner	Double move: sells a fake, then keeps going	Stutter, Stutter-go, Slant-and-go, Hitch-and-go, Out-and-up, Stick-nod, Post-corner, Zig, Shake, Hesitation
Hook back toward the ball	Turn back: stops and comes back	Curl, Comeback, Hinge comeback, Turn back 180°, Partial turn back, Smash, Quick smash
Short bar across the end	Settle: stops in the open space	Settle (drag stop)

CHANGE A CUT

1. Right-click a corner point of the route (or select it and click CUT... above the field).
2. Pick a cut. The menu shows the same icons as the legend above. **Fit the turn** picks the cut that matches the angle you drew; **No cut** removes it.



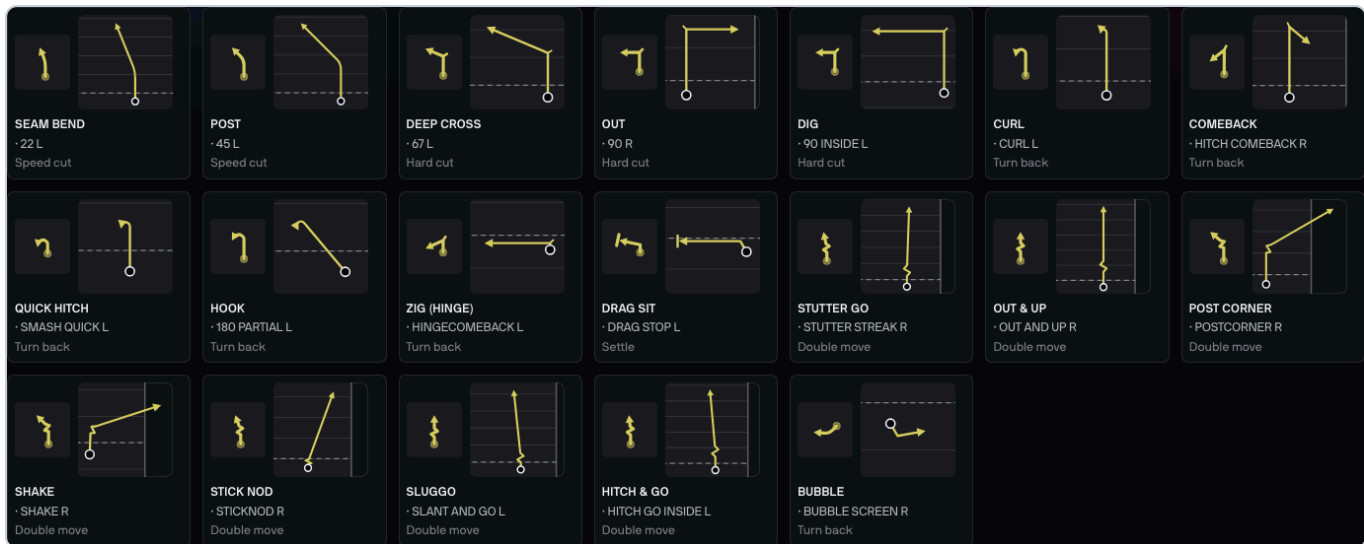
The cut menu for the corner of a route: speed cuts, hard cuts, turn backs and double moves.

The chip next to each leg in ROUTE POINTS (for example **SPEED CUT 45°** or **NO CUT**) shows the cut at the end of that leg; click it to change the cut there too.

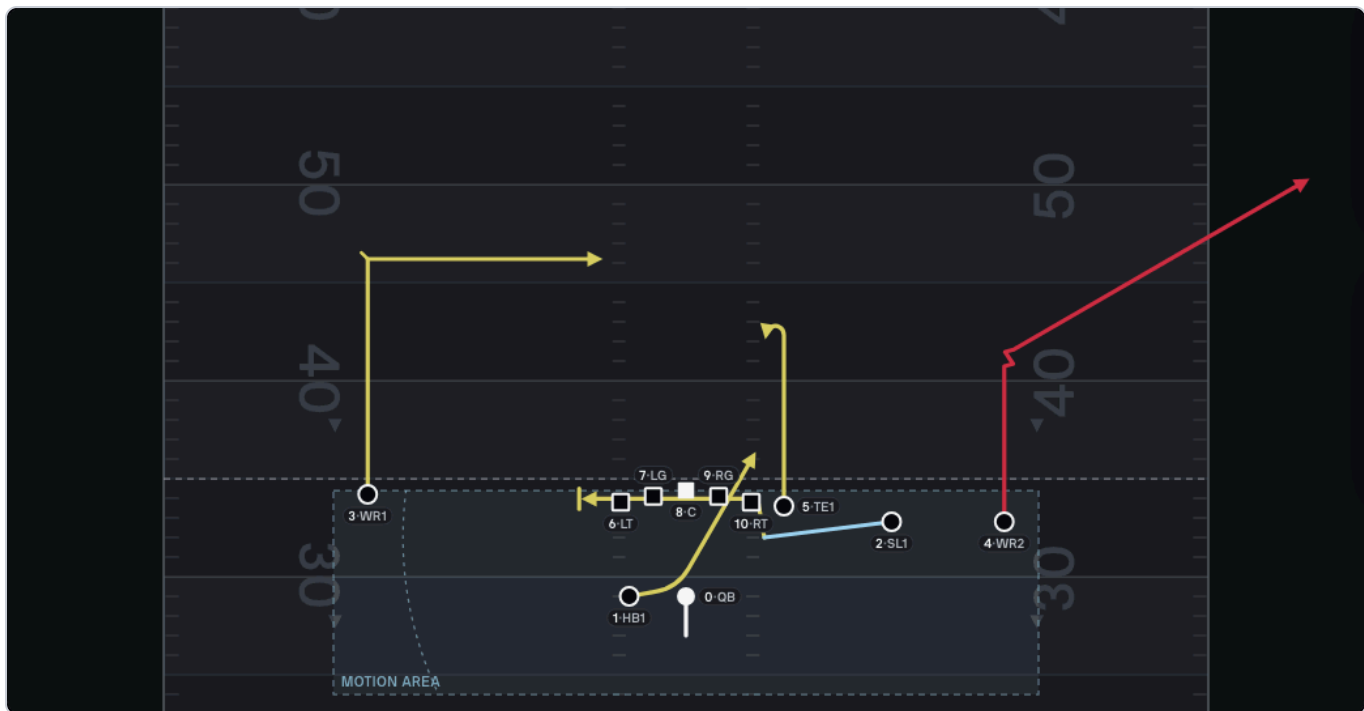
① SPEED AND HARD CUTS FOLLOW THE ANGLE

When you drag a point, the speed or hard cut (22°, 45°, 67°, 90°) at the corners next to it is re-picked to match the new angle. Named cuts (curl, comeback, stutter, smash...) stay as you chose them. So shape the route first, then pick a sharper or softer cut if you want one.

Here's every cut on a real route, drawn by the app the same way the play art shows it:



Each cut on a route for the right-side receiver: speed cuts, hard cuts, turn backs, a settle and double moves.



A whole play with each cut style, as it appears on the field and on play cards.

DOUBLE MOVES

Click **DOUBLE MOVES** (fake, then go) on the **ROUTE** tab to open complete double-move routes: **Stutter**, **Stutter-go**, **Slant-and-go**, **Hitch-and-go** (in), **Hitch-and-go** (out), **Out-and-up**, **Stick-nod** and **Zig**. Click one to put it on the player, then drag its points like any other route. You can also turn any corner into a double move with the cut menu.



The double-move presets.

RELEASES

A **release** is the receiver's first step off the line, before the stem: straight, inside (toward the ball) or outside. Set it on the player's **ADVANCED** tab under **RELEASE**, with an optional quick start. The rest of the route stays where it is.

A ROUTE THAT RUNS OUT OF BOUNDS

If a route crosses the sideline from where the player lines up (common when a route drawn for a slot receiver is put on a wide receiver), a notice appears above the route tools with **Fit to field**. It shortens only the legs that head for the sideline, so the cuts and the depth stay as you drew them. **EXPORT** lists such a route as a warning.

MY ROUTES

My Routes is your own route library. Save a route once and put it on any player in any play.

SAVE A ROUTE

1. Select the player whose route you like.
2. Click **SAVE ROUTE TO MY ROUTES** in his header (or right-click him → **Save route to My Routes...**).
3. Give it a name and click **SAVE ROUTE**.

SAVE ROUTE TO MY ROUTES

×

Saved routes can be put on any player in any play — they flip automatically for the other side of the field.

ROUTE NAME

CANCEL

SAVE ROUTE

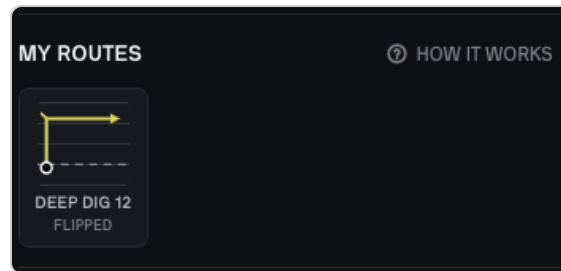
Name the route; it can then go on any player in any play.

The route is saved at once in `app-data/routes.json`; there's nothing else to save. Only the route itself is kept (not motion or the player's spot). Name routes by what they do ("Deep Dig 14", "Whip vs Man", "Bang 8 Post"): you'll find them faster later.

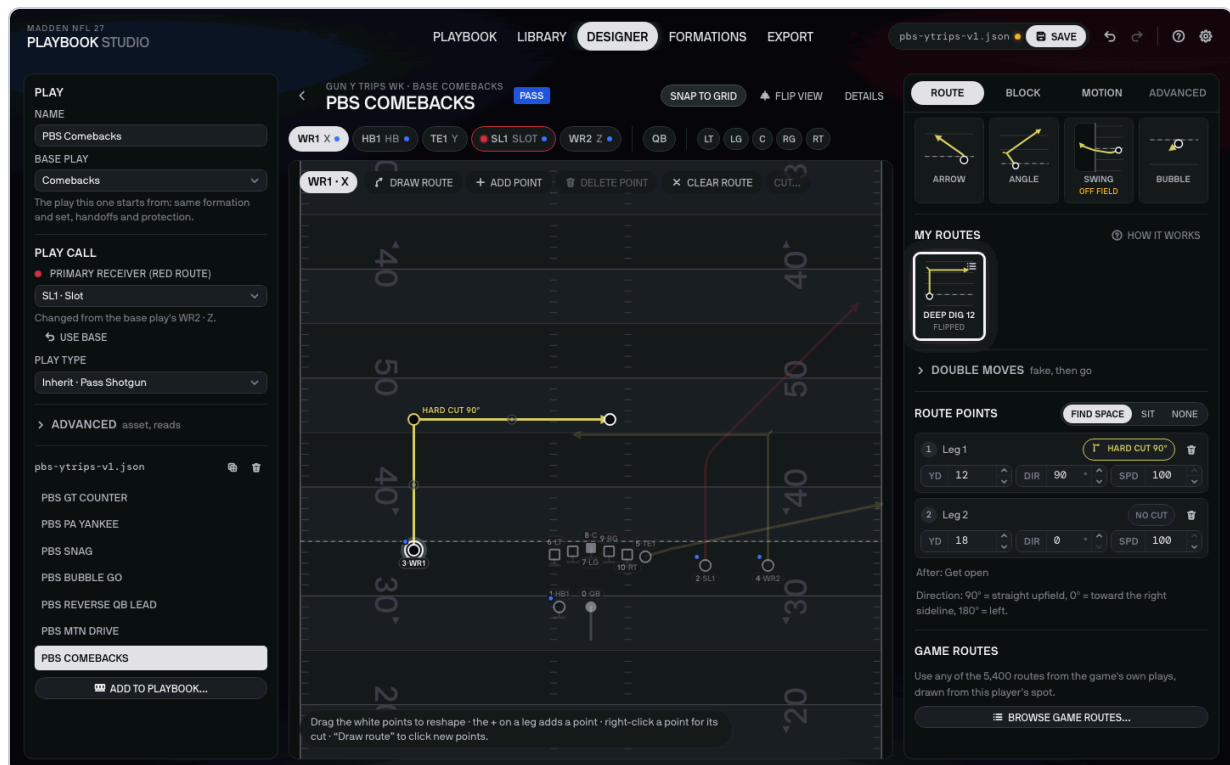
USE A SAVED ROUTE

1. In any play, select a receiver.
2. Under **MY ROUTES** on the ROUTE tab (below the ready-made routes; scroll down), click the route's tile.

Each tile is drawn from the selected player's spot. A route saved for a player on the right is **mirrored automatically** for a player on the left (an in-breaking route stays in-breaking, and the tile says **FLIPPED**), so one saved route works on both sides.



MY ROUTES for the left receiver: "Deep Dig 12", saved from the right side, is flipped for him.



The same route put on WR1: it breaks inside, toward the ball.

Your saved routes also appear in the library's ROUTES tab (switch the source to MY ROUTES).

RENAME, REORDER OR DELETE

Right-click a tile in MY ROUTES: Use for this player, Rename..., Move earlier, Move later or Delete.... Deleting a saved route doesn't change plays that already use it.

FORMATIONS & CUSTOM SETS

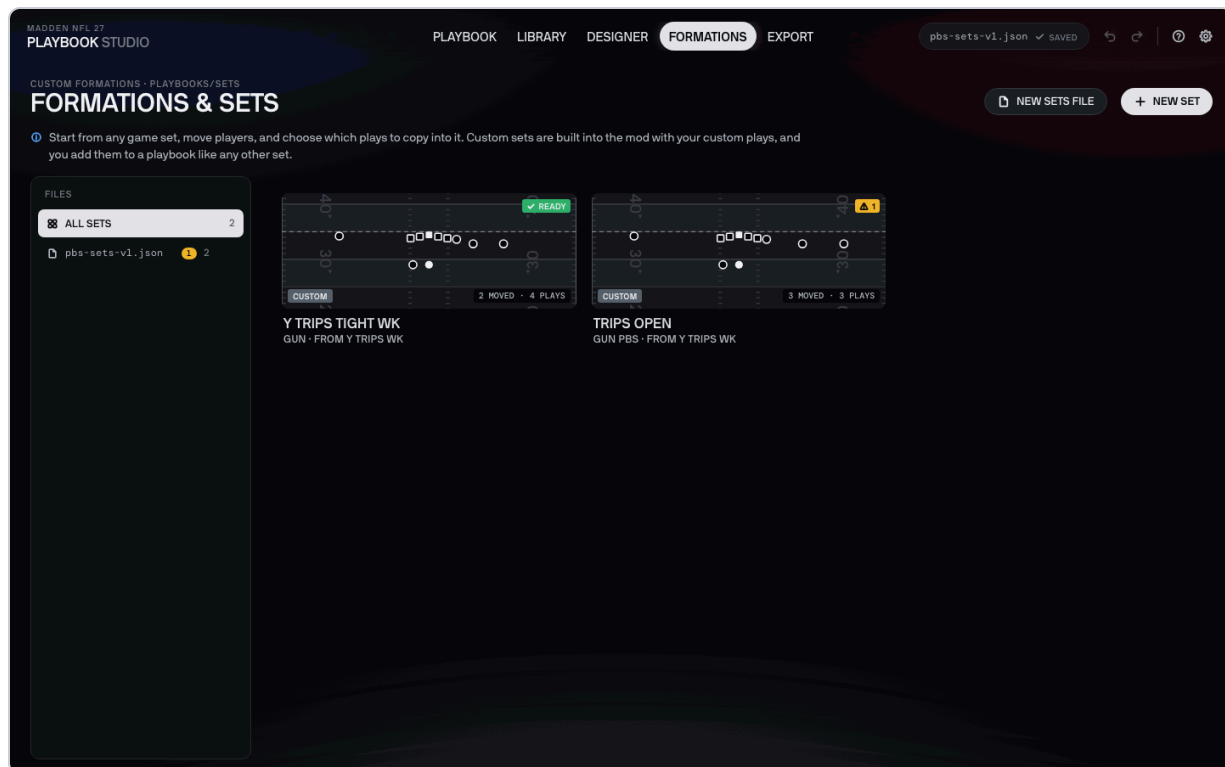
Move players, motion presets, copy plays in

MAKE A CUSTOM SET · MOVE PLAYERS · THE GAME'S CHECKS · FLIPPED PLAYS (FLIP PARTNERS) · MOTION PRESETS · COPY PLAYS INTO YOUR SET · USE YOUR SET IN A PLAYBOOK

In Madden a **formation** (Shotgun, Pistol, Singleback...) holds **sets** (Y Trips Wk, Bunch...), and the set decides where all eleven players line up. The **FORMATIONS** tab makes your own sets: start from a set the game has, move players, adjust its pre-snap motions, and copy plays into it. Your sets are built into the same mod as your plays and you add them to a playbook like any other set.

⚠ NEW: CHECK YOUR FIRST CUSTOM SET IN THE GAME

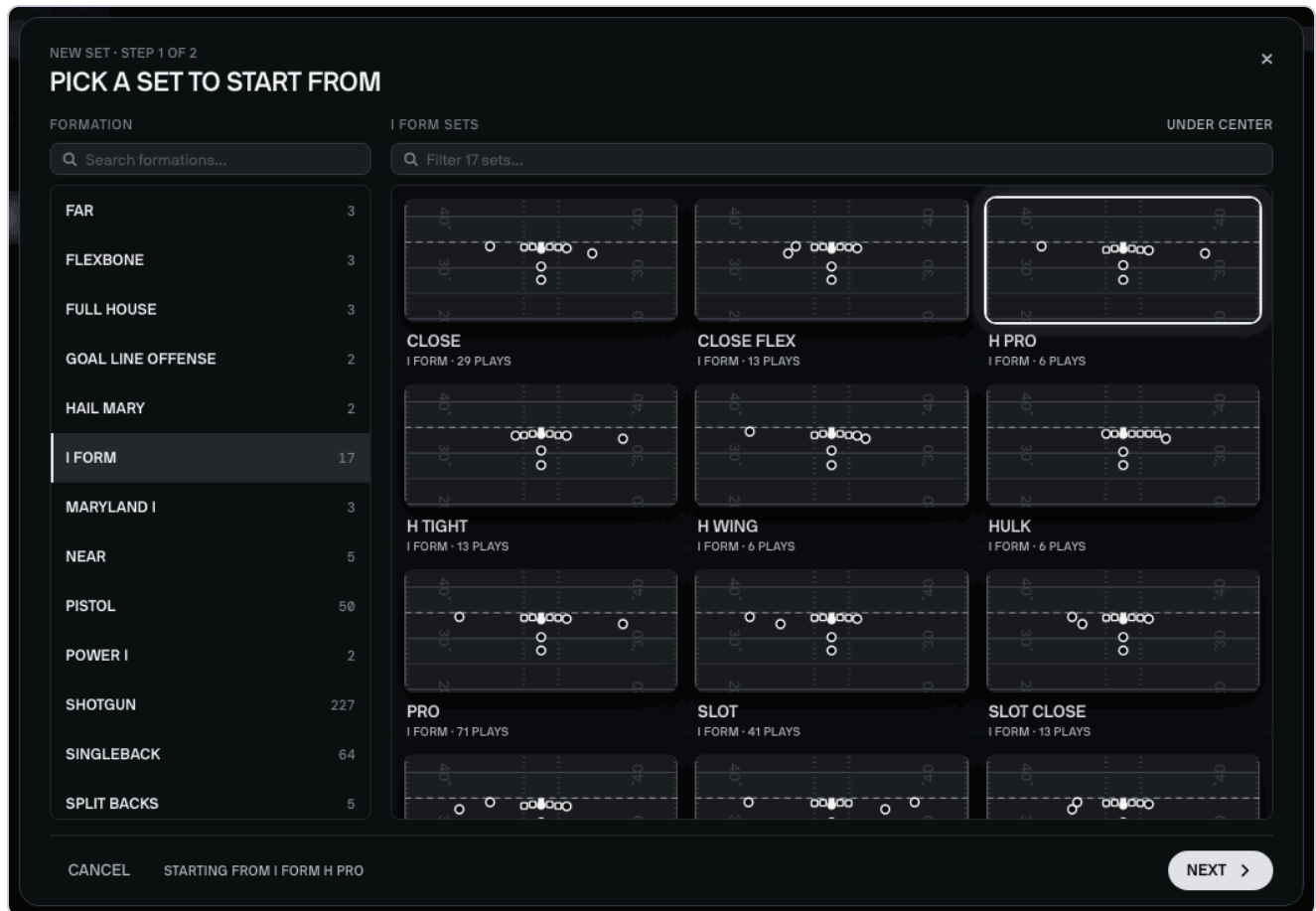
Custom sets are the newest part of Playbook Studio. The first ones were built on 2026-10-04 and haven't been confirmed in the game yet. Build one small set first, export, and check it in Madden before you build a whole playbook on custom sets.



FORMATIONS: your custom sets, each with its changes, its plays and a READY or warning badge.

MAKE A CUSTOM SET

1. Click FORMATIONS, then + NEW SET.
2. Pick a set to start from: choose a formation on the left, then click a set (double-click jumps to the next step). Pick the one closest to what you want; your set copies its players, personnel and motions.

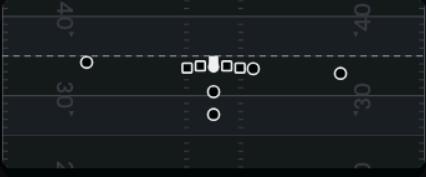


Step 1: pick the formation and the set to start from.

3. Click **NEXT** and **name your set**. This is the name you'll see in the game.
4. Choose the **FORMATION** it appears under: keep the starting set's formation, use one of your own formations, or **New formation...** to make one (for example "Gun PBS").
5. Choose the sets file to save it in (**EXISTING FILE** or **NEW FILE**), then click **CREATE SET**.

NEW SET · STEP 2 OF 2

NAME YOUR SET



H PRO

I FORM · 6 PLAYS

Your set starts as an exact copy of this one: same players, same motion presets. Next you'll move players and choose which of its plays (or plays from any other set) to copy in.

SET NAME

H Pro 2

The name you'll see in the game and use in playbooks.

FORMATION

Keep it in I Form

Which formation the set appears under in the game.

SAVE IN

EXISTING FILENEW FILEpbs-sets-v1.json · 2 sets

> ADVANCEDasset names (generated)

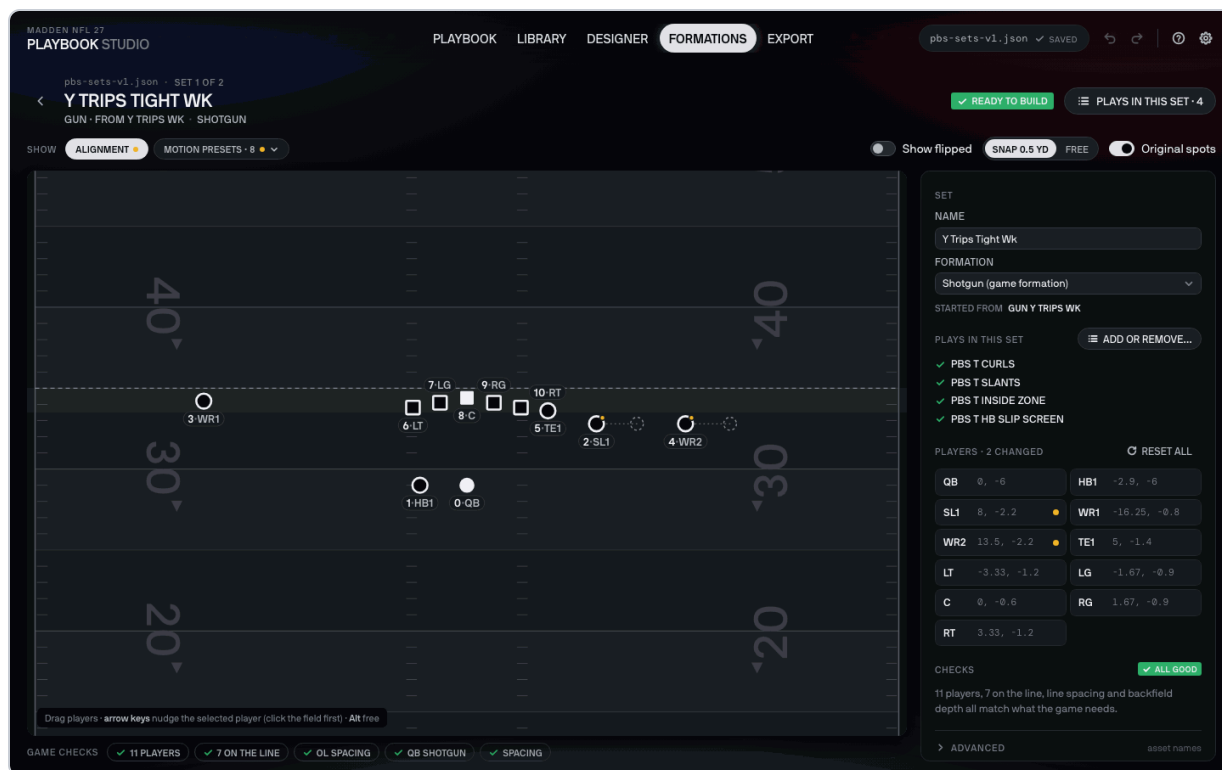
< BACK

CREATE SET

Step 2: the set's name, its formation and the file it's saved in.

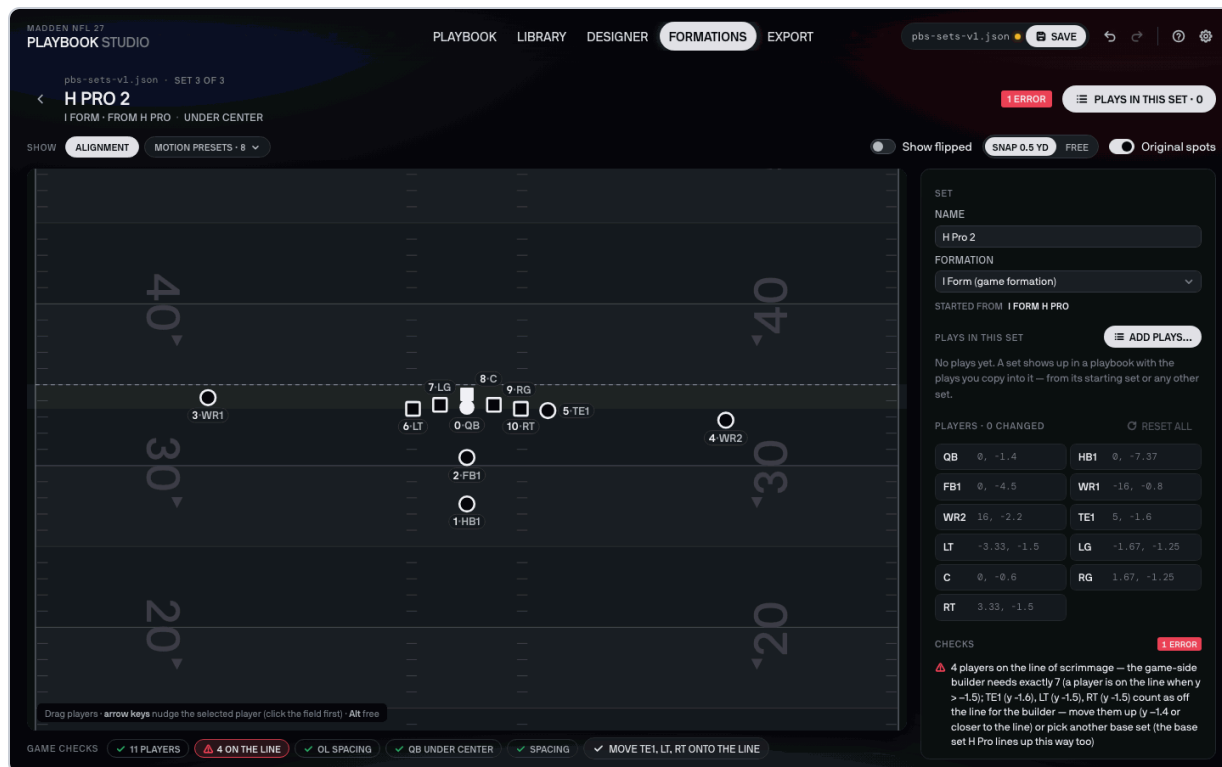
6. Press ⌘S / Ctrl+S to save.

MOVE PLAYERS



The set editor: drag players on the field; the checks are at the bottom, the set's details on the right.

- Drag a player on the field. The X/Y readout shows where he is (in yards from the ball: X across, Y back from the line).
- Click a player to see his panel: type exact X and Y, or use the quick buttons for DEPTH (on the line, off the line, backfield) and SPLIT (tight, wing, slot, numbers, wide...). MOVE TO THE OTHER SIDE mirrors him; RESET PLAYER puts him back.
- Arrow keys nudge the selected player (click the field first). SNAP 0.5 YD snaps to half yards; FREE (or holding Alt) places freely.
- Original spots shows where everyone started as faint circles.



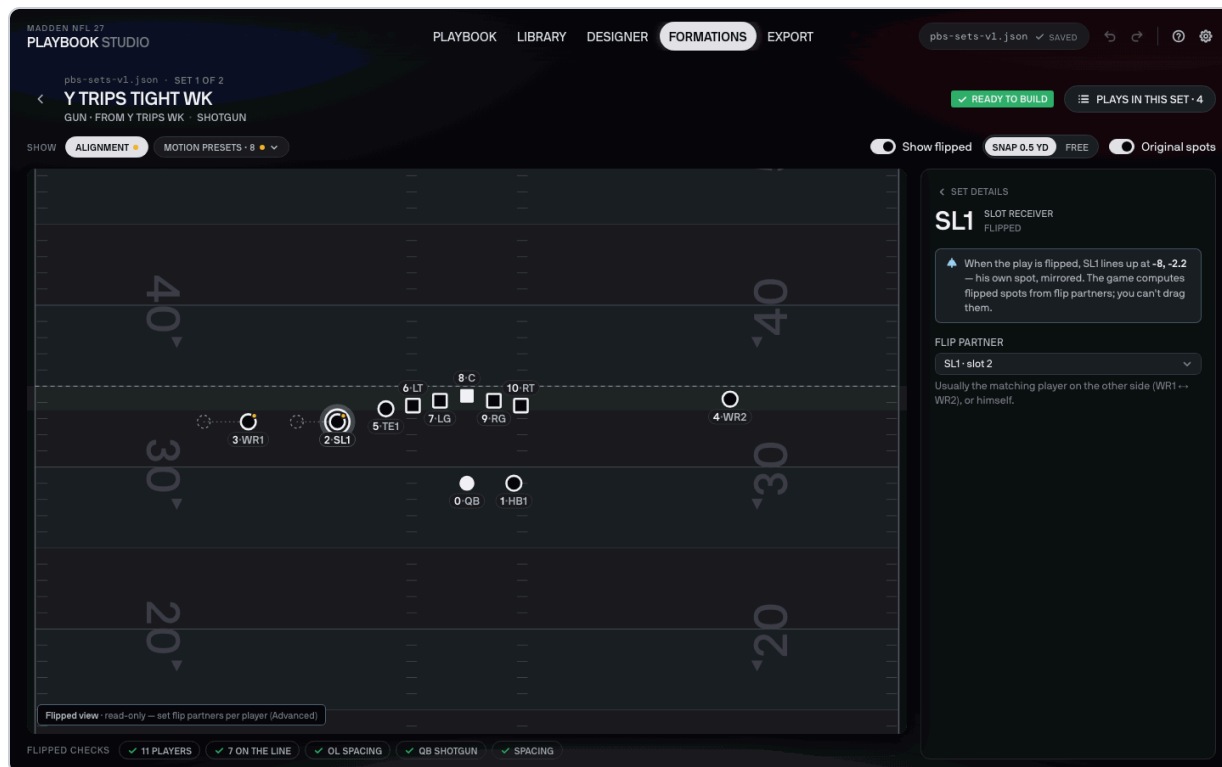
A set started from I Form H Pro: its tackles (y -1.5) and TE (y -1.6) don't count as "on the line" yet.

FOR THE OWNER: THE "ON THE LINE" RULE

Today the game-side builder (`tools/PlayDump/SetBuilder.cs`) counts a player as on the line only when $y > -1.5$. Many stock sets put their tackles at exactly -1.5 and tight ends at -1.6 , so about 130 of the roughly 430 stock offense sets (about 3 in 10) can't be used as a starting point as they are; the app flags them and offers the fix above. The one-line fix on the game side is to change that check to $y > -1.75$; after that, every one of those sets works unchanged.

FLIPPED PLAYS (FLIP PARTNERS)

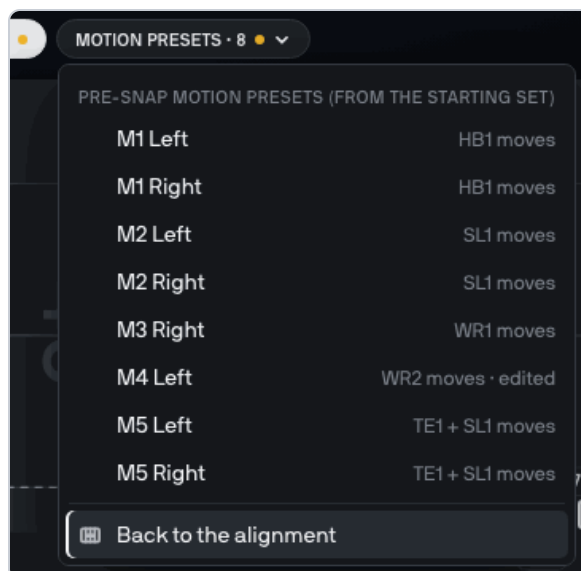
When you flip a play in the game, every player moves to his **flip partner's** spot on the other side (for example WR1 and WR2 trade places). Turn on **Show flipped** to see the mirrored alignment the game will use. It's read-only; click a player to see or change his **FLIP PARTNER**. Moving a player also moves his flipped spot.



Show flipped: the mirrored alignment, with each player's flip partner.

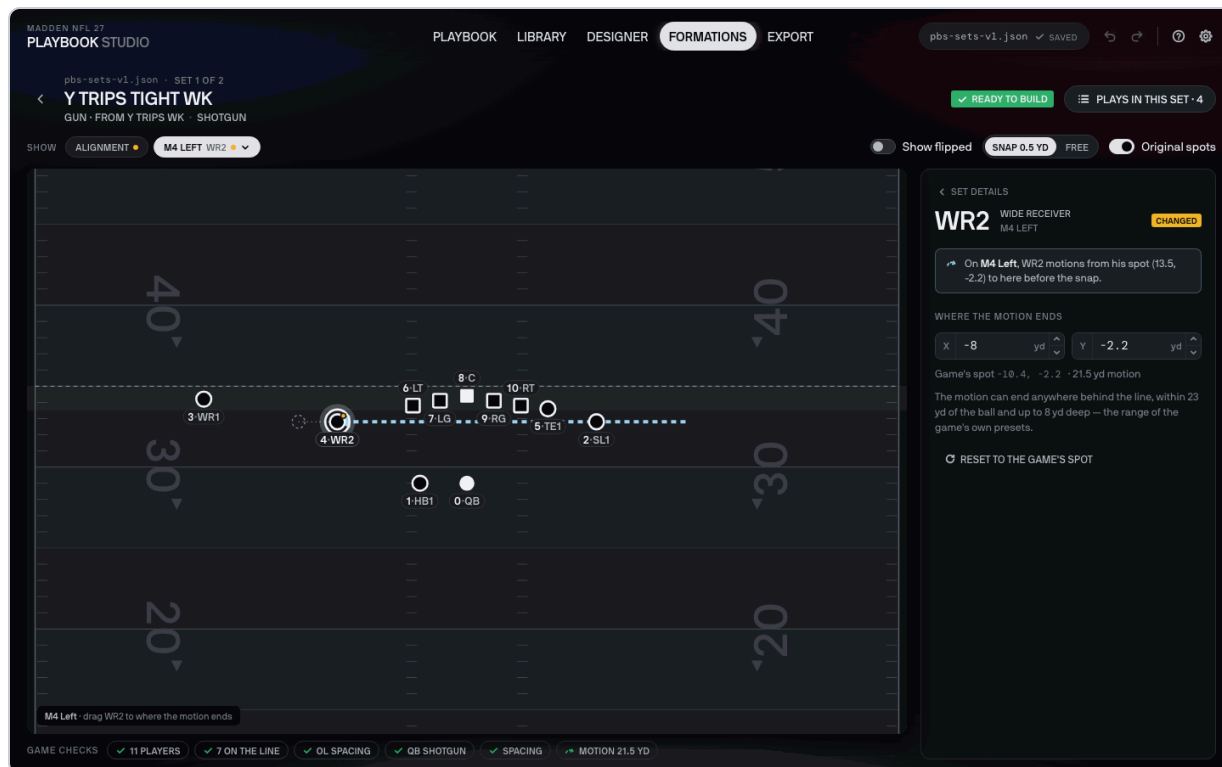
MOTION PRESETS

A set has a few ready pre-snap motions (M1 Left, M2 Right...), the ones you call at the line in the game. Under **SHOW**, open **MOTION PRESETS** and pick one to see who moves and where he ends up.



The set's motion presets: who moves on each one.

- Drag the motion man to where the motion should end, or type X and Y. The motion can end anywhere behind the line, within 23 yards of the ball and up to 8 yards deep. These numbers come from the game's own presets, so they differ a little from a play's own motion in the [Designer](#), which is measured from the motions inside plays.
- **RESET TO THE GAME'S SPOT** undoes it. **Back to the alignment** returns to the normal view.

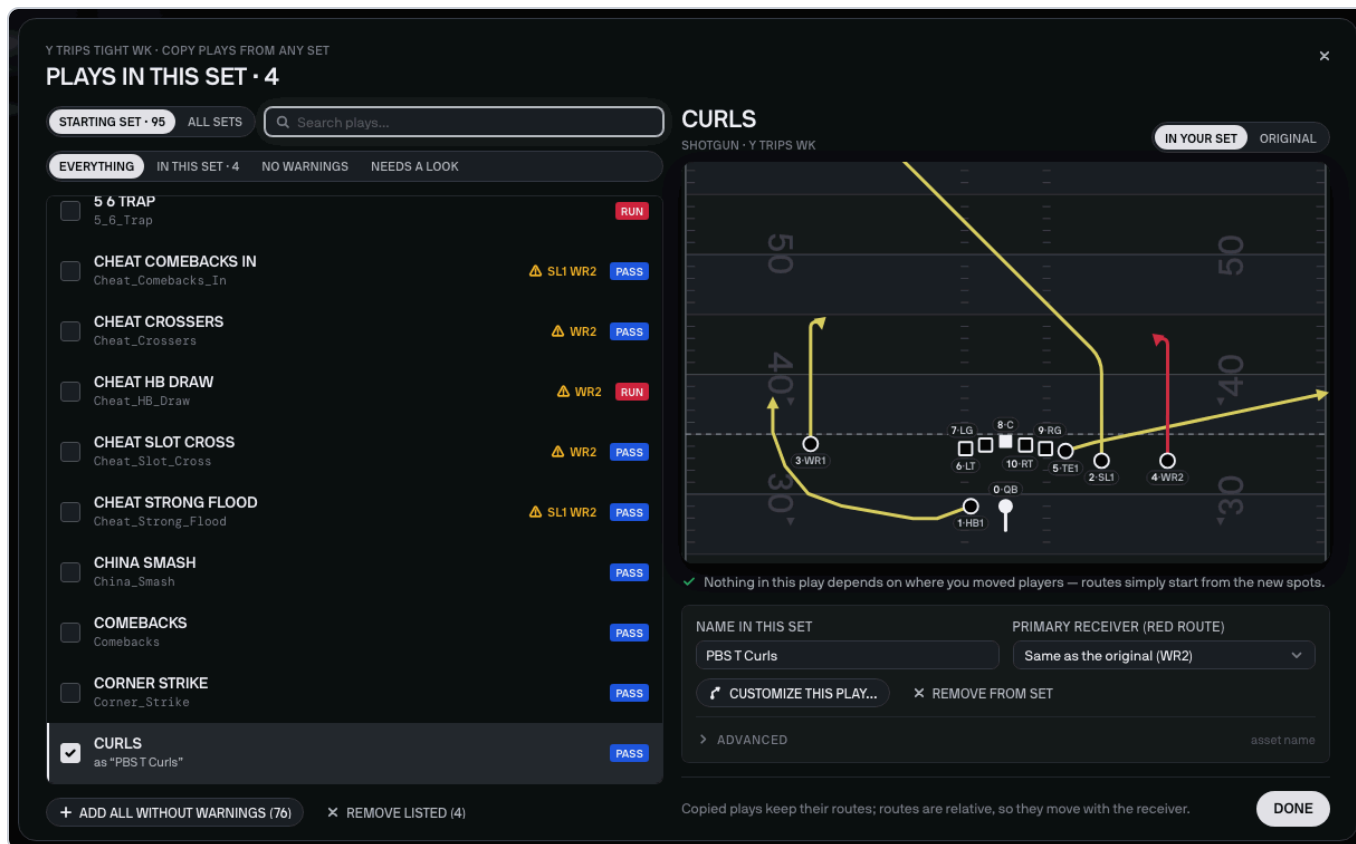


Editing M4 Left: WR2 now motions to x -8.

You can change where an existing preset ends. You can't add new presets or change which player moves yet.

COPY PLAYS INTO YOUR SET

A new set starts with no plays. Click **PLAYS IN THIS SET** • 0 at the top right (or **ADD PLAYS...** in the set's panel on the right):



Plays in this set: tick plays to copy them in, preview each one on your alignment, and see what needs a look.

1. **STARTING SET** lists the plays of the set you started from; **ALL SETS** searches every set.
2. Tick plays to copy them in. Each copy gets its own name (for example "PBS T Curls").
3. Click a play to preview it: **IN YOUR SET** shows it on your alignment, **ORIGINAL** as the game has it. Change its **NAME IN THIS SET** or its **PRIMARY RECEIVER (RED ROUTE)** here.
4. **ADD ALL WITHOUT WARNINGS** copies every play that doesn't need a look; **REMOVE LISTED** takes the listed ones out. Click **DONE**, then save.

Plays with a and player names (for example SL1 WR2) depend on a player you moved. Routes are fine (they start from the new spot), but some things keep the original coordinates and don't follow your change: handoffs, pulls, motions to a fixed spot, and players with a fixed starting spot in that play. Check those plays, or leave them out.

CUSTOMIZE THIS PLAY... opens the [Designer](#) with a new play based on the copy, so you can change its routes too. Check the **PLAYS FILE** on the last step before **CREATE PLAY**: it starts on the plays file you used last.

USE YOUR SET IN A PLAYBOOK

In **PLAYBOOK**, click **+ SET** under the formation: your set is in the list with a **CUSTOM** tag. Its copied plays appear in its **ALL PLAYS IN THIS SET** list like any other plays. Your own formations appear under **+ FORMATION**. Export builds the formations, sets and copied plays into the mod.

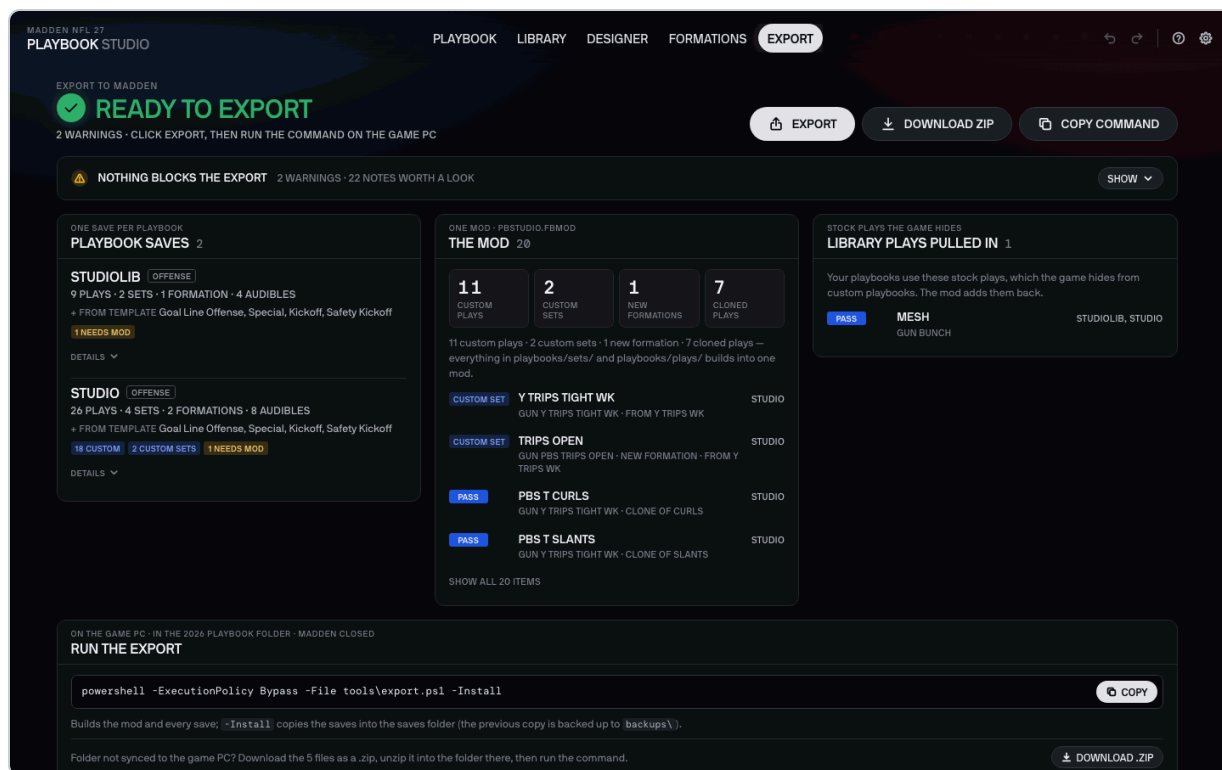
SECTION 10

EXPORT TO THE GAME

Check, export, run the command, apply the mod

1. CHECK FOR PROBLEMS · 2. CLICK EXPORT · 3. GET THE FILES TO THE MADDEN PC · 4. RUN THE COMMAND ON THE MADDEN PC · 5. APPLY THE MOD · 6. PICK YOUR PLAYBOOK IN THE GAME · THE SUMMARY CARDS · IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Playbook Studio only writes files. Turning them into something Madden can load happens on the **Madden PC**, with one command. The **EXPORT** tab checks everything first, shows what will be built, and gives you the command.



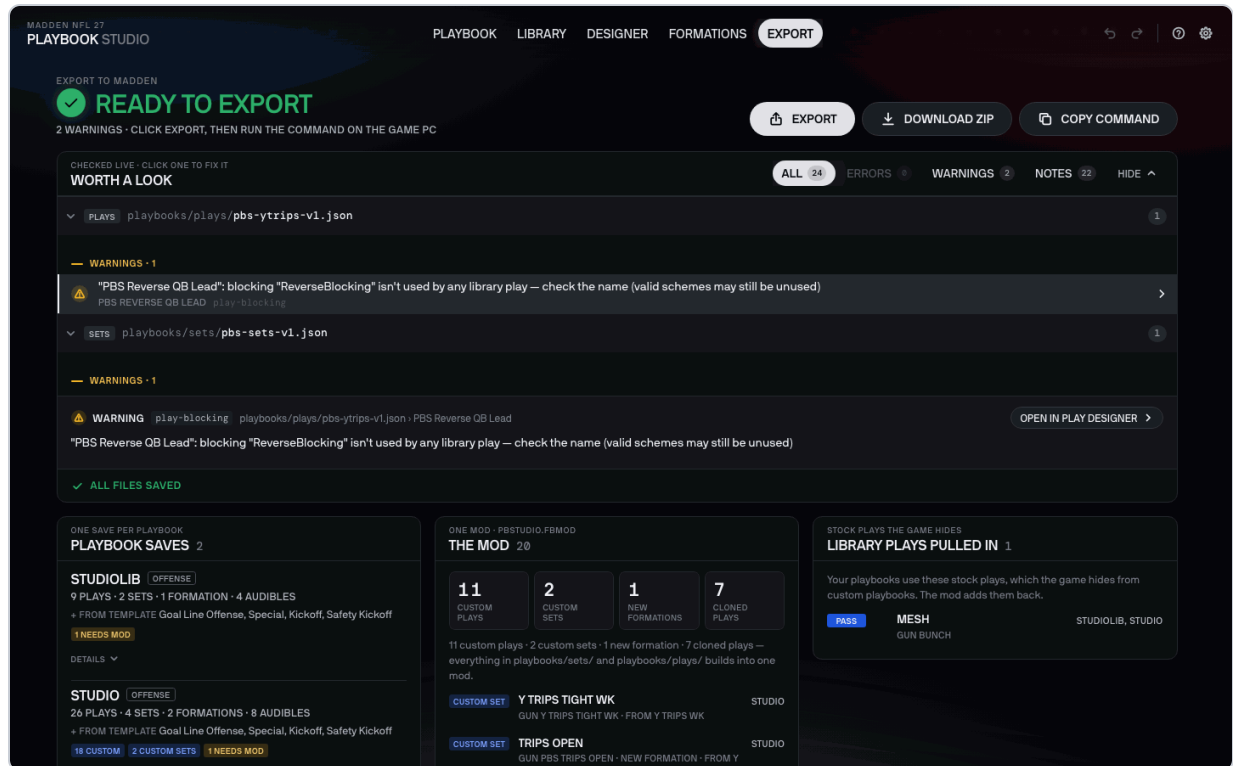
EXPORT: the status at the top, the three summary cards, and the command to run on the Madden PC.

1. CHECK FOR PROBLEMS

The big status at the top tells you where you stand:

STATUS	MEANS
READY TO EXPORT (green)	Nothing blocks the build. Warnings and notes are worth a look but don't stop it.
N PROBLEMS TO FIX (red)	Something would make the build fail. Fix these first.
BUILD WOULD FAIL (red)	A playbook can't be built as it is (for example a template section the template doesn't have).
NOTHING TO EXPORT YET	There are no playbooks, plays or sets yet.

The bar under it (for example *NOTHING BLOCKS THE EXPORT · 2 WARNINGS · 22 NOTES*) opens the full list with **SHOW**:



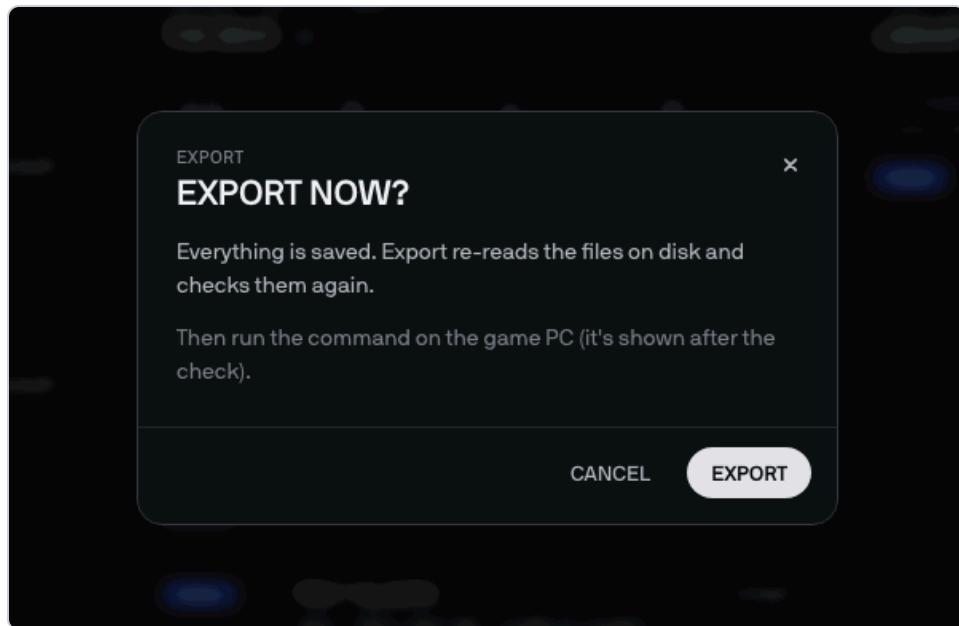
The checks list: grouped by file; click one to see it and open the right editor.

- **ERRORS** (red) stop the build: an unknown play, too many plays, two audibles on the same button, a custom set without 7 on the line...
- **WARNINGS** (amber) build, but might not do what you want in the game: a route that runs out of bounds, a motion longer than any in the game, a copied play that depends on a player you moved...
- **NOTES** are just information, such as which plays need the mod.

Click a row to see the details, then the button on the right (for example **OPEN IN PLAY DESIGNER**) to fix it.

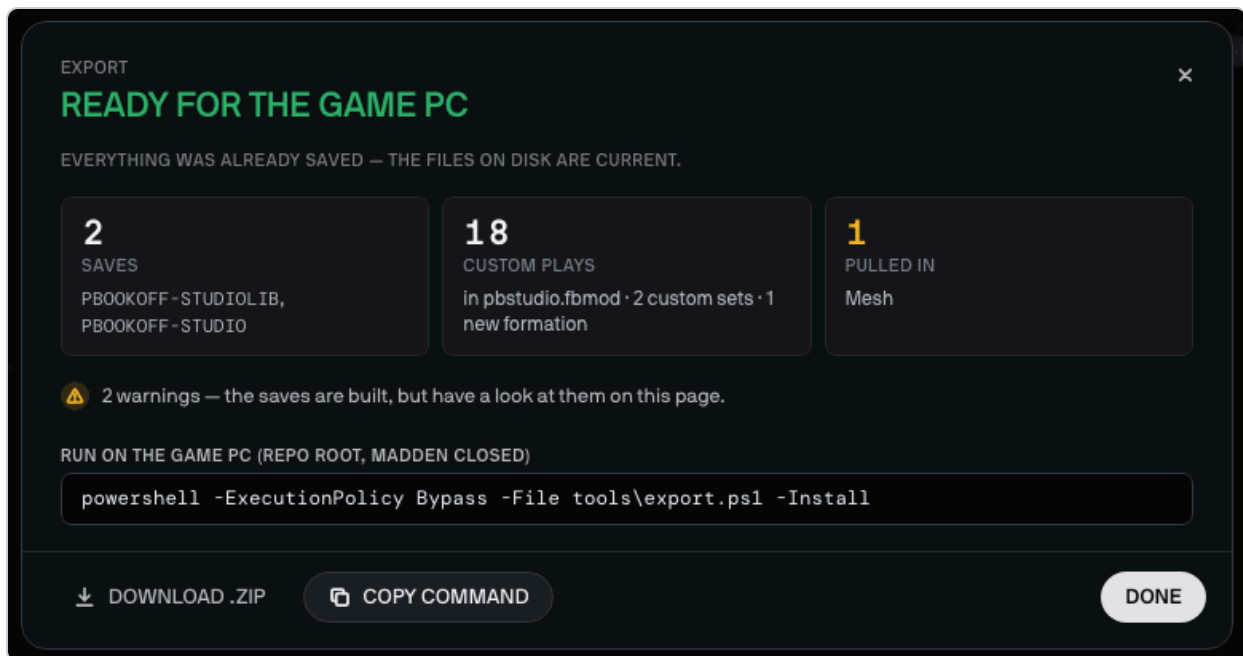
2. CLICK EXPORT

EXPORT saves every changed file, reads them back from disk and checks them again. When some files aren't saved yet, it lists them first: click **CANCEL** if one of them holds changes you only made to try something out.



If everything is saved, Export just re-checks; otherwise it lists the files it will save first.

When it's done you see what the Madden PC will build:



The result: the saves it will build, the custom plays in the mod, the stock plays pulled in, and the command.

3. GET THE FILES TO THE MADDEN PC

The command runs in the `2026 Playbook` folder on the Madden PC, so that folder needs your latest files:

- You used the app on the Madden PC (from your website, with that PC's folder): they're already there.
- You sync the folder (git or a sync app): sync it (`git pull` on the PC).
- Neither: click **DOWNLOAD ZIP** and unzip it into the `2026 Playbook` folder on the PC. It holds just your playbooks, plays, sets and app data.

4. RUN THE COMMAND ON THE MADDEN PC

1. Close Madden.
2. Open the `2026 Playbook` folder in File Explorer, click the address bar, type `powershell` and press Enter.
3. Paste the command (COPY COMMAND copies it) and press Enter:

```
POWERSHELL
```

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File tools\export.ps1 -Install
```

It builds:

- **One mod**, `mods\pbstudio.fbmod`, with all your custom plays, custom formations and sets, copied plays, and the stock plays the game normally hides (NEEDS MOD).
- **One save per playbook**, `PBOOKOFF-<NAME>` (for example `PBOOKOFF-STUDIO`). `-Install` copies them into `Documents\Madden NFL 27\saves`; the copy that was there before is backed up to `backups\`.

5. APPLY THE MOD

1. Open MMC Mod Manager.
2. The first time, add `mods\pbstudio.fbmod` from the `2026 Playbook` folder. After that, **refresh** it so the manager picks up the new build.
3. Click **Apply**, then **Launch**.

6. PICK YOUR PLAYBOOK IN THE GAME

In an **offline** mode, open the playbook choice and pick your custom playbook (STUDIO shows up as STUDIO). The special-teams and goal-line sections come from the stock playbook, so kicking works as usual.

OFFLINE ONLY

Modded playbooks follow the MMC rules: offline modes only, never online.

THE SUMMARY CARDS

- **PLAYBOOK SAVES**: one card per playbook with its plays, sets, formations and audibles, what comes from the template, and tags for custom plays, custom sets and plays that need the mod. **DETAILS** lists every row the save gets.
- **THE MOD**: everything in the one mod: custom plays, custom sets, new formations, copied plays.
- **LIBRARY PLAYS PULLED IN**: stock plays your playbooks use that the game hides from custom playbooks. The mod adds them back.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
The command says a play or set can't be found	Re-run the export in the app (it re-checks); fix the errors it lists. Make sure the PC has your latest files.
A play is missing in the game	It probably needs the mod: check that <code>pbstudio.fbmod</code> is refreshed and applied, then launch through the mod manager.
The playbook doesn't show up	Check that the command finished without errors and that <code>PBOOKOFF-<NAME></code> is in <code>Documents\Madden NFL 27\saves</code> . Restart Madden.
Old version in the game	Close Madden, run the command again, refresh the mod in MMC Mod Manager, Apply.
"running scripts is disabled"	Use the full command above; <code>-ExecutionPolicy Bypass</code> allows it for this one run.

More answers in the [FAQ](#).

USE IT ON YOUR WEBSITE

Upload by FTP, open your folder, the Madden PC

1. BUILD THE SITE (ON THE MAC) · 2. TURN ON HTTPS (ONCE) · 3. UPLOAD WITH FTP · 4. OPEN YOUR FOLDER · 5. ON THE MADDEN PC · KEEP THE MAC AND THE PC IN SYNC · UPDATE THE SITE · IS IT PRIVATE? · TROUBLESHOOTING

You can put Playbook Studio on your own website and open it in Chrome or Edge from any computer, including the PC that runs Madden. The website only holds the app itself. Your playbooks and the game data stay in your `2026 Playbook` folder on the computer you're using: the app asks you to open that folder and works on it directly.

	ON THIS COMPUTER	FROM YOUR WEBSITE
Start it	<code>npm run dev</code> in the <code>app</code> folder	Open <code>https://your-site.com/playbook/</code>
Needs	Node, a terminal	Chrome or Edge, and the folder on that computer
Files	The folder the server runs in	The folder you open in the browser

Both write the same files, so you can switch freely. The full walkthrough, with every host's screens, is in `app/docs/HOSTING.md` in the repo.

1. BUILD THE SITE (ON THE MAC)

In Terminal:

```
SH
cd "2026 Playbook/app"
npm install          # first time only
npm run build:site   # builds the website into app/dist/ and checks it's ready to upload
```

`app/dist/` is the whole website: `index.html`, `favicon.svg`, an `assets/` folder and this guide. No game data or playbooks are in it. To look at it before uploading, run `npm run preview:site` and open `http://localhost:4178/playbook/`.

2. TURN ON HTTPS (ONCE)

The app can only open your folder on a secure page: the address must start with `https://`. In your hosting control panel, turn on a free Let's Encrypt certificate (cPanel: **Security** → **SSL/TLS Status** → **Run AutoSSL**; other panels have an "SSL" or "Let's Encrypt" page). Check it: open your site in Chrome and click the icon left of the address; it should say **Connection is secure**.

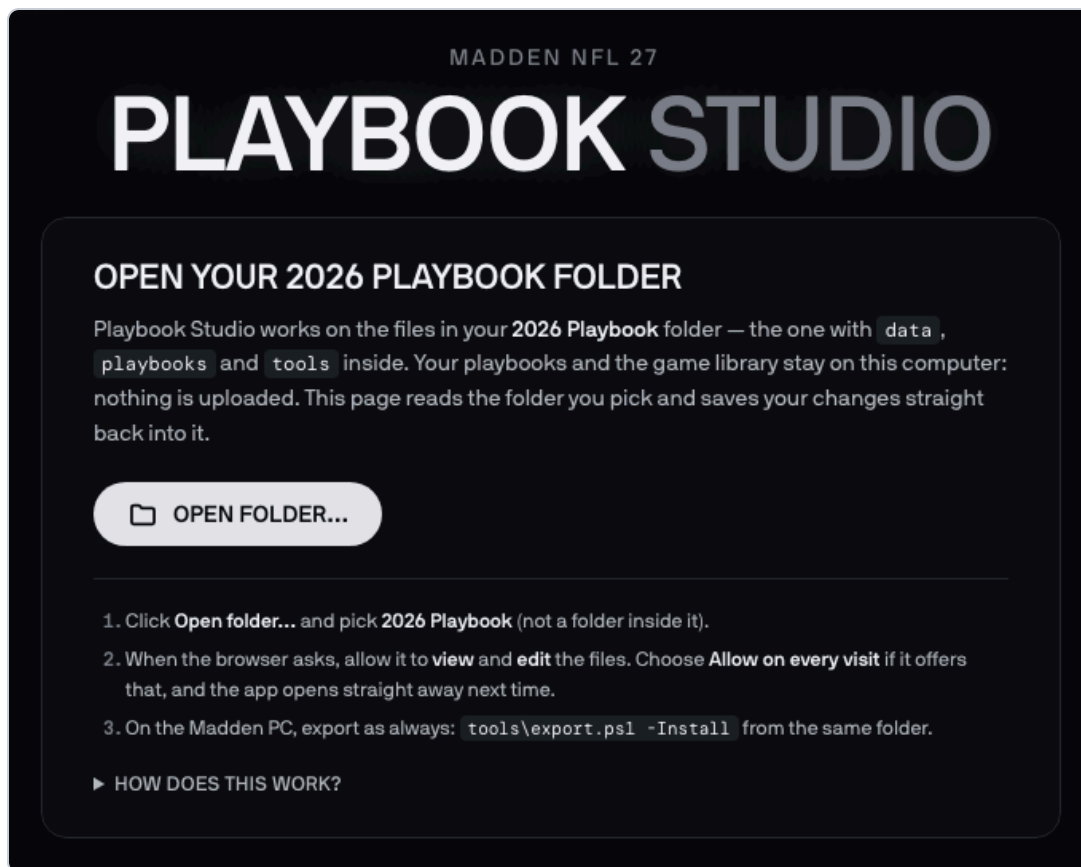
3. UPLOAD WITH FTP

1. Open an FTP app (FileZilla, Cyberduck or Transmit) and connect with the FTP or SFTP login from your hosting panel. Use **SFTP**, or FTP with **explicit TLS**; avoid plain FTP.

2. On the server, open the website folder (usually `public_html`) and create a folder for the app, for example `playbook`.
3. On the Mac side, open `2026 Playbook/app/dist`.
4. Select **everything inside** `dist` and drag it into `playbook`. Upload `assets/` first and `index.html` last.
5. Open `https://your-site.com/playbook/`.

The server should end up with `public_html/playbook/index.html` and `public_html/playbook/assets/...`. If you see `playbook/dist/index.html`, you uploaded the folder instead of its contents.

4. OPEN YOUR FOLDER



The start screen of the hosted app.

1. Open the site in **Chrome** or **Edge**.
2. Click **OPEN FOLDER...** and pick your **2026 Playbook** folder: the one with `data`, `playbooks` and `tools` inside, not a folder inside it. (If you pick the wrong one, the app tells you which one to pick.)
3. Allow the browser to **view** the files, then to **edit** them.
4. The library loads from the folder (a few seconds) and the app opens on **PLAYBOOK**. Save as usual; it writes straight into the folder.

Next time, click **Reconnect to "2026 Playbook"** and allow access. If Chrome offers **Allow on every visit**, choose it and the app opens straight into your folder from then on.

To use another copy of the folder, go to **Settings** → **Files & data** and click **Change folder...**; **Close folder** goes back to the start screen. That page also shows which way the app is running: **Folder in this browser** (your website) or **Local server** (`npm run dev`).

5. ON THE MADDEN PC

1. Use **Edge** (already on Windows) or **Chrome**.
2. Keep the `2026 Playbook` folder on the PC, the same one you export from (for example `C:\Users\<you>\Documents\2026 Playbook`).
3. Open your site, **OPEN FOLDER...**, pick that folder, and edit and save as usual.
4. Close Madden, and run the export from that folder as always (see [Export](#)).

Audibles are drawn as Xbox buttons by default; change it in **Settings** → **Audibles**.

KEEP THE MAC AND THE PC IN SYNC

The website always works on the folder of the computer you're on, so keep the two folders in sync:

- **git** (recommended): `git pull` before you start, and when you're done, save in the app, then `git add playbooks app-data && git commit -m "playbook edits" && git push` . Keep the repository private: it contains game data.
- A **sync app** (OneDrive, Dropbox, iCloud Drive): mark the folder "always keep on this device", and don't edit on both computers at the same time.

If files change while the app is open, click back into its window: files you haven't edited reload, and files you have edited are marked **CHANGED ON DISK** so nothing is overwritten without asking.

UPDATE THE SITE

When the app changes: run `npm run build:site` again, upload the contents of `app/dist/` to the same folder (choose **Overwrite**), and reload the page (⌘ ⇧ R / Ctrl+Shift+R if it still looks old). Updating the site never touches your playbooks; they're in your folders, not on the server.

IS IT PRIVATE?

- **Nothing from the game or your playbooks is uploaded.** The site is plain files; your browser reads and writes your folder on your own disk.
- The page can only touch the one folder you picked, and only after you allowed it.
- Anyone with the address can load the app, but without their own 2026 Playbook folder it does nothing. To keep others out entirely, password-protect the folder in your hosting panel (cPanel: **Directory Privacy**).

TROUBLESHOOTING

YOU SEE	DO THIS
"Use Chrome or Edge"	Safari, Firefox and phones can't open folders. Use Chrome or Edge on a Mac or PC.
"Open this page over https"	Use the <code>https://</code> address. No certificate yet? See step 2.
A blank page	The server sends <code>.js</code> files with the wrong type, or <code>assets/</code> is missing. Upload the <code>.htaccess</code> file from <code>app/docs/htaccess.txt</code> (rename it to <code>.htaccess</code>), and upload all of <code>dist</code> again.
"... doesn't look like your 2026 Playbook folder"	Pick the folder that contains <code>data</code> and <code>playbooks</code> .
"... no longer has access to the folder"	Reload the page and click Reconnect .
The old version still shows	Hard-reload: ⌘⇧R (Mac) or Ctrl+Shift+R (PC).
Library won't load	The folder on this computer is missing <code>data/library/</code> . Sync it (git pull), or regenerate it on the PC.

FAQ & TROUBLESHOOTING

Common questions and fixes

PLAYS AND ROUTES · PLAYBOOKS AND THE GAME · SAVING AND FILES · THE APP AND THE BROWSER

PLAYS AND ROUTES

CAN I CHANGE WHO GETS THE RED ROUTE (THE PRIMARY RECEIVER)?

Yes. In the [Designer](#), pick a player under PRIMARY RECEIVER (RED ROUTE) in the play panel, or right-click the player → **Make primary receiver (red route)**. For a stock play, make a copy first: **CLONE IN DESIGNER** in the library. For a play copied into one of your own sets, the **Plays in this set** dialog has the same menu.

THE RED ROUTE SHOWS ON TWO RECEIVERS IN THE GAME

That has happened with plays whose **reads** were rewritten. Open the play in the designer, go to **ADVANCED → READS** in the play panel and click **USE BASE READS**, set the primary receiver again, save and export. Change the reads only when you really need to.

CAN I SAVE A ROUTE I MADE AND USE IT AGAIN?

Yes: **SAVE ROUTE TO MY ROUTES** in the player's header. It then shows under **MY ROUTES** on the **ROUTE** tab of every play, flipped automatically for players on the other side. See [My Routes](#).

HOW DO I CLEAR A ROUTE AND DRAW MY OWN?

Select the player and click **CLEAR ROUTE** above the field: the route goes and **DRAW ROUTE** turns on. Click each corner on the field, then press Esc. See [Routes, cuts & My Routes](#).

CAN I SEE THE DIFFERENT CUTS?

Yes. The app draws each cut the way it looks: rounded for speed cuts, sharp for hard cuts, a small zig for double moves, a hook for turn-backs and a bar for settles. See the legend in [Routes, cuts & My Routes](#).

WHY CAN'T I DRAG A PLAYER TO A NEW SPOT IN THE DESIGNER?

Players line up where the **set** puts them. You can move one player for **this play only** (player header → **Move this player for this play only**). To move him in every play, make your own set in [Formations](#) and build plays on it. Players in a handoff are locked to the base play's spot.

WHY IS A PLAYER LOCKED (LOCK ICON)?

He takes part in the base play's handoff, fake, option or pitch, which has to match the QB exactly. His first steps come from the base play. Use **Edit what happens after the handoff** to change the rest, or pick another base play.

HOW FAR CAN A PLAYER GO IN MOTION?

Behind the line, no deeper than 11 yards, inside the numbers (18 yards either side of the ball), 1 to 5 points, about 25 yards in total (35 at most), one motion man per play, never a lineman. The designer keeps the points inside the shaded area and warns about the rest. See [Design a play](#).

CAN I EDIT A PLAY THE GAME ALREADY HAS?

Not in place. Use it as the base of a new play (CLONE IN DESIGNER); the original stays in the game.

CAN I MAKE DEFENSIVE PLAYS OR SETS?

The library shows defensive plays and you can build a defense playbook from them. Custom plays and custom sets are offense only for now.

PLAYBOOKS AND THE GAME

WHAT DOES NEEDS MOD MEAN?

The game hides some plays from custom playbooks. The export adds them to the Playbook Studio mod for you, so they work once the mod is applied. Your own plays and sets always need the mod.

A PLAY IS MISSING IN THE GAME

- Make sure the mod is **refreshed and applied** in MMC Mod Manager after every export, and that you launched through it. Custom plays and NEEDS MOD plays only exist with the mod.
- Make sure the play is actually in the playbook (PLAYBOOK tab), and that you saved before exporting.
- Check EXPORT for errors, then run the export again.

MY KICKOFFS, PUNTS OR FIELD GOALS ARE GONE

Keep **Special**, **Kickoff** and **Safety Kickoff** in the playbook (and usually **Goal Line Offense**). They're there as **TEMPLATE** sections in new playbooks; if you removed one, add the formation again with **+ FORMATION**.

THE PLAYS ARE IN A DIFFERENT ORDER IN THE GAME

Madden sorts formations by how often you call them, and in testing the order of plays inside a set didn't always follow the file. The app keeps your order in the file anyway.

THE AUDIBLE BUTTONS IN THE GAME DON'T MATCH THE APP

Change the mapping in **Settings** → **Audibles** → **Which button is which slot**. The default layout hasn't been confirmed in Madden 27 yet. See [Audibles](#).

MY CUSTOM SET SAYS IT NEEDS 7 PLAYERS ON THE LINE

The game-side builder counts a player as on the line only when he's less than 1.5 yards off the ball. Click the fix chip next to the checks (for example **MOVE TE1, LT, RT ONTO THE LINE**), or start from another set. See [Formations](#).

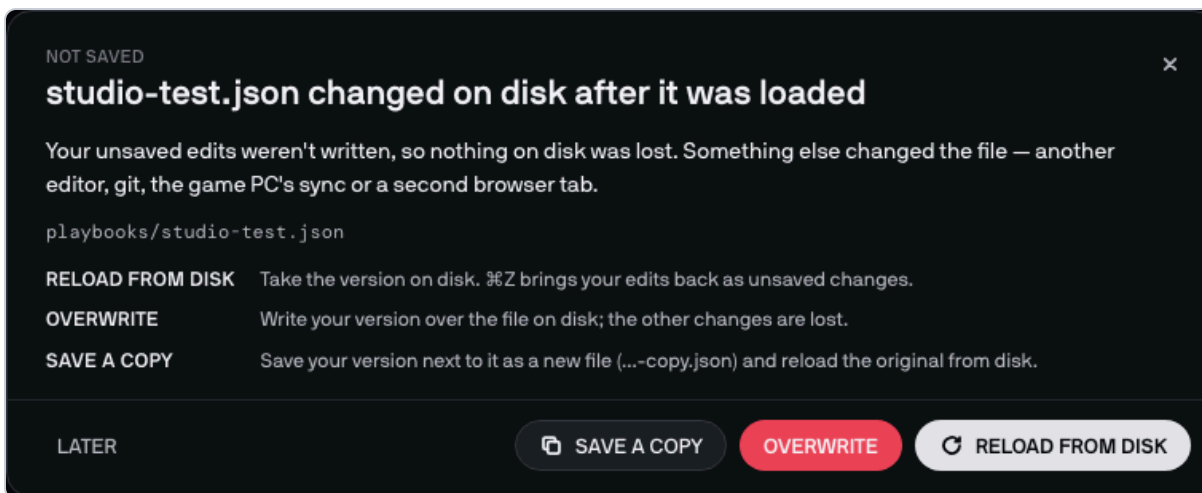
SAVING AND FILES

DID MY CHANGES SAVE?

Look at the file chip at the top right: **SAVED** means yes; a yellow dot and **SAVE** mean there are unsaved changes. Press **⌘S** / **Ctrl+S** (this file) or **⇧⌘S** / **Ctrl+Shift+S** (all files). **EXPORT** also saves everything.

"CHANGED ON DISK" / A FILE CHANGED OUTSIDE THE APP

Something else changed the file since the app loaded it: git, a sync app, another browser tab or an editor. The app never overwrites it silently; it asks:



The changed-on-disk dialog: reload the disk version, overwrite it, or save your version as a copy.

- **RELOAD FROM DISK**: take the version on disk. Your edits stay one **⌘Z** away.
- **OVERWRITE**: write your version over it.
- **SAVE A COPY**: save yours as `<name>-copy.json` and reload the original.
- **LATER**: decide later; the file chip shows **CHANGED ON DISK** until you do.

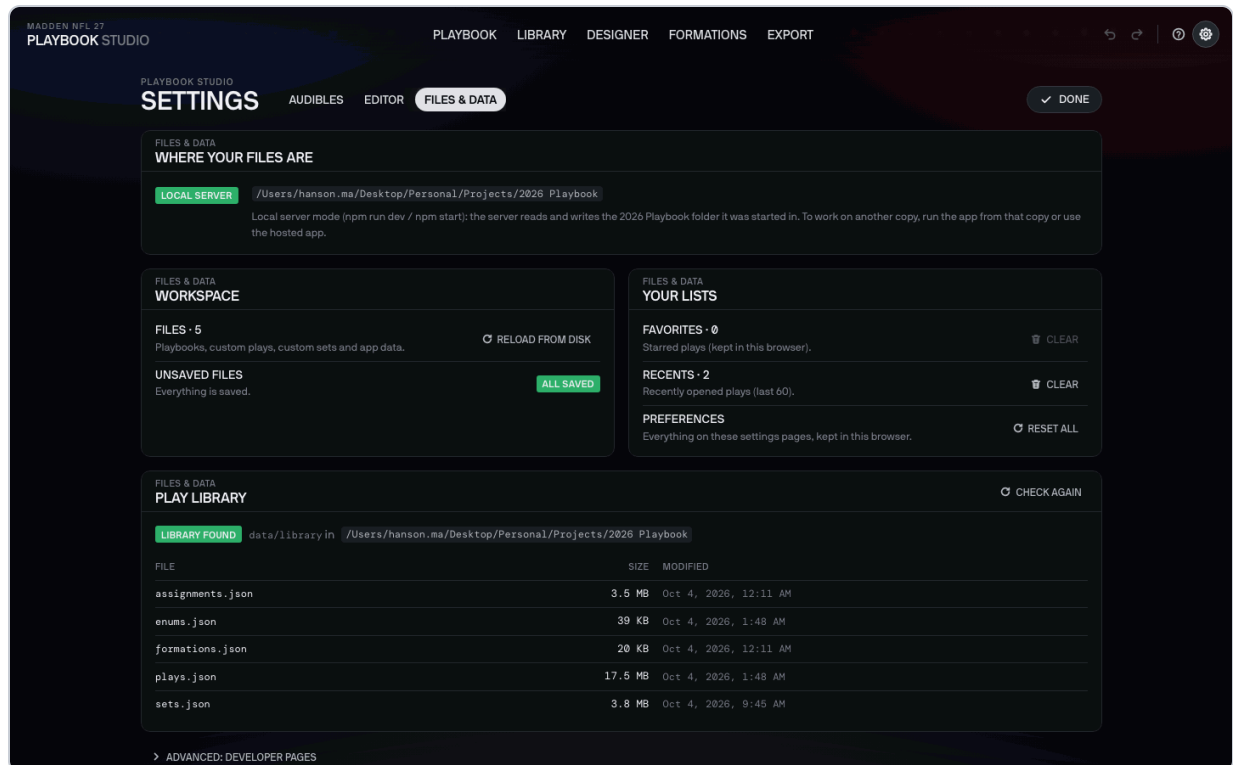
I DELETED SOMETHING BY MISTAKE

Inside a file: **⌘Z** / **Ctrl+Z**. A deleted file (playbook, plays file, sets file) is moved to `app-data/.trash/` with the date in its name: move it back to its folder to restore it.

WHERE ARE MY FILES?

WHAT	WHERE
Playbooks	<code>playbooks/<name>.json</code>
Your plays	<code>playbooks/plays/<name>.json</code>
Your formations and sets	<code>playbooks/sets/<name>.json</code>
My Routes, concepts and tags	<code>app-data/</code>
Deleted files	<code>app-data/.trash/</code>

Settings → **Files & data** shows the folder the app is working on.



Settings → Files & data: the folder in use, unsaved files, your lists and the play library it found.

THE APP AND THE BROWSER

THE BROWSER CAN'T OPEN MY FOLDER

- Use Chrome or Edge on a Mac or PC. Safari, Firefox, iPad and phones can't open folders.
- The address must start with **https://** (or be `localhost`).
- Pick the **2026 Playbook** folder itself, not `playbooks` or `data` inside it.
- Next visit, click **Reconnect** and allow access again (or choose **Allow on every visit**).

See [Use it on your website](#).

THE LIBRARY WON'T LOAD

The app reads the game's play library from `data/library/` in your 2026 Playbook folder. Make sure those files are there (sync the folder, or regenerate them on the Madden PC after a game patch with `PlayDump library data/library`), then reload. **Settings → Files & data → PLAY LIBRARY** shows what it found.

WHERE'S THE PDF VERSION OF THIS GUIDE?

Click **Open the PDF guide** at the bottom of the guide's section list. It has the same content, ready to print.